

COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Essay - Complete Subject-Wide Knowledge Guide and Solved PYQs

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

Essay - Complete Subject-Wide Knowledge Guide and Solved PYQs

One continuous guide covering all 16 Essay knowledge topics. No MCQs and no artificial learning-session sequence. Every Basic and Advanced owner is preserved in full before the solved PYQ section.

PART I - COMPLETE KNOWLEDGE GUIDE

TOPIC 01 - Paper Rules, Choice and Selection

Complete foundational knowledge

Subject: Essay | **Tier:** Must-Do | **GS Paper:** Essay (General Studies Paper - Essay, Mains). **Core area:** Paper mechanics; separating audited fact from strategy; a simple, risk-aware method for choosing one topic from each Section. **Grounded in:** UPSC Essay PYQ corpus - V1 directly verified locally for 2018-2025 and V2 carried-forward practice wording for 2013-2017 (see ../PYQ-Corpus-2013-2025.md); ../00_Master-Framework.md Sections 1, 3, 11. **Research cutoff:** 18 July 2026. **Tags:** FACT: verified fact | ANALYSIS: strategy/inference | CURRENT: dated anchor | WRONG: trap/boundary. **Companion:** ../advanced/01_Paper-Rules-Choice-and-Selection.md

1. Purpose and scope

This topic answers two questions before any writing begins: *what does the paper actually require*, and *how should a candidate choose which of the eight-plus-eight displayed prompts to attempt?* It does not teach decoding technique (see 02/03) or drafting technique (see 05-07) - it teaches the upstream decision that determines how easy those later steps will be.

2. Core terms in plain language

- **Section:** a labelled group of four prompts; the candidate must pick exactly one topic from each of the two displayed Sections.
- **Prompt:** the single sentence/aphorism or issue-statement to be written on - quoted, not paraphrased, when referenced in planning.
- **Thesis-fit:** how easily a prompt yields one qualified, defensible central argument (see 05).
- **Dimension count:** how many genuinely distinct angles (not restatements of the same point) a prompt supports (see 04).
- **Evidence availability:** how many safe, verifiable Indian or global illustrations you can actually recall for a prompt (see 12).

3. FACT: Exam facts / source basis

The current corpus ledger records 2018-2025 as **V1 - directly verified locally** and 2013-2017 as **V2 - carried-forward, not locally verifiable**. The paper-mechanics facts below are illustrated with the 2024 and 2025 papers, whose printed wording is reproduced in the ledger.

- **FACT: 2024 instruction, exactly as printed:** "Write two essays, choosing one topic from each of the following Sections A and B, in about 1000-1200 words each." followed by the marks line "(125 × 2 = 250)".
- **WRONG: 2025 instruction is garbled in the printed paper:** "Write two

essays, choosing one topic from each of the following Sections A as in about 1000 - 1200 words each:". FACT: The requirement is still unambiguous from the paper's Hindi line and its two printed section headings - two essays, one from each of Sections A and B, about 1000-1200 words each - but do not quote the 2025 line as clean English.

- FACT: **Printed numbering is not a stable convention.** 2024 restarts

Section B at 1-4; 2025 continues Section B at 5-8. This folder's B5-B8 labels are an internal reference scheme, not the 2024 paper's printed numbers.

- FACT: Both years display **four prompts per Section**, print each topic

bilingually (Hindi then English), and require **one topic chosen from each Section** - never two from the same Section.

- WRONG: **Not printed in either locally held paper:** any "Time Allowed"

header, a 2025 marks line, an author beside any prompt, or any marking rubric/weightage. FACT: The separate official examination scheme supplies the **three-hour** Essay duration; no phase split is official.

- See . . /PYQ-Corpus-2013-2025.md for all 100 prompts and each year's

verification level: V1 for 2018-2025 and V2 for 2013-2017.

ANALYSIS: **Practical consequence for choice:** because the paper's own numbering and even its instruction line vary year to year, spend the first reading confirming the *structural* rule (one from each Section) rather than assuming any layout you have seen in a mock paper.

4. The central idea and common misreading

ANALYSIS: **Central idea:** topic choice is a strategic decision made on the basis of thesis-fit, dimension count and evidence availability - not simple familiarity. WRONG: **Common misreading:** picking a prompt because it sounds close to a favourite GS subject (e.g. choosing "Empires of the mind" purely because you like Science & Technology) without first checking whether you can actually form one qualified thesis and recall two or three safe illustrations for it. A topic that feels unfamiliar but decodes cleanly (most aphorisms do, once you apply 02) is frequently the safer choice.

5. Basic scan questions

Ask these of every displayed prompt within the first few minutes:

1. Can I restate this prompt's core claim in one plain sentence?
2. Is this an aphorism (needs decoding, see 02) or an issue-statement (needs scoping, see 03)?
3. Can I already name two distinct dimensions for it (see 04)?
4. Can I already name one Indian illustration that fits without forcing it (see 12)?
5. Does a workable thesis come to mind within about a minute (see 05)?

6. Comparison grid

ANALYSIS: Use a quick grid - not a full essay plan - to compare shortlisted prompts before committing:

Candidate prompt	Thesis comes easily?	≥2 real dimensions?	≥2 safe illustrations?	Conclusion risk (forced /earned?)
e.g. 2024-A3 "Happiness is the path"	Yes - process vs. destination	Individual, policy, consumption	Yes	Earned - flourishing as process
e.g. 2024-A2 "Empires of the mind"	Slower - needs "empire" redefined	Education, digital divide, platform power	Partial	Needs care to avoid forced ending

Score honestly; a prompt with weaker fit in two or more columns is riskier than it looks at first read.

7. India-first illustration starters

ANALYSIS: Before committing to a prompt, recall - do not invent - at least one Indian illustration per likely dimension: an institution, a policy episode, a well-known social pattern, or a documented event. If nothing comes to mind without forcing it, that is itself useful information about the prompt's risk (see topic 12 for the full verified-example discipline).

8. Thesis options and selection

ANALYSIS: For each shortlisted prompt, draft one candidate thesis sentence before final choice - not a full outline. Choose the prompt whose thesis sentence is (a) a genuine claim, not a restatement of the prompt, (b) qualified (acknowledges a limit or condition), and (c) supportable by the illustrations recalled in Section 7. Full thesis-construction method in 05.

8a. Two-essay portfolio gate

ANALYSIS: Choose one prompt from **each** Section, then test the pair before committing to either draft:

1. Does each essay independently have a qualified thesis, two distinct paragraph-clusters and safe evidence?
2. Does either choice consume so much planning time or uncertain recall that the other essay will be rushed?
3. Are you relying on the same thin, half-remembered illustration for both essays? If so, replace the weaker choice.

The better pair is not necessarily the two most familiar prompts; it is the pair for which both essays remain defensible under the same time budget. This is a final gate, not an excuse to over-deliberate.

9. Simple essay architecture

ANALYSIS: A brief architecture preview helps the choice: sketch three to four one-line paragraph clusters per shortlisted prompt (opening idea, two-three developed dimensions, a synthesis/counter-view paragraph, closing idea). If a prompt only yields two clusters even after Section 6's grid, it is under-developed for 1000-1200 words. Full architecture method in 07.

10. Opening, body and closure moves

ANALYSIS: Check feasibility, not final wording: can you picture a relevant opening (not a forced anecdote) and a closing that follows naturally from your draft thesis, without repeating the introduction verbatim? If both feel forced for a shortlisted prompt, prefer the alternative. Full method in 06.

11. WRONG: Traps and repair moves

- **WRONG: Choosing by subject-liking alone.** -> Repair: run the Section 5-8 checks before committing; familiarity without thesis-fit is a false signal.
- **WRONG: Attempting two prompts from the same Section.** -> Repair: confirm one-per-Section before writing a single word; this is a hard paper rule, not a style choice.
- **WRONG: Treating the word-count instruction as approximate.** -> Repair: plan toward the printed 1000-1200-word range (see 13) rather than a much shorter or longer draft.
- **WRONG: Assuming a prompt needs a "clever" or obscure reading.** -> Repair: a plain, well-qualified reading defended with real illustrations outperforms a strained, ornamental interpretation.

12. Timed micro-drill and self-check

5-minute drill: Using `../README.md`'s full prompt index, pick any one 2024 Section and one 2025 Section at random. For each of the four prompts in each, write one line for: thesis-fit, dimension count and one recalled Indian illustration. Circle the prompt in each Section you would actually choose, and state why in one sentence.

Self-check: Did you choose the most *familiar-sounding* prompt, or the one that scored best on Sections 5-8's checks? If they differ, re-examine your reasoning before moving to 02.

Complete advanced knowledge

Subject: Essay | **Tier:** Advanced | **GS Paper:** Essay (General Studies Paper - Essay, Mains). **Core area:** Choice as a portfolio/risk decision; the hidden assumptions inside "pick your favourite topic" advice; a decision protocol that survives exam-day time pressure. **Grounded in:** UPSC Essay PYQ corpus - V1 directly verified locally for 2018-2025 and V2 carried-forward practice wording for 2013-2017 (see `../PYQ-Corpus-2013-2025.md`); `../00_Master-Framework.md` Sections 1, 3, 11. **Research cutoff:** 18 July 2026. **Tags:** FACT: verified fact | ANALYSIS: strategy/inference | CURRENT: dated anchor | WRONG: trap/boundary. **Companion:** `../basic/01_Paper-Rules-Choice-and-Selection.md`

1. Advanced proposition and boundary

Proposition: ANALYSIS: topic choice is best modelled as a portfolio decision under time pressure - you are choosing the prompt with the best expected combination of thesis-clarity, dimension-depth and evidence-safety, not the prompt with the highest emotional appeal. **Boundary:** WRONG: this topic does not itself decode any single prompt in depth (that is 02/03) or build a full argument map (05/08); it supplies the upstream selection logic those topics assume has already been run.

2. Concept definition and taxonomy

- **Aphorism prompts** (most of both years' Sections): compressed, metaphorical, require decoding before dimension-work is possible.
- **Issue-statement prompts** (e.g. 2024-B5 on social media/FOMO): more directly empirical/social, require scoping (03) rather than metaphor-decoding.
- **High-fit prompt:** thesis emerges within about a minute, ≥ 2 real dimensions, ≥ 2 recallable illustrations, plausible non-forced conclusion.
- **Low-fit prompt:** any of the above missing, *or* only recoverable with visible strain (a warning sign under time pressure, not merely a stylistic weakness).

3. Tension pairs and hidden assumptions

- **Interest vs. tractability:** the assumption that liking a subject guarantees writing quality is unsafe - interest without a qualified thesis produces an enthusiastic but shapeless essay.
- **Familiarity vs. depth:** a "familiar" topic invites GS-answer stacking (fact lists) rather than argument; an unfamiliar aphorism forces argument-first thinking, which the paper actually rewards.
- **Speed vs. reversibility:** choice happens early and is costly to reverse mid-attempt; the hidden assumption in "just start writing" is that later correction is cheap - it is not, given the fixed time budget (13).

4. Levels of analysis and temporal-spatial scale

Selection logic should be checked at three levels: (a) the sentence level - can the prompt's own words support a thesis without distortion; (b) the essay level - will 10-12 paragraphs (07) sustain interest and argument without repetition; (c) the exam level - does the choice, given your remaining time budget for both essays (13), still allow adequate planning and revision for the second essay.

5. Stakeholder map and distributional effects

The "stakeholders" in a choice decision are internal to the candidate's own performance: the introduction/conclusion quality, the second essay's available time, and the risk of an unrecoverable topic-drift mid-draft. ANALYSIS: Unlike most Essay-topic stakeholder maps (which describe people affected by a policy), this one describes *trade-offs across the candidate's own two essays* - time spent over-analysing choice is time not spent planning either essay.

6. Causality, mechanisms and feedback loops

```
WEAK CHOICE FILTER (familiarity only)
  |
  v
THIN THESIS or GS-STYLE FACT LIST
  |
  v
WEAK PARAGRAPH LINKS (nothing to argue, so paragraphs restate)
  |
  v
FORCED CONCLUSION
```

versus

```
STRONG CHOICE FILTER (thesis-fit + dimension + evidence check)
  |
  v
QUALIFIED THESIS EMERGES EARLY
  |
  v
ARGUMENT MAP FEASIBLE (05/08)
  |
  v
EARNED, NON-REPETITIVE CONCLUSION
```

ANALYSIS: The feedback loop matters: a weak early choice cannot usually be repaired by better paragraph-level writing later - the failure propagates forward through the whole essay.

7. Necessary/sufficient conditions and exceptions

Thesis-fit, dimension count and evidence availability are each **necessary but not individually sufficient** conditions for a good choice - a prompt can pass all three checks and still fail if the candidate cannot manage a non-forced conclusion (Section 6 above), which is why Section 5-8 of the basic file explicitly checks conclusion feasibility before commitment. ANALYSIS: **Exception:** under severe time pressure, a "good enough, fast" choice may beat a marginally better but slower-to-decide choice - the decision itself has an opportunity cost.

8. Paradox, dialectic and counterfactual test

Paradox: the topic that feels *hardest* to decode at first glance (most aphorisms) is often *safer* to write than the topic that feels easiest (familiar issue-statements), because the aphorism forces argument-construction from the outset, while the familiar topic invites fact-stacking that only reveals its thinness at the paragraph-writing stage.

Counterfactual test: "If I removed my prior familiarity with this subject, would the prompt still support a clear thesis and two distinct dimensions?" If the answer is no, familiarity was doing the work the prompt itself should be doing.

9. Ethical conflict and synthesis

ANALYSIS: There is a minor ethical dimension even here: choosing a topic solely because it lets you recycle memorised GS content risks an essay that technically answers a *different, adjacent* question rather than the one printed - a subtle form of misrepresenting engagement with the actual prompt. **Synthesis:** treat the prompt's exact wording as the binding constraint, and treat prior subject knowledge only as a *resource* for illustrations (12), not as a licence to answer a related-but-different question.

10. Evidence/source-risk and India application

FACT: Both years' prompts are unattributed and carry printed defects (see . . /README . md) - an advanced candidate should draw two conclusions from this. First, the paper is testing original interpretation, not recall of a "correct," externally sourced reading: there is no canonical text behind the prompt to be matched against. Second, WRONG: a printing defect is not a cryptic signal - 2024-A2's "empires of the **futures**" is a slip, not an invitation to write about plural futures, and 2025's garbled "Sections A as in" instruction line is a typesetting failure, not a change of rule. Quote as printed; interpret the evident sense. ANALYSIS: Evidence-risk at the choice stage means: do not shortlist a prompt whose only available illustrations are half-remembered statistics you cannot verify under exam conditions - prefer prompts supportable by institutions, well-known policy episodes, or documented events you can state without invented numbers (full discipline in 09, 12).

11. Advanced structure, paragraph sequencing and style

ANALYSIS: At the choice stage, sequencing is prospective, not yet actual: mentally sequence three to five paragraph-clusters for each shortlisted prompt (per basic/01 Section 9) and check whether the sequence has a natural progression (cause -> consequence -> qualification -> synthesis) or whether the clusters are merely parallel restatements of the same point - the latter signals a thesis that has not yet been sharpened enough to choose confidently.

12. WRONG: Failure modes and revision protocol

- WRONG: **Sunk-cost persistence:** continuing with a poorly-fitting prompt because time was already spent deciding. -> Protocol: if Section 6's checks fail after five minutes of genuine attempt, switch once, early, rather than mid-draft.
- WRONG: **Over-deliberation:** spending disproportionate time optimising choice at the expense of planning/drafting time. -> Protocol: cap choice-and-decode time per essay (13) and commit once the basic checks are passed reasonably well, not perfectly.
- WRONG: **Choosing purely to avoid a weaker Section,** ignoring that both Sections must still be attempted. -> Protocol: apply the same filter to all four prompts in *both* Sections before finalising either essay.

13. CURRENT: Dated anchor / practice lab / transfer task

CURRENT: **Dated anchor:** none required for this topic - choice mechanics are paper-structural, not time-sensitive; do not attach a current-affairs date merely to satisfy a tagging habit.

Practice lab: Using one complete year from . . /PYQ-Corpus-2013-2025 . md, run the Section 6/Section 7 (basic-file) checks on all eight prompts from one year within 15 minutes, and record which single prompt you would commit to and why, in two sentences.

Transfer task: Repeat the same 15-minute drill on the other year's eight prompts on a different day, and compare your reasoning consistency between the two attempts - log any drift in your criteria in 16's error log.

TOPIC 02 - Philosophical Quote Decoding

Complete foundational knowledge

Subject: Essay | **Tier:** Must-Do | **GS Paper:** Essay (General Studies Paper - Essay, Mains). **Core area:** Turning a compressed aphorism into a literal meaning, an operative tension, a defensible interpretation and a working thesis. **Grounded in:** UPSC Essay PYQ corpus - V1 directly verified locally for 2018-2025 and V2 carried-forward practice wording for 2013-2017 (see `../PYQ-Corpus-2013-2025.md`); `../00_Master-Framework.md` Section 4. **Research cutoff:** 18 July 2026. **Tags:** FACT: verified fact | ANALYSIS: strategy/inference | CURRENT: dated anchor | WRONG: trap/boundary. **Companion:** `../advanced/02_Philosophical-Quote-Decoding.md`

1. Purpose and scope

Most prompts in both audited years are single-sentence aphorisms (e.g. "Truth knows no color"; "Forests precede civilizations and deserts follow them"). This topic teaches a repeatable method to move from the literal sentence to a defensible essay-ready reading. It does not cover issue-based prompts like 2024-B5 (FOMO) - see 03 - or thesis construction proper - see 05.

2. Core terms in plain language

- **Literal meaning:** what the sentence says if read with no metaphorical extension.
- **Operative tension:** the underlying opposition the aphorism sets up (e.g. process vs. destination; restraint vs. action; simplicity vs. complexity).
- **Scope of the claim:** who or what the aphorism is really about once extended - an individual, an institution, a civilisation, or several at once.
- **Defensible interpretation:** a reading you can sustain for 1000-1200 words without contradicting the sentence's own wording.

3. FACT: Exam facts / source basis

- FACT: All 16 recent prompts (2024, 2025) are printed ****without any author attribution****; the full 100-prompt ledger, with each year's verification level, is `../PYQ-Corpus-2013-2025.md`.
- FACT: **Quote the paper, not the tidy version.** Read directly from the official PDFs, 2024-A2 prints "The empires of the **futures** will be the empires of the mind" and 2024-A3 prints "There is no path to happiness, Happiness is the path" - plural "futures", and a comma rather than a semicolon. Coaching reproductions commonly normalise both. WRONG: Do not.
- WRONG: A printing defect is not a hidden meaning. Decode the evident sense of the sentence; an essay arguing that "futures" (plural) signals multiple possible futures is answering a question the paper did not ask.
- ANALYSIS: Because no author is given, this folder treats every prompt as a **free-standing proposition to be interpreted on its own terms** - there is no "correct," externally sourced reading to recall.

3a. Philosophical prompt vs. issue prompt - which method applies

ANALYSIS: Deciding this in the first thirty seconds saves the whole attempt, because the two prompt types need different first moves.

	Philosophical prompt (this file, 02)	Issue prompt (03)
What it presents	A compressed proposition, usually metaphorical or definitional	A named real-world phenomenon plus an asserted causal/evaluative claim
Example	2025-B5 "Muddy water is best cleared by leaving it alone."	2024-B5, on social media, FOMO and youth distress
First move	Decode - literal claim, operative tension, scope	Scope - bound the specific claim, name the mechanism
Main risk	Restating the metaphor instead of interpreting it	Drifting into a GS survey of the subject area
What "evidence" does	Tests whether the decoded reading survives real cases	Substantiates or qualifies the asserted causal chain

WRONG: The boundary is not always clean: a prompt can be metaphorical in phrasing and empirical in reference (2024-A1, forests and deserts). ANALYSIS: Where it is genuinely hybrid, decode first and scope second - decoding a prompt that needed only scoping costs a minute; scoping a prompt that needed decoding produces an essay about the wrong subject. 03, Section 3a, gives a three-question test for the borderline cases.

4. The central idea and common misreading

ANALYSIS: **Central idea**: decoding means finding the *operative tension*, not just restating the sentence in different words. WRONG: **Common misreading**: treating the aphorism as a trivia prompt requiring a "clever" literary allusion, or assuming there is one single "official" interpretation to be guessed and matched - there is not; a well-argued, textually faithful reading is what the exam rewards.

5. Basic decomposition questions

1. What is the literal claim of the sentence?
2. What two ideas or states does the sentence place in relation to each other (e.g. forests/deserts; empires/mind; happiness/path)?
3. Is the relation causal ("precede... follow"), definitional ("is the path"), or comparative ("less than")?
4. What is the most natural non-literal reading that still respects the sentence's own words?
5. What would a *contrary* reading of the same sentence look like - and why would the straightforward reading still be more defensible?

5a. Claim-assumption-scope-exception test

ANALYSIS: Before treating a reading as your thesis, write four short lines:

Check	Question
Claim	What does the aphorism actually assert?
Assumption	What must be true for that assertion to hold?
Scope	At which scale or in which situation does it plausibly hold?
Exception	What counter-case limits it without emptying it of meaning?

This prevents a universal-sounding aphorism from becoming an absolute essay. The exception qualifies the claim; it must not replace the claim.

6. Dimension-expansion grid

Prompt (example)	Literal claim	Operative tension	Natural extended reading
2024-A1 "Forests precede civilizations and deserts follow them."	Ecological sequence: forest -> civilisation -> desert	Sustainable use vs. extractive overreach	Civilisations that exhaust ecological capital degrade their own foundations
2025-A1 "Truth knows no color."	Truth has no colour/­race	Objectivity vs. identity-inflected perception	Standards of evidence should not bend to race, ideology or partisanship
2025-B5 "Muddy water is best cleared by leaving it alone."	Undisturbed water settles and clears	Restraint vs. intervention	Some conflicts/­complex problems resolve better through patience than forceful action

Full method for turning this into a thesis: 05.

7. India-first illustration starters

ANALYSIS: For each decoded tension, recall (not invent) one Indian institutional, historical or social example that embodies each side of the tension - e.g. forest-cover policy debates for 2024-A1, or a documented public-conduct episode for "supreme art of war... without fighting" (2025-A2). Full verified-example discipline: 12.

8. Thesis options and selection

ANALYSIS: From the decoded tension, draft two or three alternative thesis sentences, not just one - e.g. for 2024-A3 ("Happiness is the path"): (a) happiness is a by-product of conduct, not an end-state to be chased; (b) policy that treats well-being as a future target rather than a present condition under-serves citizens. Choose the alternative you can qualify and defend most concretely. Full method: 05.

9. Simple essay architecture

ANALYSIS: A decoded aphorism typically supports: one paragraph establishing the literal-to-extended reading, two to four paragraphs developing distinct dimensions of the tension (see 04), one paragraph testing a counter-reading (see 08 cross-link to counterargument in that topic), and a conclusion resolving the tension into a synthesis. Full architecture: 07.

10. Opening, body and closure moves

ANALYSIS: A safe opening states the literal sentence's tension in your own words before extending it - this shows the examiner you have engaged with the actual text, not a generic essay on the "topic area." A safe closing returns to that same tension, now resolved by your argument. Full method: 06.

11. WRONG: Traps and repair moves

- **WRONG: Restating the sentence, not interpreting it.** -> Repair: always produce the operative tension (Section 5, Q2) before drafting a single paragraph.
- **WRONG: Inventing an author or source for the aphorism** to sound authoritative. -> Repair: since no author is printed (Section 3), never attribute one; use the prompt's own words as the reference point (full discipline: 09, 16).
- **WRONG: **Treating OCR noise as official wording - or "correcting" the paper into better English.**** Both are the same error in opposite directions. -> Repair: quote from . . /PYQ-Corpus-2013-2025.md's V1 rows, which reproduce the 2018-2025 papers as printed, defects included.

- **WRONG: Picking the first metaphorical reading that comes to mind** without testing a contrary reading. -> Repair: always run Section 5, Q5 before committing to a thesis.

12. Timed micro-drill and self-check

5-minute drill: Pick any prompt from . . /README . md's index you have not yet decoded. Write: (a) the literal claim, (b) the operative tension, (c) two alternative thesis sentences, (d) one contrary reading you considered and rejected, with a one-line reason.

Self-check: Does your thesis sentence use words that only make sense *because of* the prompt's own wording (a good sign), or could it be pasted onto almost any prompt about "change" or "society" in general (a sign of shallow decoding)?

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2024-2025 . md.

- **Years represented:** 2024, 2025
- **Paper(s):** Essay
- **Routed question demands:** 14

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (exact V1 wording)	Directive /​ format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	Essay	Section B - 2	"Nearly all men can stand adversity, but to test the character, give him power."	Essay · about 1000-1200 words; 2024 paper: 125 marks each	Routed to essay-method owner	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2024	Essay	Section A - 2	"The empires of the futures will be the empires of the mind."	Essay · about 1000-1200 words; 2024 paper: 125 marks each	Routed to essay-method owner	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2024	Essay	Section B - 3	"All ideas having large consequences are always simple."	Essay · about 1000-1200 words; 2024 paper: 125 marks each	Routed to essay-method owner	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2024	Essay	Section A - 3	"There is no path to happiness, Happiness is the path."	Essay · about 1000-1200 words; 2024 paper: 125 marks each	Routed to essay-method owner	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2024	Essay	Section B - 4	"The cost of being wrong is less than the cost of doing nothing."	Essay · about 1000-1200 words; 2024 paper: 125 marks each	Routed to essay-method owner	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2024	Essay	Section A - 4	"The doubter is a true man of science."	Essay · about 1000-1200 words; 2024 paper: 125 marks each	Routed to essay-method owner	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2025	Essay	Section A - 1	"Truth knows no color."	Essay · about 1000-1200 words; marks line not printed locally	Routed to essay-method owner	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (exact V1 wording)	Directive /​ format	Source status	Owner requirement
2025	Essay	Section A - 2	"The supreme art of war is to subdue the enemy without fighting."	Essay · about 1000-1200 words; marks line not printed locally	Routed to essay-method owner	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2025	Essay	Section A - 3	"Thought finds a world and creates one also."	Essay · about 1000-1200 words; marks line not printed locally	Routed to essay-method owner	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2025	Essay	Section A - 4	"Best lessons are learnt through bitter experiences."	Essay · about 1000-1200 words; marks line not printed locally	Routed to essay-method owner	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2025	Essay	Section B - 5	"Muddy water is best cleared by leaving it alone."	Essay · about 1000-1200 words; marks line not printed locally	Routed to essay-method owner	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2025	Essay	Section B - 6	"The years teach much which the days never know."	Essay · about 1000-1200 words; marks line not printed locally	Routed to essay-method owner	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2025	Essay	Section B - 7	"It is best to see life as a journey, not as a destination."	Essay · about 1000-1200 words; marks line not printed locally	Routed to essay-method owner	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2025	Essay	Section B - 8	"Contentment is natural wealth; luxury is artificial poverty."	Essay · about 1000-1200 words; marks line not printed locally	Routed to essay-method owner	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.

What this owner must now support

- "Nearly all men can stand adversity, but to test the character, give him power."
- "The empires of the futures will be the empires of the mind."
- "All ideas having large consequences are always simple."
- "There is no path to happiness, Happiness is the path."
- "The cost of being wrong is less than the cost of doing nothing."
- "The doubter is a true man of science."
- "Truth knows no color."
- "The supreme art of war is to subdue the enemy without fighting."
- "Thought finds a world and creates one also."
- "Best lessons are learnt through bitter experiences."
- "Muddy water is best cleared by leaving it alone."
- "The years teach much which the days never know."
- "It is best to see life as a journey, not as a destination."
- "Contentment is natural wealth; luxury is artificial poverty."

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Complete advanced knowledge

Subject: Essay | **Tier:** Advanced | **GS Paper:** Essay (General Studies Paper - Essay, Mains). **Core area:** Decoding aphorisms as compressed propositions with hidden scope and assumption structure; testing readings against counter-readings and exceptions before committing. **Grounded in:** UPSC Essay PYQ corpus - V1 directly verified locally for 2018-2025 and V2 carried-forward practice wording for 2013-2017 (see `../PYQ-Corpus-2013-2025.md`); `../00_Master-Framework.md` Section 4. **Research cutoff:** 18 July 2026. **Tags:** FACT: verified fact | ANALYSIS: strategy/inference | CURRENT: dated anchor | WRONG: trap/boundary. **Companion:** `../basic/02_Philosophical-Quote-Decoding.md`

1. Advanced proposition and boundary

Proposition: ANALYSIS: an aphorism is best treated as a compressed argument with an implicit premise, an implicit scope, and an implicit exception - decoding means making all three explicit before writing. **Boundary:** WRONG: this topic does not itself construct the final thesis or argument map (05/08) or select illustrations (12) - it supplies the reading that those stages operate on.

2. Concept definition and taxonomy

- **Metaphor-carrying aphorism** (e.g. "empires of the mind"; "muddy water"): requires identifying the vehicle (empire, water) and the tenor (power/knowledge; unresolved conflict/information) separately.
- **Comparative aphorism** (e.g. "the cost of being wrong is less than the cost of doing nothing"): requires identifying the two compared quantities precisely, not just gesturing at "action is good."
- **Definitional aphorism** (e.g. "happiness is the path"; "contentment is natural wealth"): asserts an identity between two concepts and should be tested for where the identity holds and where it breaks down.

3. Tension pairs and hidden assumptions

ANALYSIS: Every aphorism in the audited corpus carries at least one hidden assumption worth surfacing:

Prompt (example)	Hidden assumption	Why it matters
2024-A4 "The doubter is a true man of science."	Assumes doubt is disciplined (falsifiable, evidence-seeking), not indiscriminate	Undisciplined doubt (denialism) is not the same phenomenon; conflating them weakens the essay
2024-B7 "All ideas having large consequences are always simple."	Assumes simplicity of the <i>idea</i> , not of its <i>implementation</i>	An essay that treats "simple" as meaning "easy to execute" misreads the prompt
2025-A2 "Supreme art of war... without fighting."	Assumes "war" and "fighting" can be decoupled - conflict resolved by means other than force	A literal-military-only reading forecloses the richer diplomatic​social reading

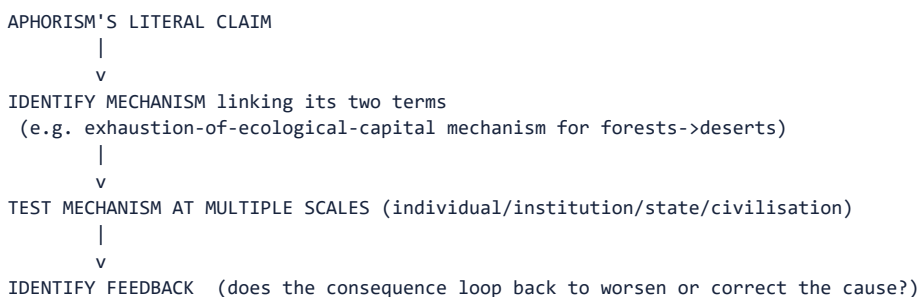
4. Levels of analysis and temporal-spatial scale

ANALYSIS: For each aphorism, check whether the operative tension holds at every scale or only some: individual (a person's private conduct), institutional (an organisation's incentives), state (public policy), and civilisational (long-run historical pattern). E.g. 2024-A1 (forests/ deserts) is most defensible at the civilisational/ecological scale; forcing it onto a purely individual-psychology reading strains the text.

5. Stakeholder map and distributional effects

ANALYSIS: Where a prompt has a clear social-policy extension (e.g. the issue-statement 2024-B5 on FOMO, or the aphorism 2025-A1 on truth/color), identify who is advantaged and disadvantaged by each candidate reading - e.g. a reading of "truth knows no color" that only defends institutional objectivity, without acknowledging that access to voice and evidence is unevenly distributed, is incomplete; a synthesis should hold both plural standpoint and common evidentiary standards together (cross-link 10).

6. Causality, mechanisms and feedback loops



ANALYSIS: A decoding that stops at "mechanism identified" without testing scale and feedback often yields a single-paragraph insight stretched thin across 1000+ words - the feedback-loop check is what generates enough material for a full essay without repetition.

7. Necessary/sufficient conditions and exceptions

ANALYSIS: Most aphorisms are stated as universal ("all ideas...always simple"; "nearly all men can stand adversity"), but a defensible essay usually argues a **near-universal tendency with a stated exception**, not an absolute law. E.g. for 2024-B7, an advanced reading grants that the moral/political *core* of a large-consequence idea is often simple (equality, dignity) while explicitly carving out the exception that *execution* is rarely simple - this exception is what prevents the essay from being a naive restatement of the prompt.

8. Paradox, dialectic and counterfactual test

Issue-prompt analogue (2024-B5, FOMO): connection technology that promises to reduce isolation can simultaneously produce loneliness - this is an issue-prompt double effect, not an aphorism to decode. Its analysis should hold both effects together in the synthesis. **Dialectic:** thesis (social media connects) -> counter-claim (social media isolates through comparison) -> condition/limit (effect depends on use-pattern, design and social context) -> synthesis (agency plus humane platform design). **Counterfactual test:** "If the mechanism I've identified were absent, would the aphorism's claim still hold?" - for 2025-B6 ("years teach... days never know"), remove *reflection*, and mere chronological age no longer teaches anything, showing reflection (not time alone) is the true mechanism.

9. Ethical conflict and synthesis

ANALYSIS: Several aphorisms compress an ethical conflict: 2024-B6 (power tests character) sets discretionary power against personal virtue; 2025-B8 (contentment vs. luxury) sets sufficiency against aspiration. An advanced reading names the values in tension explicitly (accountability vs. autonomy; sufficiency vs. legitimate aspiration) rather than treating one side as simply wrong - full framework in 10.

10. Evidence/source-risk and India application

FACT: No prompt in either audited year carries a printed author (see . . /README . md); an advanced candidate should resist the temptation to attribute a "likely" author from memory, since misattribution is a credibility risk with no compensating benefit - the prompt's own wording is sufficient warrant. ANALYSIS: India-application at the decoding stage means testing the reading against one recallable Indian case *before* finalising the thesis, to check the reading is not merely a Western or abstract-philosophical exercise (12).

11. Advanced structure, paragraph sequencing and style

ANALYSIS: A decoded aphorism with a tested exception (Section 7) and a paradox resolved into synthesis (Section 8) naturally sequences into: literal reading -> mechanism -> scale-test -> exception/counter-case -> synthesis - this sequence should map directly onto paragraph clusters in 07, avoiding the common advanced-writer error of over-elaborating the decoding in prose (spending three paragraphs "explaining what the quote means" before any argument begins).

12. WRONG: Failure modes and revision protocol

- WRONG: **Over-literal reading** that refuses to extend the metaphor at all
(e.g. treating "forests precede civilizations" as only about forestry policy). -> Protocol: always test at least one scale beyond the literal (Section 4).
- WRONG: **Over-extension** that loses contact with the sentence's own words
(e.g. turning "muddy water" into an essay solely about foreign policy with no reference to restraint/patience). -> Protocol: re-anchor each paragraph's claim to the literal sentence at least once.
- WRONG: **Treating the hidden assumption as the whole thesis** rather than a qualification. -> Protocol: state the assumption, then still argue a substantive claim built on top of it.

13. CURRENT: Dated anchor / practice lab / transfer task

CURRENT: **Dated anchor**: not applicable as a standing fact - decoding method is stable; do not force a current-affairs date into this topic.

Practice lab: Take any three prompts from . . /README . md you find hardest to decode. For each, write the mechanism (Section 6), one exception (Section 7) and one paradox or dialectic line (Section 8) in under 15 minutes total.

Transfer task: Re-run the same three prompts a week later without looking at your first attempt; compare whether your mechanism/exception identification is consistent, and log any drift in 16's error log.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance**: Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023 . md.

- **Years represented**: 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023
- **Paper(s)**: Essay
- **Routed question demands**: 33

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive /​ format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	Essay	2	A good life is one inspired by love and guided by knowledge	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/8203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2018	Essay	3	Poverty anywhere is a threat to prosperity everywhere	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/8203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2018	Essay	5	Customary morality cannot be a guide to modern life	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; section header OCR-read as SECTION-E in this scan	Use as a brainstorming/8203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2018	Essay	6	The past as a permanent dimension of human consciousness and values	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/8203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2018	Essay	7	A people that values its privileges above its principles loses both	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/8203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2018	Essay	8	Reality does not conform to the ideal but confirms it	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/8203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2019	Essay	1	Wisdom finds truth	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/8203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2019	Essay	2	Values are not what humanity is but what humanity ought to be	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/8203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2019	Essay	4	Courage to accept and dedication to improve as two keys to success	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/8203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2020	Essay	1	Life is a long journey between human being and being humane	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/8203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2020	Essay	2	Mindful manifesto as the catalyst to a tranquil self	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/8203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive /​ format	Source status	Owner requirement
2020	Essay	3	Ships sink because of the water that gets into them	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2020	Essay	4	Simplicity is the ultimate sophistication	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2020	Essay	5	Culture is what we are, civilization is what we have	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2021	Essay	1	The process of self-discovery as technologically outsourced	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2021	Essay	2	Perception of me as a reflection of you and reaction as awareness	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2021	Essay	3	Philosophy of wantlessness as Utopian and materialism as chimera	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2021	Essay	4	The real is rational and the rational is real	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2021	Essay	5	The hand that rocks the cradle rules the world	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2021	Essay	6	What is research but a blind date with knowledge	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2021	Essay	7	History repeats itself first as tragedy then as farce	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2022	Essay	2	Poets as the unacknowledged legislators of the world	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive /​ format	Source status	Owner requirement
2022	Essay	3	History as victories of the scientific man over the romantic man	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/8203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2022	Essay	4	A ship in harbour is safe but that is not what a ship is for	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/8203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2022	Essay	5	The time to repair the roof is when the sun is shining	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/8203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2022	Essay	6	You cannot step twice in the same river	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/8203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2022	Essay	7	A smile as the chosen vehicle for all ambiguities	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/8203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2023	Essay	1	Thinking as a game that needs an opposite team	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/8203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2023	Essay	2	Visionary decision-making at the intersection of intuition and logic	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/8203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2023	Essay	3	Not all who wander are lost	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/8203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2023	Essay	4	Inspiration for creativity from looking for the magical in the mundane	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/8203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2023	Essay	6	Mathematics is the music of reason	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/8203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2023	Essay	8	Education as what remains after one forgets what was learned	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/8203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.

What this owner must now support

- A good life is one inspired by love and guided by knowledge
- Poverty anywhere is a threat to prosperity everywhere
- Customary morality cannot be a guide to modern life
- The past as a permanent dimension of human consciousness and values
- A people that values its privileges above its principles loses both
- Reality does not conform to the ideal but confirms it
- Wisdom finds truth
- Values are not what humanity is but what humanity ought to be
- Courage to accept and dedication to improve as two keys to success
- Life is a long journey between human being and being humane
- Mindful manifesto as the catalyst to a tranquil self
- Ships sink because of the water that gets into them
- Simplicity is the ultimate sophistication
- Culture is what we are, civilization is what we have
- The process of self-discovery as technologically outsourced
- Perception of me as a reflection of you and reaction as awareness
- Philosophy of wantlessness as Utopian and materialism as chimera
- The real is rational and the rational is real
- The hand that rocks the cradle rules the world
- What is research but a blind date with knowledge
- History repeats itself first as tragedy then as farce
- Poets as the unacknowledged legislators of the world
- History as victories of the scientific man over the romantic man
- A ship in harbour is safe but that is not what a ship is for
- The time to repair the roof is when the sun is shining
- You cannot step twice in the same river
- A smile as the chosen vehicle for all ambiguities
- Thinking as a game that needs an opposite team
- Visionary decision-making at the intersection of intuition and logic
- Not all who wander are lost
- Inspiration for creativity from looking for the magical in the mundane
- Mathematics is the music of reason
- Education as what remains after one forgets what was learned

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

TOPIC 03 - Issue-Based Prompt Scoping

Complete foundational knowledge

Subject: Essay | **Tier:** Must-Do | **GS Paper:** Essay (General Studies Paper - Essay, Mains). **Core area:** Scoping empirical/social-policy prompts (e.g. the FOMO prompt) as essays, not GS answers - issue framing, boundary-setting, and avoiding scheme-listing. **Grounded in:** UPSC Essay PYQ corpus - V1 directly verified locally for 2018-2025 and V2 carried-forward practice wording for 2013-2017 (see `../PYQ-Corpus-2013-2025.md`); `../00_Master-Framework.md` Section 4. **Research cutoff:** 18 July 2026. **Tags:** FACT: verified fact | ANALYSIS: strategy/inference | CURRENT: dated anchor | WRONG: trap/boundary. **Companion:** `../advanced/03_Issue-Based-Prompt-Scoping.md`

1. Purpose and scope

A clear audited example - 2024-B5, printed as "Social media is triggering 'Fear of Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness" - is an issue-statement rather than a philosophical aphorism: it names a real phenomenon, a mechanism and a consequence directly. This topic teaches how to scope such prompts as an essay *argument*, distinct from 02's aphorism-decoding and distinct from a GS-III/Society answer.

2. Core terms in plain language

- **Issue-statement prompt:** a prompt that names a real-world phenomenon and asserts a causal or evaluative claim about it, without requiring metaphor-decoding.
- **Scope creep:** letting the essay drift into a general survey of the subject area (e.g. "social media in India") instead of the specific asserted claim.
- **GS-answer collapse:** structuring the essay like a GS-I/II/III answer - headings, "causes/effects/measures taken" lists - rather than a continuous argued essay.

3. FACT: Exam facts / source basis

- FACT: 2024-B5 is printed exactly as: "Social media is triggering 'Fear of Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness." - no author, and **no comma before "precipitating"** (widely circulated versions insert one; the paper does not). No further qualifying data is attached in the source paper.
- FACT: It is printed as **item 1 of Section B** in the 2024 paper, which restarts Section B numbering at 1; B5 is this folder's internal label (see `../README.md`).
- ANALYSIS: The missing comma slightly changes what is asserted: without it, "precipitating depression and loneliness" reads as attached to the FOMO it triggers rather than as a separate consequence of social media. FACT: Either way the essay must engage the *causal chain the sentence asserts* - social media -> FOMO -> depression/loneliness - and WRONG: not substitute a general discussion of social media's effects.
- ANALYSIS: Within the 2024-2025 paper pair, this is the only direct, unmetaphorical issue-statement; the remaining 15 prompts are decoded via 02. This is **not** a claim about the whole V1 corpus: 2018-2025 contains further issue and hybrid prompts requiring the same method.

3a. Is this actually an issue prompt? - a three-question test

ANALYSIS: basic/02, Section 3a, gives the full philosophical-vs-issue contrast table. This section does not repeat it; it supplies the decision procedure for the one call you have to make under time pressure.

- Q1 Does the sentence name a real, nameable phenomenon (social media, urbanisation, automation) rather than an abstraction?
 - no -> philosophical prompt: decode it (02)
 - yes -> continue
- Q2 Does it assert a causal or evaluative claim ABOUT that phenomenon ("is triggering", "has lost the ability to", "is a threat to")?
 - no -> a bare topic label, not an issue-statement: treat as a scoping-plus-decoding hybrid, decoding first
 - yes -> continue
- Q3 Would a literal reading of the sentence already give you something contestable to argue?
 - yes -> issue prompt: scope it (this file)
 - no -> the sentence only looks empirical; decode first (02)

ANALYSIS: Q3 is the one candidates skip. 2024-A1 ("Forests precede civilizations and deserts follow them") passes Q1 and arguably Q2, but fails Q3 - read literally it is a claim about vegetation sequence that nobody would spend 1000 words contesting. That failure is the signal that the sentence is carrying a metaphor, and that 02 owns it. WRONG: Scoping a prompt that needed decoding produces a technically accurate essay about the wrong subject - the most expensive error available at this stage, because it is invisible until the essay is finished.

4. The central idea and common misreading

ANALYSIS: **Central idea:** an issue-based prompt still needs a *thesis*, not just an accurate description of the phenomenon - the essay must argue something about the claim (its mechanism, its limits, what follows), not merely narrate it. WRONG: **Common misreading:** treating 2024-B5 as an invitation to write a GS-III/Society-style answer on social media's "causes, effects and government measures" complete with scheme names and headings - this under-uses the essay's actual test of argument and synthesis.

5. Basic decomposition questions

1. What exact claim is being made - connection causes FOMO causes depression/loneliness - and is this an absolute or a tendency claim?
2. What is the mechanism linking cause to effect (e.g. social comparison, curated self-presentation, algorithmic amplification)?
3. Who is most affected, and does the prompt's "youth" framing hold uniformly or need qualification (e.g. by access, platform design, family/school context)?
4. What is the strongest counter-case (e.g. social media also enabling support communities, information access, civic mobilisation)?
5. What synthesis resolves the tension without denying either the harm or the benefit?

5a. Causal-evidence-limit chain

ANALYSIS: Treat each asserted causal link as an argument to test, not as a fact to repeat:

- PROMPT CLAIM
- > plausible mechanism
 - > named, verifiable evidence or illustration
 - > what that evidence supports (not more)
 - > mediator, counter-case or limit
 - > qualified thesis

An association is not proof of causation. If you cannot name evidence, state the mechanism and the limit qualitatively rather than inventing a statistic or presenting correlation as settled proof.

6. Dimension-expansion grid

Dimension	Content for 2024-B5
Individual/psychological	Social comparison, curated self-image, validation-seeking
Family/community	Parental awareness, peer culture, offline-relationship displacement
Institutional/platform	Algorithmic design incentives, engagement-maximising features
State/policy	Digital literacy programmes, platform accountability debates
Ethical/values	Autonomy vs. protection of minors; free expression vs. harm mitigation

7. India-first illustration starters

ANALYSIS: Recall (not invent) a named, verifiable Indian illustration relevant to youth mental health, digital literacy or student smartphone use. Use it as functional evidence for one dimension above, not as a scheme-listing exercise. Full discipline: 12.

8. Thesis options and selection

ANALYSIS: Sample alternative theses for 2024-B5: (a) social media's design, not connectivity itself, is the primary driver of FOMO-linked distress, implying design/regulatory responses; (b) FOMO reflects a pre-existing social-comparison tendency that technology has amplified rather than created, implying that literacy and self-regulation matter alongside platform reform. Choose the one you can sustain with real illustrations and a genuine counter-case. Full method: 05.

9. Simple essay architecture

ANALYSIS: A workable shape: one paragraph framing the phenomenon and its scale without invented statistics, two to three paragraphs developing distinct mechanisms/dimensions (Section 6), one paragraph testing the counter-case (Section 5, Q4), and a synthesis conclusion (agency + literacy + humane platform design) - not a "conclusion" that merely lists more government schemes. Full architecture: 07.

10. Opening, body and closure moves

ANALYSIS: A safe opening states the tension (connectivity promising closeness while producing isolation) in your own words, without a fabricated anecdote. A safe closing resolves the tension into a forward-looking, feasible synthesis - not a list of five recommendations in bullet form. Full method: 06.

11. WRONG: Traps and repair moves

- **WRONG: Writing a GS-III/Society answer** with headings and a "government measures" list. -> Repair: keep the piece as one continuous argued essay; use 07's paragraph-flow method instead of headings.
 - **WRONG: Treating "youth" as a monolith** ignoring access/context variation. -> Repair: qualify claims by access, platform design, and social context (Section 6).
 - **WRONG: One-sided moralising against social media** without the counter-case. -> Repair: always include Section 5's Q4 counter-case before the synthesis.
 - **WRONG: Citing unverifiable statistics** on depression/loneliness rates.
- > Repair: describe mechanism and pattern in qualitative terms rather than inventing a number (full discipline: 09).

12. Timed micro-drill and self-check

5-minute drill: For 2024-B5, write one sentence each for: the mechanism, the strongest counter-case, and your chosen thesis. Then write one Indian illustration you can genuinely recall (not invent) that functions as evidence for your mechanism.

Transfer drills - unfamiliar prompts: These are practice prompts, not claims supplied as facts.

1. *"Remote work has improved productivity while weakening workplace community."* Identify each causal link, one mediator, one counter-case and the qualified thesis.

2. *"When algorithms choose, responsibility does not disappear."* Decide whether the prompt is issue-based, philosophical or hybrid; then map mechanism -> named evidence -> limit before planning dimensions.

Self-check: Does your plan contain any heading, numbered list, or "government schemes" section that belongs in a GS answer rather than a continuous essay? If yes, remove it and rewrite that portion as connected prose.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2024-2025.md.

- **Years represented:** 2024
- **Paper(s):** Essay
- **Routed question demands:** 2

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (exact V1 wording)	Directive /​format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	Essay	Section A - 1	"Forests precede civilizations and deserts follow them."	Essay · about 1000-1200 words; 2024 paper: 125 marks each	Routed to essay-method owner	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2024	Essay	Section B - 1	"Social media is triggering 'Fear of Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness."	Essay · about 1000-1200 words; 2024 paper: 125 marks each	Routed to essay-method owner	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.

What this owner must now support

- "Forests precede civilizations and deserts follow them."
- "Social media is triggering 'Fear of Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness."

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Subject: Essay | **Tier:** Advanced | **GS Paper:** Essay (General Studies Paper - Essay, Mains). **Core area:** The scope-discipline that separates an issue-based essay from a GS answer; distributional and mechanism-level analysis of the FOMO/social-media prompt as the corpus's clearest test case. **Grounded in:** UPSC Essay PYQ corpus - V1 directly verified locally for 2018-2025 and V2 carried-forward practice wording for 2013-2017 (see `../PYQ-Corpus-2013-2025.md`; `../00_Master-Framework.md` Section 4). **Research cutoff:** 18 July 2026. **Tags:** FACT: verified fact | ANALYSIS: strategy/inference | CURRENT: dated anchor | WRONG: trap/boundary. **Companion:** `../basic/03_Issue-Based-Prompt-Scoping.md`

1. Advanced proposition and boundary

Proposition: ANALYSIS: an issue-based essay prompt differs from a GS answer not in subject matter but in *test-of-argument* - the examiner already expects the candidate to know the phenomenon; what is tested is whether the candidate can build a qualified thesis and a synthesis around it. **Boundary:** WRONG: this topic does not supply the platform-design or mental-health mechanism content itself in GS depth (owned by Indian-Society and Science-and-Technology); it supplies the essay-specific scoping discipline that keeps that content in service of an argument.

2. Concept definition and taxonomy

- **Issue-statement prompt:** names phenomenon + mechanism + consequence in one sentence (2024-B5 is the corpus's example).
- **Scope creep:** essay drifts from the *specific* asserted mechanism ("FOMO... precipitating depression and loneliness") into a general survey of "social media in society."
- **GS-answer collapse:** headings, "causes/effects/measures" structure, and scheme-name lists substituted for continuous argument.
- **ANALYSIS:** Note the taxonomy is not unique to 2024-B5 - any future issue-style prompt (on, say, urbanisation, automation, or misinformation) should be scoped by the same method.

3. Tension pairs and hidden assumptions

- **Causal specificity vs. generality:** the prompt asserts a specific mechanism (FOMO precipitating depression/loneliness); the hidden assumption in a weak essay is that any social-media-related content answers the question - it does not, unless it engages that specific causal chain.
- **Universality vs. distribution:** "the youth" is treated as homogeneous by the prompt's phrasing; an advanced essay should interrogate this - access, platform type, family context, and pre-existing vulnerability all mediate the effect differently.
- **Correlation vs. mechanism:** a common hidden assumption is that observed association between usage and distress implies the causal story asserted by the prompt; an advanced essay should explicitly discuss plausible mechanism (social comparison, curated self-presentation, algorithmic amplification of engagement) rather than assert correlation as proof.

4. Levels of analysis and temporal-spatial scale

Level	What the essay should say at this level
Individual	Social comparison, self-esteem, validation-seeking behaviour
Family/Community	Parental mediation, peer culture, offline-relationship displacement
Institutional/Platform	Design incentives (engagement metrics), content-recommendation systems
State/Policy	Digital literacy programmes, platform-accountability debate, age-appropriate design
Temporal	Whether the effect is a stable feature of always-on connectivity or an artefact of a particular platform-design era, subject to future design change

5. Stakeholder map and distributional effects

ANALYSIS: Distinguish: (a) youth users directly affected; (b) platforms whose business model may depend on engagement-maximising design; (c) families and schools bearing mediation responsibility; (d) the state, balancing free expression against protective regulation. An advanced essay should show that responsibility is distributed across these actors, rather than locating blame in only one (e.g. "youth today" moralising, or purely "Big Tech" moralising) - both are one-sided versions of the same scope-collapse error.

6. Causality, mechanisms and feedback loops

```
ALGORITHMIC DESIGN (engagement-optimised feeds)
|
v
SOCIAL COMPARISON + CURATED SELF-PRESENTATION exposure increases
|
v
FOMO / INADEQUACY perception rises
|
v
INCREASED USAGE (seeking validation/relief) <----- FEEDBACK LOOP
|
v
DEPRESSION / LONELINESS risk (mediated by support, literacy, context)
```

ANALYSIS: The feedback loop (increased distress driving increased, not decreased, usage) is the analytically richest part of this prompt - naming it distinguishes an advanced essay from one that treats the relationship as simple and linear.

7. Necessary/sufficient conditions and exceptions

ANALYSIS: Social media use is not sufficient by itself to cause depression/ loneliness - the mechanism is mediated by design, context, and pre-existing vulnerability (Section 4); nor is abstinence necessary for protection - supportive use (e.g. maintaining distant relationships, accessing peer support) can supply a counter-case. An advanced essay states this precisely rather than treating the prompt's claim as an absolute law to be defended or attacked wholesale.

8. Paradox, dialectic and counterfactual test

Paradox: the same technology that promises connection can produce isolation - not a contradiction, but a double effect depending on use pattern and design. **Dialectic:** thesis (connectivity precipitates distress) -> counter-claim (connectivity also provides support, information and civic voice) -> condition (effect depends on design and use-pattern) -> synthesis (agency, literacy and humane platform design as joint correctives). **Counterfactual test:** "If platforms were designed without engagement-maximising feeds, would the FOMO mechanism (Section

6. still operate at the same intensity?" - a "no" strengthens the design-focused thesis; a "largely yes" strengthens a thesis centred on underlying social-comparison psychology.

9. Ethical conflict and synthesis

ANALYSIS: Values in tension: individual autonomy and free expression vs. protective regulation of minors; platform commercial interest vs. user well-being; parental oversight vs. adolescent privacy. **Synthesis:** locate responsibility across the distributed stakeholder map (Section

5. - literacy and self-regulation at the individual/family level, accountable design at the platform level, and proportionate, rights-respecting safeguards at the policy level - rather than resolving the conflict by favouring one actor's interest alone.

10. Evidence/source-risk and India application

FACT: The prompt itself supplies no statistic and no author; an advanced essay should resist supplying an invented one either. ANALYSIS: India application: use a named, verifiable Indian illustration where available; otherwise state the policy debate qualitatively without asserting an unverified national prevalence figure - full discipline in 09/12.

11. Advanced structure, paragraph sequencing and style

ANALYSIS: Recommended sequencing: phenomenon and tension (1 paragraph) -> mechanism and feedback loop (Section 6, 2 paragraphs) -> distributional analysis across stakeholders (Section 5, 1-2 paragraphs) -> counter-case and dialectic (Section 8, 1 paragraph) -> synthesis and forward-looking close (1 paragraph). This keeps the essay argumentative throughout, rather than descriptive-then-prescriptive in the GS-answer style.

12. WRONG: Failure modes and revision protocol

- WRONG: **Full GS-III/Society answer disguised as an essay** (headings, scheme lists). -> Protocol: remove all headings; verify every paragraph contains a claim, not just a fact.
- WRONG: **Treating "youth" as undifferentiated**. -> Protocol: qualify by at least one distributional variable (Section 5) in the essay body.
- WRONG: **Correlation-as-causation without mechanism**. -> Protocol: state the mechanism (Section 6) explicitly before asserting the causal claim.
- WRONG: **One-sided technology-moralising** (either "social media is simply bad" or "concerns are overblown"). -> Protocol: always include the dialectic step (Section 8) before the conclusion.

13. CURRENT: Dated anchor / practice lab / transfer task

CURRENT: **Dated anchor:** if a genuinely current, dated official statement on platform regulation or youth digital-safety policy is available and verifiable at the time of writing, it may be cited with its source and date; otherwise, describe the policy debate in general, undated terms rather than inventing a "latest" development.

Practice lab: Write the mechanism diagram (Section 6) and the distributional stakeholder list (Section 5) for 2024-B5 from memory in under 10 minutes, without consulting this file.

Transfer task: Apply the same scoping method (phenomenon -> mechanism -> distribution -> dialectic -> synthesis) to a hypothetical future issue-style prompt (e.g. on automation or misinformation) to confirm the method generalises beyond this one audited prompt.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2018, 2019, 2020, 2023
- **Paper(s):** Essay
- **Routed question demands:** 9

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive /​ format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	Essay	1	Alternative technologies for a climate change resilient India	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2018	Essay	4	Management of Indian border disputes as a complex task	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2019	Essay	5	South Asian societies woven around plural cultures and identities	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2019	Essay	6	Neglect of primary health care and education as reasons for backwardness	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2019	Essay	7	Biased media as a real threat to Indian democracy	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2019	Essay	8	Rise of Artificial Intelligence, jobless future or reskilling opportunity	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2020	Essay	7	Patriarchy as the least noticed structure of social inequality	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2020	Essay	8	Technology as the silent factor in international relations	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2023	Essay	5	Girls weighed down by restrictions and boys by demands	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.

What this owner must now support

- Alternative technologies for a climate change resilient India
- Management of Indian border disputes as a complex task
- South Asian societies woven around plural cultures and identities
- Neglect of primary health care and education as reasons for backwardness
- Biased media as a real threat to Indian democracy
- Rise of Artificial Intelligence, jobless future or reskilling opportunity
- Patriarchy as the least noticed structure of social inequality

- Technology as the silent factor in international relations
- Girls weighed down by restrictions and boys by demands

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

TOPIC 04 - Brainstorming and Dimensional Expansion

Complete foundational knowledge

Subject: Essay | **Tier:** Must-Do | **GS Paper:** Essay (General Studies Paper - Essay, Mains). **Core area:** Generating genuinely distinct dimensions from a decoded prompt - scale, time, domain and effect-direction - without padding with repetitive restatements. **Grounded in:** UPSC Essay PYQ corpus - V1 directly verified locally for 2018-2025 and V2 carried-forward practice wording for 2013-2017 (see `../PYQ-Corpus-2013-2025.md`); `../00_Master-Framework.md` Section 5. **Research cutoff:** 18 July 2026. **Tags:** FACT: verified fact | ANALYSIS: strategy/inference | CURRENT: dated anchor | WRONG: trap/boundary. **Companion:** `../advanced/04_Brainstorming-and-Dimensional-Expansion.md`

1. Purpose and scope

Once a prompt is decoded (02/03), this topic teaches how to generate enough genuinely distinct material to sustain 1000-1200 words without repetition. It does not build the thesis itself (05) - it supplies the raw dimensional material the thesis will select from and organise.

2. Core terms in plain language

- **Dimension:** a genuinely distinct angle on the prompt's tension - not a rephrasing of an angle already used.
- **Scale axis:** person -> family/community -> institution -> state -> global order -> civilisation.
- **Time axis:** historical origin -> present manifestation -> plausible future trajectory.
- **Domain axis:** material/economic, institutional/governance, ethical/values, ecological, digital/technological, cultural.

3. FACT: Exam facts / source basis

- **FACT:** Both audited years supply eight prompts each (four per Section); see `../README.md` for verbatim wording. Word range is 1000-1200 per essay in both years.
- **ANALYSIS:** Neither paper specifies how many dimensions or paragraphs an essay should contain - this folder's guidance on dimension count is a pedagogical heuristic, not an official requirement.

4. The central idea and common misreading

ANALYSIS: Central idea: expand only until the thesis is well-supported by two to four genuinely distinct dimensions - quality and distinctness matter more than quantity. **WRONG: Common misreading:** listing every possible angle mechanically ("past-present-future," "social-economic- political-environmental") as a template, producing four paragraphs that say the same thing in different vocabulary.

5. Basic decomposition questions

1. Which scale does the prompt's tension operate at most naturally (Section 2)?
2. Does the tension look different at an earlier historical moment than it does today?
3. Which domain (material, institutional, ethical, ecological, digital, cultural) does the prompt's tension most concretely touch?
4. For each candidate dimension, can you state one distinct claim (not a restatement of another dimension's claim)?
5. Which two or three dimensions, taken together, best support the thesis you are leaning toward (see 05)?

5a. Keep filter: coherence, evidence and limitation

ANALYSIS: Keep a dimension only when it passes every link in this chain:

distinct claim

- > explains a mechanism
- > has a named, verifiable illustration
- > carries a relevant limit or counter-case
- > moves the same central thesis forward

Compare the final link across all kept dimensions. If one dimension does not help prove the same thesis, it is a parallel mini-essay, not useful breadth. If the illustration is not recallable safely, park the dimension rather than padding the essay.

6. Dimension-expansion grid

Prompt (example)	Scale dimension	Time dimension	Domain dimension
2024-A2 "Empires of the mind"	Individual (education) -> institution (research) -> state (strategic autonomy)	Industrial-era physical empires -> knowledge-era power	Digital/technological (platform power, misinformation)
2025-B8 "Contentment... luxury"	Individual (consumption choices) -> society (status competition)	-	Ecological (footprint of consumption); ethical (sufficiency vs. aspiration)
2024-A1 "Forests...deserts"	Civilisation-level	Historical (past extractive civilisations) -> present (development choices) -> future (regeneration)	Ecological; institutional (policy)

7. India-first illustration starters

ANALYSIS: For each selected dimension, recall one Indian illustration that makes it concrete rather than abstract - e.g. education/research policy for the "empires of the mind" institutional dimension, or a documented consumption/sustainability pattern for the contentment/luxury domain dimension. Full discipline: 12.

8. Thesis options and selection

ANALYSIS: Use the two to three strongest dimensions (not all available ones) to build alternative thesis sentences, then pick the one with the most coherent support. Over-broad brainstorming without a filter is the most common cause of a diffuse, unfocused essay. Full method: 05.

9. Simple essay architecture

ANALYSIS: Map each selected dimension onto one or two paragraphs in sequence - typically ordered from the most immediate/individual to the broadest/ civilisational, or vice versa, whichever creates a clearer build toward the conclusion. Full architecture: 07.

10. Opening, body and closure moves

ANALYSIS: The opening should signal which dimensions the essay will develop (without a mechanical "in this essay I will discuss..." announcement); the closure should show how the developed dimensions combine into the final synthesis. Full method: 06.

11. WRONG: Traps and repair moves

- **WRONG: Template-driven padding** (mechanically listing

"social-economic-political-environmental" regardless of fit). -> Repair: only use a dimension that yields a genuinely distinct claim (Section 5, Q4).

- **WRONG: Repetition dressed as expansion** (four paragraphs restating the same point in different vocabulary). -> Repair: before drafting, write one claim-sentence per intended paragraph and check none duplicate.

- **WRONG: Over-expansion** (eight dimensions, each underdeveloped in one or two sentences). -> Repair: cut to two-to-four dimensions and develop each with mechanism and illustration.

12. Timed micro-drill and self-check

5-minute drill: For any prompt from . . /README .md, list four candidate dimensions across scale, time, domain and effect-direction. Cross out any that would restate another; keep only the genuinely distinct ones.

Self-check: Could you swap the content of two of your "distinct" dimensions and the essay would read almost the same? If so, one of them is not actually distinct - replace it.

Complete advanced knowledge

Subject: Essay | **Tier:** Advanced | **GS Paper:** Essay (General Studies Paper - Essay, Mains). **Core area:** Disciplined dimension-generation using scale, time, domain and distributional axes together; detecting and pruning false expansion. **Grounded in:** UPSC Essay PYQ corpus - V1 directly verified locally for 2018-2025 and V2 carried-forward practice wording for 2013-2017 (see . . /PYQ-Corpus-2013-2025 .md); . . /00_Master-Framework .md Section 5. **Research cutoff:** 18 July 2026. **Tags:** FACT: verified fact | ANALYSIS: strategy/inference | CURRENT: dated anchor | WRONG: trap/boundary. **Companion:** . . /basic/04_Brainstorming-and-Dimensional-Expansion .md

1. Advanced proposition and boundary

Proposition: ANALYSIS: dimensional expansion is a search-and-prune process, not a listing exercise - the value is in discarding dimensions that restate an existing claim, not in maximising the count generated. **Boundary:** WRONG: this topic does not itself decide which dimensions to keep for the final thesis (05) or how to sequence them into paragraphs (07) - it supplies a disciplined generation-and-filtering method.

2. Concept definition and taxonomy

- **Genuine dimension:** yields a distinct claim, testable independently of the other dimensions chosen.
- **False dimension:** a relabelling of an existing dimension in different vocabulary (e.g. "social" and "community" angles that actually make the same point).
- **Axis:** a generative category (scale, time, domain, distributional effect) used to search for dimensions - not itself a dimension.

3. Tension pairs and hidden assumptions

- **Breadth vs. depth:** the hidden assumption that more dimensions signals more depth is false; four shallow dimensions read as thinner than two deeply developed ones.
- **Breadth vs. coherence:** a distinct and more dangerous trade-off than breadth vs. depth. Breadth asks *how many* distinct angles the essay covers; coherence asks whether those angles **build one argument**. An essay can be broad *and* deep and still be incoherent - three well-developed dimensions that never speak to each other are three essays sharing a title. ANALYSIS: The diagnostic: state each kept dimension's claim in one line, then ask whether the second claim would change if the first were false. If not, you have breadth without coherence, and 07's sequencing will not rescue it - the fix belongs here, at selection.
- **Template completeness vs. relevance:** the assumption that every axis (scale/time/domain/distribution) must be represented is false - some prompts (e.g. 2025-B5, "muddy water") are richer on the individual-to-institutional scale axis than on the time axis, and forcing a historical dimension can feel manufactured.

4. Levels of analysis and temporal-spatial scale

ANALYSIS: Use the scale axis (person -> family/community -> institution -> state -> global order -> civilisation) as the primary generative tool, and treat time (historical -> present -> future) and domain (material/institutional/ethical/ecological/digital/cultural) as secondary filters applied *within* a chosen scale, not as independent axes to expand separately - this avoids a combinatorial explosion of thin dimensions.

5. Stakeholder map and distributional effects

ANALYSIS: For prompts with a clear social dimension (2024-B5 FOMO, 2025-A1 truth/ color, 2025-B8 contentment/luxury), an advanced expansion should include at least one **distributional** dimension: who benefits and who bears the cost of the phenomenon described, disaggregated by at least one relevant axis (income, access, institutional power) - this is often the dimension most likely to be missing from a template-driven basic expansion.

6. Causality, mechanisms and feedback loops

```
CANDIDATE DIMENSION
|
v
STATE ITS CLAIM IN ONE SENTENCE
|
v
COMPARE against every other kept dimension's claim-sentence
|
duplicate? -----> DISCARD
|
v (distinct)
DOES IT HAVE A MECHANISM AND A RECALLABLE ILLUSTRATION? --no--> WEAKEN/PARK
|
yes
v
KEEP for thesis stage (05)
```

ANALYSIS: This filter should be run explicitly, even briefly, rather than trusted to intuition - most padding is produced by skipping the duplicate-claim check under time pressure.

7. Necessary/sufficient conditions and exceptions

ANALYSIS: Two to four genuine dimensions are typically *sufficient* to sustain 1000-1200 words when each is developed with mechanism and illustration; more dimensions are not necessary and often reduce quality by forcing shallower treatment of each. **Exception:** a prompt with an unusually rich distributional structure (e.g. 2024-B5) may sustain more dimensions if each remains genuinely distinct and well-developed.

8. Paradox, dialectic and counterfactual test

Paradox: the instinct to "cover more ground" for safety often produces a *less* safe essay, because thin, generic paragraphs are easier to penalise for vagueness than two or three well-argued ones. **Counterfactual test:** "If I deleted this dimension entirely, would the essay lose a genuinely distinct claim, or only lose a restatement?" If the latter, the dimension was false expansion (Section 2) and should be cut regardless of how much was already drafted around it.

9. Ethical conflict and synthesis

ANALYSIS: There is a minor integrity dimension here: presenting four paragraphs as covering "multiple dimensions" when they in fact restate one point risks overstating the essay's actual analytical range - the discipline of Section 6's filter is also a form of honest self-presentation, not merely a stylistic preference.

10. Evidence/source-risk and India application

ANALYSIS: Each kept dimension should be paired with a recallable, verifiable Indian illustration before being finalised - a dimension that cannot be illustrated concretely (Section 6's "weaken/park" branch) is often not yet ready for the final essay and should either be strengthened with a real example or set aside. Full discipline: 12.

11. Advanced structure, paragraph sequencing and style

ANALYSIS: Order kept dimensions to build rather than merely list: e.g. for 2024-A2 ("empires of the mind"), sequence individual (education) -> institutional (research capacity) -> state (strategic autonomy) -> global/ digital (platform power, misinformation) so each paragraph raises the stakes of the previous one, rather than presenting four parallel, equally-weighted observations. Full sequencing method: 07.

12. WRONG: Failure modes and revision protocol

- **WRONG: Mechanical axis-listing** (forcing scale, time, domain, and distribution dimensions regardless of fit). -> Protocol: only use an axis that yields a genuine, illustrable dimension for this specific prompt.
- **WRONG: Duplicate-claim padding.** -> Protocol: run the Section 6 filter explicitly before drafting.
- **WRONG: Ignoring the distributional axis** on prompts that clearly need it (Section 5). -> Protocol: check for a missing distributional dimension whenever the prompt touches a social phenomenon.

13. CURRENT: Dated anchor / practice lab / transfer task

CURRENT: Dated anchor: not applicable - dimensional-expansion method is stable across prompts and does not require a current-affairs anchor.

Practice lab: For 2025-A3 ("Thought finds a world and creates one also"), generate six candidate dimensions across scale/time/domain/ distribution, then apply Section 6's filter to cut to the three strongest, stating in one line why each cut dimension was discarded.

Transfer task: Repeat the same six-then-cut-to-three process for a prompt from the other audited year, and compare whether your filtering criteria (duplicate-claim, mechanism, illustration) were applied consistently; log any drift in 16's error log.

TOPIC 05 - Thesis, Central Argument and Argument Map

Complete foundational knowledge

Subject: Essay | **Tier:** Must-Do | **GS Paper:** Essay (General Studies Paper - Essay, Mains). **Core area:** Converting a decoded prompt and its dimensions into one qualified, defensible central argument, and mapping it into a proposition -> mechanism -> illustration -> qualification -> synthesis chain. **Grounded in:** UPSC Essay PYQ corpus - V1 directly verified locally for 2018-2025 and V2 carried-forward practice wording for 2013-2017 (see `../PYQ-Corpus-2013-2025.md`); `../00_Master-Framework.md` Section 6. **Research cutoff:** 18 July 2026. **Tags:** FACT: verified fact | ANALYSIS: strategy/inference | CURRENT: dated anchor | WRONG: trap/boundary. **Companion:** `../advanced/05_Thesis-Central-Argument-and-Argument-Map.md`

1. Purpose and scope

This topic is the hinge between decoding/expansion (02-04) and structure/writing (06-08): it teaches how to commit to one thesis and lay it out as a chain that can be developed paragraph by paragraph. It does not decode the prompt itself or generate dimensions - it selects and organises what 02-04 produced.

2. Core terms in plain language

- **Topic:** the printed prompt itself - the exact sentence UPSC set. You do not choose it, restate it, or improve it; you argue about it.
- **Theme:** a recurring subject area the topic touches (e.g. "well-being", "power", "technology"). A theme is a container, not a position - an essay organised around themes lists; an essay organised around a thesis argues.
- **Thesis:** one sentence stating the essay's central, qualified claim
- not a restatement of the prompt, not a list of themes.
- **Qualification:** an explicit limit, condition, or exception attached

to the thesis so it is defensible, not absolute.

- **Argument map:** the sequence proposition -> mechanism -> illustration ->

qualification -> synthesis, repeated once per major paragraph-cluster.

ANALYSIS: **Worked separation, 2024-A3.** Topic: "There is no path to happiness, Happiness is the path." Theme: well-being. Thesis: *happiness is a by-product of how one lives rather than an outcome to be pursued, which is why public policy that treats well-being as a future target under-serves citizens in the present.* Only the third is arguable - the theme could head a thousand different essays.

2a. Claim, reason and warrant

ANALYSIS: Most weak body paragraphs fail at the warrant, not the claim. Naming the three parts separately makes the gap visible.

Part	What it is	Test
Claim	What you are asserting in this paragraph	Could a reasonable reader disagree?
Reason	The "because" - the mechanism or evidence supporting it	Is it stated, or only implied?
Warrant	The unstated principle that licenses moving from that reason to that claim	Would someone who accepts the reason but rejects the warrant still resist the claim?

Worked example (2024-B8, cost of being wrong vs. doing nothing):

CLAIM A regulator should pilot a contested reform rather than defer it.
REASON Because a pilot's errors are observable and reversible.
WARRANT Because reversible error is a lower expected cost than the compounding cost of an unaddressed problem.

ANALYSIS: The warrant is where the counter-view attaches (08): an objector need not deny that pilots are reversible - they deny that reversibility is the governing consideration when the harm is severe. WRONG: A paragraph that states claim and reason but never surfaces its warrant reads as assertion even when the reason is true, because the reader is being asked to supply the connecting principle themselves.

2b. Evidence significance and rebuttal cycle

ANALYSIS: Build each major paragraph-cluster as a continuous argument:

claim
-> reason / mechanism
-> named, verifiable illustration
-> what the illustration proves for this claim
-> strongest objection
-> concession, boundary and response
-> link back to the thesis

The concession accepts what the objection gets right; the boundary states where the claim stops; the response explains why the qualified claim still holds. An illustration is not evidence merely because it is named: state its significance, then its limit, before moving on.

3. FACT: Exam facts / source basis

- FACT: Both audited papers require one essay per Section, about 1000-1200

words, with no author attribution and no printed marking rubric (see . . /README . md).

- ANALYSIS: Neither paper prescribes a required thesis format; the

proposition-mechanism-illustration-qualification-synthesis chain used in this folder is a pedagogical structuring tool, not an official requirement.

4. The central idea and common misreading

ANALYSIS: **Central idea:** a thesis is a claim that could, in principle, be disagreed with - if no reasonable reader could disagree, it is too vague to argue. **WRONG: Common misreading:** treating the thesis as a one-line summary of the prompt ("Happiness is found in the journey, not the destination, as this essay will show") rather than a distinct, qualified claim that goes beyond the prompt's own words.

5. Basic decomposition questions

1. What is my one-sentence claim, in my own words, going beyond a restatement of the prompt?
2. What limit or condition makes this claim defensible rather than absolute?
3. What is the main mechanism that explains *why* my claim holds?
4. What illustration best demonstrates that mechanism?
5. What is the strongest objection to my claim, and how does my qualification already address it?

6. Dimension-expansion grid

Prompt (example)	Candidate thesis	Qualification
2024-B8 "Cost of being wrong... less than... doing nothing."	Reversible, evidence-based experimentation should be preferred to paralysis	Only where errors are reversible and safeguarded - irreversible/high-harm risks need precaution
2025-B7 "Life as journey, not destination."	Process, learning and ethical means should be valued alongside achievement	Destinations/targets still matter for accountability and cannot be dismissed entirely
2024-A4 "The doubter is a true man of science."	Disciplined, evidence-seeking doubt is essential to scientific and civic progress	Only disciplined doubt (falsifiable, methodical) qualifies - indiscriminate denialism does not

7. India-first illustration starters

ANALYSIS: For your chosen thesis, recall one Indian illustration that demonstrates the mechanism concretely - e.g. a documented reform episode for the "cost of being wrong" thesis, or a scientific-institution example for the "doubter" thesis. Full discipline: 12.

8. Thesis options and selection

ANALYSIS: Generate two or three thesis alternatives (Section 6) before committing. Select the one that is (a) genuinely arguable, (b) already qualified, and (c) supportable by at least one recalled illustration - not simply the first idea that occurred to you.

9. Simple essay architecture

ANALYSIS: Once the thesis is chosen, sketch the argument map (Section 2) as a short list: proposition, 2-3 mechanisms/illustrations (one per paragraph-cluster), the strongest qualification, and the synthesis. This list becomes the paragraph plan for 07.

10. Opening, body and closure moves

ANALYSIS: The introduction should state (or clearly imply) the thesis early, without a generic preamble; the body develops the argument map in order; the conclusion restates the thesis in its qualified, tested form - not verbatim from the introduction. Full method: 06.

11. WRONG: Traps and repair moves

- **WRONG: Thesis-as-restatement** ("this essay will show that happiness is the path, not a destination" - merely repeating the prompt). -> Repair: add a claim beyond the prompt's own words (Section 4).
- **WRONG: Unqualified absolute thesis** ("doing nothing is always worse than being wrong"). -> Repair: attach the qualification identified in Section 6 before drafting.
- **WRONG: Thesis-as-theme** (announcing a subject area - "this essay examines happiness and public policy" - rather than a position). -> Repair: ask what a reader could disagree with in your sentence; if nothing, you have named a theme, not a thesis (Section 2).
- **WRONG: Unstated warrant** (claim and reason present, connecting principle left for the reader to supply). -> Repair: write the "because...is what governs here" sentence explicitly at least once per argument cycle (Section 2a).
- **WRONG: Thesis without a mechanism** (asserting the claim but never explaining why it holds). -> Repair: always answer Section 5's Q3 before writing body paragraphs.
- **WRONG: Switching thesis mid-essay** without signalling or resolving the shift. -> Repair: if the argument genuinely evolves, make the evolution explicit as part of the synthesis, not as an unexplained inconsistency.

12. Timed micro-drill and self-check

5-minute drill: For any decoded prompt, write: thesis (one sentence), qualification (one sentence), mechanism (one sentence), illustration (one recalled example), and the strongest objection with a one-line rebuttal.

Self-check: Could someone reasonably disagree with your thesis sentence as written? If not, sharpen it until it makes a genuine, contestable claim.

Complete advanced knowledge

Subject: Essay | **Tier:** Advanced | **GS Paper:** Essay (General Studies Paper - Essay, Mains). **Core area:** Building a thesis that survives its own strongest objection; sequencing multiple argument-map cycles without contradiction or repetition. **Grounded in:** UPSC Essay PYQ corpus - V1 directly verified locally for 2018-2025 and V2 carried-forward practice wording for 2013-2017 (see `../PYQ-Corpus-2013-2025.md`); `../00_Master-Framework.md` Section 6. **Research cutoff:** 18 July 2026. **Tags:** FACT: verified fact | ANALYSIS: strategy/inference | CURRENT: dated anchor | WRONG: trap/boundary. **Companion:** `../basic/05_Thesis-Central-Argument-and-Argument-Map.md`

1. Advanced proposition and boundary

Proposition: ANALYSIS: a strong thesis is one that has already survived its own best objection *before* the essay is drafted - the qualification should be load-bearing, not decorative. **Boundary:** WRONG: this topic does not itself supply counterargument technique (08) or paragraph-level execution (07) - it supplies the thesis-and-map design those depend on.

2. Concept definition and taxonomy

- **Load-bearing qualification:** a limit that, if removed, would make the thesis indefensible (e.g. "reversible, safeguarded experimentation" in the 2024-B8 thesis - removing "reversible, safeguarded" makes the claim reckless).
- **Decorative qualification:** a limit added only for the appearance of balance, doing no real argumentative work (e.g. "of course there are exceptions" with no exception specified).
- **Multi-cycle argument map:** repeating proposition->mechanism->illustration->qualification->synthesis two to four times across an essay, each cycle addressing a distinct dimension from 04.
- **Backed warrant:** a warrant (basic/05, Section 2a) that is itself defended, rather than assumed - the difference between "reversible error costs less than inaction" asserted and the same principle argued from observability, correction speed and distribution of harm.

2a. Warrant analysis - where advanced theses actually break

ANALYSIS: At basic level the discipline is to *surface* the warrant. At advanced level it is to notice that **the warrant, not the claim, is what a strong objector attacks** - and to design the thesis so its warrant is defensible in its own right.

Prompt	Claim	Warrant it depends on	How the warrant is attacked
2025-B5 muddy water	Restraint often resolves a disturbed situation	That the situation is self-correcting if left undisturbed	Show a domain where delay compounds rather than settles (public health, active injustice) - the warrant fails, so the claim fails with it
2024-A4 the doubter	Doubt is constitutive of science	That the doubt in question is disciplined and evidence-seeking	Point to denialism, which satisfies "doubt" but not the warrant - forcing the thesis to specify <i>which</i> doubt
2025-B8 contentment	Contentment is the truer wealth	That the person addressed is already above a sufficiency threshold	Point to those below it, for whom aspiration is need, not luxury - the warrant is bounded, not universal

ANALYSIS: Note the pattern: in each case the repair is not to abandon the claim but to **write the warrant's boundary into the thesis** - this is exactly what makes a qualification load-bearing (Section 2) rather than decorative. WRONG: A thesis whose warrant cannot be bounded without becoming trivial is a thesis worth replacing at the planning stage, not defending under time pressure.

3. Tension pairs and hidden assumptions

- **Arguability vs. safety:** a hidden assumption that a "safe," vague thesis is lower-risk; in fact a vague thesis produces vague paragraphs throughout, which is its own risk (cross-link 14).
- **Single-cycle vs. multi-cycle:** the assumption that one strong argument-map cycle suffices for 1000-1200 words is usually false - most audited prompts need two to four cycles (one per kept dimension from 04) to sustain length without repetition.
- **Consistency vs. false uniformity:** the assumption that every argument-map cycle must reach the *same* qualification is false - each dimension may carry its own distinct qualification, unified only at the final synthesis.

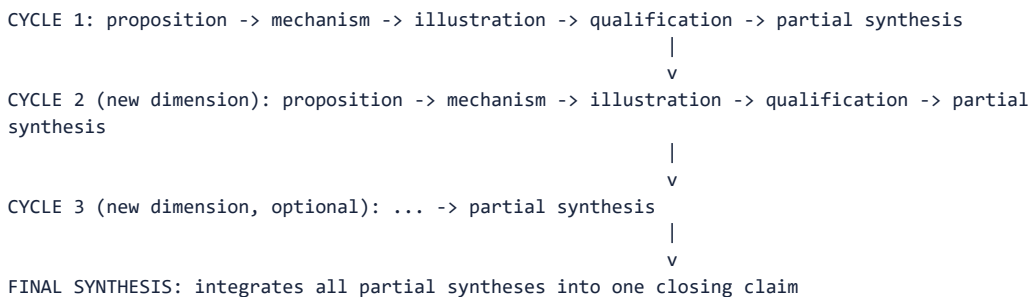
4. Levels of analysis and temporal-spatial scale

ANALYSIS: Test the thesis at more than one scale before finalising: does the 2025-B7 thesis ("process/means matter alongside destination") hold at the individual (career/education), institutional (organisational goal- setting) and state (development-target) scales equally, or does it need a scale-specific qualification at one of them (e.g. states legitimately need measurable targets for accountability, more than an individual needs a fixed life-goal)?

5. Stakeholder map and distributional effects

ANALYSIS: For theses with a clear social-policy dimension (e.g. 2024-B8's "reversible experimentation" thesis), identify who bears the risk if the thesis's qualification is violated - e.g. who is harmed if an "experimental" reform turns out not to be reversible. A thesis that ignores whose risk is being traded off is analytically incomplete.

6. Causality, mechanisms and feedback loops



ANALYSIS: Each cycle should feed into the next - e.g. cycle 1's qualification can become cycle 2's opening tension - rather than three unconnected mini-essays stapled together.

7. Necessary/sufficient conditions and exceptions

ANALYSIS: A load-bearing qualification (Section 2) is *necessary* for a defensible thesis but not *sufficient* on its own - the qualification must also be demonstrated, not merely asserted, through the mechanism and illustration stages. **Exception:** for prompts with an unusually narrow, well-supported claim (e.g. 2025-A1, "truth knows no color," read as an epistemic-standards claim), a single well-developed cycle with a strong qualification may outperform a forced multi-cycle structure.

8. Paradox, dialectic and counterfactual test

Paradox: the strongest theses often concede the most to their opposing view - e.g. a thesis on 2024-B6 (power tests character) that fully grants adversity also builds character, while still arguing power is the more revealing and consequential test, is stronger than one that denies adversity teaches anything. **Counterfactual test:** "If I removed my thesis's qualification, would a reasonable counter-example immediately break the claim?" If yes, the qualification is load-bearing and correctly placed (Section 2); if the thesis survives even without it, the qualification may be unnecessary hedging.

9. Ethical conflict and synthesis

ANALYSIS: Constructing a thesis around a value conflict (e.g. 2024-B6's accountability vs. autonomy, or 2025-B8's sufficiency vs. aspiration) requires naming the values explicitly rather than resolving the tension by simply asserting one side is correct - the synthesis should show how both values are honoured under stated conditions (full framework: 10).

10. Evidence/source-risk and India application

ANALYSIS: An argument-map cycle normally benefits from one well-matched illustration when it materially advances the claim; unsupported assertion and evidence-dumping are both risks (09). India-application at the thesis stage means checking, before finalising, that at least one cycle's illustration is a genuinely Indian case - not a generic or entirely foreign one - to keep the essay grounded (12).

11. Advanced structure, paragraph sequencing and style

ANALYSIS: Sequence argument-map cycles from the scale/dimension the reader will find most immediately graspable to the broadest/most consequential, ending the body with the cycle that most directly sets up the final synthesis - avoid ordering cycles by the order dimensions happened to be brainstormed in (04), which is often not the most persuasive sequence. Full method: 07.

12. WRONG: Failure modes and revision protocol

- **WRONG: Decorative qualification** (Section 2) that does no real work. ->

Protocol: for every qualification, state the specific counter-example it rules out; if none can be stated, cut or strengthen the qualification.

- **WRONG: Disconnected cycles** (three mini-essays, not one essay). ->

Protocol: ensure each cycle's opening links explicitly to the previous cycle's qualification or synthesis.

- **WRONG: Thesis drift across cycles** (later cycles quietly argue something different from the opening thesis). -> **Protocol:** re-read the opening thesis before drafting each new cycle and confirm continuity.

13. CURRENT: Dated anchor / practice lab / transfer task

CURRENT: Dated anchor: not applicable - thesis-construction method is stable and does not require a current-affairs anchor.

Practice lab: For 2024-A2 ("empires of the mind"), build a two-cycle argument map (education/institutional cycle; digital-power cycle) with a distinct, load-bearing qualification in each, then write the final synthesis sentence integrating both.

Transfer task: Apply the same two-cycle method to 2025-A3 ("thought finds a world and creates one also") on a separate occasion, and compare whether your qualifications in both attempts were genuinely load-bearing (Section 8's counterfactual test) or decorative; log any drift in 16's error log.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023
- **Paper(s):** Essay
- **Routed question demands:** 18

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive /​format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	Essay	7	A people that values its privileges above its principles loses both	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive /​ format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	Essay	8	Reality does not conform to the ideal but confirms it	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2019	Essay	3	Best for an individual is not necessarily best for the society	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2019	Essay	4	Courage to accept and dedication to improve as two keys to success	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2020	Essay	3	Ships sink because of the water that gets into them	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2020	Essay	4	Simplicity is the ultimate sophistication	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2020	Essay	6	Social justice and economic prosperity as mutually dependent	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2021	Essay	6	What is research but a blind date with knowledge	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2021	Essay	8	There are better practices to best practices	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2022	Essay	1	Forests as the best case studies for economic excellence	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2022	Essay	4	A ship in harbour is safe but that is not what a ship is for	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2022	Essay	5	The time to repair the roof is when the sun is shining	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2022	Essay	7	A smile as the chosen vehicle for all ambiguities	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2022	Essay	8	Having a choice does not mean any of them has to be right	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2023	Essay	2	Visionary decision-making at the intersection of intuition and logic	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive /​format	Source status	Owner requirement
2023	Essay	4	Inspiration for creativity from looking for the magical in the mundane	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2023	Essay	7	A society that has more justice needs less charity	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2023	Essay	8	Education as what remains after one forgets what was learned	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.

What this owner must now support

- A people that values its privileges above its principles loses both
- Reality does not conform to the ideal but confirms it
- Best for an individual is not necessarily best for the society
- Courage to accept and dedication to improve as two keys to success
- Ships sink because of the water that gets into them
- Simplicity is the ultimate sophistication
- Social justice and economic prosperity as mutually dependent
- What is research but a blind date with knowledge
- There are better practices to best practices
- Forests as the best case studies for economic excellence
- A ship in harbour is safe but that is not what a ship is for
- The time to repair the roof is when the sun is shining
- A smile as the chosen vehicle for all ambiguities
- Having a choice does not mean any of them has to be right
- Visionary decision-making at the intersection of intuition and logic
- Inspiration for creativity from looking for the magical in the mundane
- A society that has more justice needs less charity
- Education as what remains after one forgets what was learned

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

TOPIC 06 - Introductions and Conclusions

Complete foundational knowledge

Subject: Essay | **Tier:** Must-Do | **GS Paper:** Essay (General Studies Paper - Essay, Mains). **Core area:** Designing relevant, non-forced openings and earned, forward-looking closures that avoid manufactured anecdotes and verbatim repetition. **Grounded in:** UPSC Essay PYQ corpus - V1 directly verified locally for 2018-2025 and V2 carried-forward practice wording for 2013-2017 (see `../PYQ-Corpus-2013-2025.md`); `../00_Master-Framework.md` Section 9. **Research cutoff:** 18 July 2026. **Tags:** FACT: verified fact | ANALYSIS: strategy/inference | CURRENT: dated anchor | WRONG: trap/boundary. **Companion:** `../advanced/06_Introductions-and-Conclusions.md`

1. Purpose and scope

This topic covers only the essay's opening and closing paragraphs - the body's internal flow and transitions are covered in 07. It assumes a thesis has already been chosen (05).

2. Core terms in plain language

- **Relevant opening:** an opening that engages the prompt's actual tension (from 02/03) within the first sentence or two.
- **Forced anecdote:** a fabricated or generic human-interest story used to "hook" the reader without genuine connection to the thesis.
- **Earned conclusion:** a closing that follows logically from the body's argument, not one that could be pasted onto a different essay.

3. FACT: Exam facts / source basis

- **FACT:** Both audited papers require essays of about 1000-1200 words with no printed structural requirement for introduction/conclusion length or form (see . . /README .md).
- **ANALYSIS:** The techniques below are pedagogical, not derived from any official UPSC style guide - none exists in the audited corpus.

4. The central idea and common misreading

ANALYSIS: Central idea: the introduction should state or clearly imply the thesis's tension quickly; the conclusion should return to that tension transformed by the argument, not merely repeated. **WRONG: Common misreading:** opening with a fabricated personal anecdote ("I remember when my grandfather told me...") disconnected from any real argument, or closing with a generic call to action ("we must all work together") that could end almost any essay on any topic.

5. Basic decomposition questions

1. What is the prompt's tension, in one sentence, that my opening should surface?
2. Can I open with the prompt's own tension restated in my own words, rather than an anecdote?
3. What has my argument *added* to the thesis by the end of the essay that the introduction did not yet know?
4. Does my conclusion state a feasible, forward-looking synthesis, or just a summary?
5. Would my conclusion still make sense if pasted onto a different essay on a different prompt? (If yes, it is too generic.)

5a. Provisional-answer / tested-answer alignment check

ANALYSIS: The introduction gives a **provisional answer**: it raises the prompt's tension and signals the direction of the thesis without pre-solving every qualification. The conclusion gives the **tested answer**: it returns to that same tension after the body has supplied mechanism, evidence, limits and synthesis.

Before finalising the frame, ask:

1. Does the opening promise the argument the body actually develops?
2. Does the conclusion answer that promise in a more qualified form, rather than merely repeat it?
3. Has either frame introduced a claim or illustration that the body never develops?

6. Dimension-expansion grid

Prompt (example)	Opening move	Closing move
2025-A1 "Truth knows no color."	State the tension: objectivity claimed vs. perspective-shaped perception	Synthesis: plural voice, common evidentiary standard
2024-A3 "Happiness is the path."	State the tension: destination-chasing vs. present conduct	Synthesis: flourishing as ongoing process and social condition
2025-B5 "Muddy water... leaving it alone."	State the tension: restraint vs. intervention	Synthesis: diagnostic wisdom - knowing which situations need which

7. India-first illustration starters

ANALYSIS: An opening may use a brief, real Indian reference (an institution, a documented episode) instead of an abstract statement, provided it is recalled, not invented, and directly tied to the tension. Full discipline: 12.

8. Thesis options and selection

ANALYSIS: The chosen thesis (from 05) should be visible, at least in implication, by the end of the introduction - a reader should be able to predict roughly what the essay will argue, without the essay stating "in this essay I will argue..." mechanically.

9. Simple essay architecture

ANALYSIS: A workable shape: introduction (1 paragraph, tension + implied thesis), body (per 07), conclusion (1 paragraph, transformed thesis + synthesis). Avoid a two-paragraph introduction or a conclusion that introduces a brand-new idea not developed in the body.

10. Opening, body and closure moves

- **Opening move**: state the tension in your own words; optionally ground it in one recalled illustration; imply the thesis.
- **Closure move**: restate the thesis in its tested, qualified form; state the synthesis; end on a feasible, humane, forward-looking note - not a slogan.

11. WRONG: Traps and repair moves

- **WRONG: Forced/fabricated anecdote opening.** -> Repair: open with the prompt's own tension in your own words instead.

- **WRONG: Introduction that reveals no thesis at all.** -> Repair: ensure a reader could state, even roughly, what you will argue after reading paragraph one.

- **WRONG: Conclusion that merely repeats the introduction verbatim.** -> Repair: restate the thesis in its *tested* form, showing what the body argument added.

- **WRONG: Conclusion that introduces a brand-new, undeveloped claim.** -> Repair: the conclusion should synthesise material already argued in the body, not add new content.

12. Timed micro-drill and self-check

5-minute drill: For any chosen thesis, write only the opening sentence and the closing sentence (not the full essay). Check that the opening states a tension (not an anecdote) and the closing states a synthesis (not a repeat).

Self-check: Read your closing sentence in isolation. Does it clearly belong to *this* essay's specific argument, or could it end almost any essay on "change," "balance" or "progress" in general? If the latter, rewrite it to reference your specific thesis and mechanism.

Complete advanced knowledge

Subject: Essay | **Tier:** Advanced | **GS Paper:** Essay (General Studies Paper - Essay, Mains). **Core area:** Engineering an introduction that sets up every body cycle without giving away the synthesis, and a conclusion that performs real closure work rather than summarising. **Grounded in:** UPSC Essay PYQ corpus - V1 directly verified locally for 2018-2025 and V2 carried-forward practice wording for 2013-2017 (see `../PYQ-Corpus-2013-2025.md`); `../00_Master-Framework.md` Section 9. **Research cutoff:** 18 July 2026. **Tags:** FACT: verified fact | ANALYSIS: strategy/inference | CURRENT: dated anchor | WRONG: trap/boundary. **Companion:** `../basic/06_Introductions-and-Conclusions.md`

1. Advanced proposition and boundary

Proposition: ANALYSIS: the introduction's job is to raise the tension and create productive uncertainty about how it resolves - not to pre-state the full synthesis, which would make the body redundant. **Boundary:** WRONG: this topic does not cover body-paragraph transitions (07) or argument-cycle design (05) - only the framing paragraphs at each end.

2. Concept definition and taxonomy

- **Tension-raising opening:** states the prompt's opposition clearly enough that the reader anticipates an argument, without revealing the full resolution.

- **Summary conclusion (weak):** restates each body paragraph's point in sequence - mechanically comprehensive but analytically flat.

- **Synthesising conclusion (strong):** integrates the body's multiple argument-map cycles (05) into one transformed statement of the thesis, showing *how* the tension is resolved, not merely *that* it was discussed.

3. Tension pairs and hidden assumptions

- **Intrigue vs. clarity:** a hidden assumption that an intriguing,

ambiguous opening is more sophisticated; in fact, an opening that is intriguing but leaves the reader unsure what is being argued at all performs worse than one that is clear but still open-ended about the resolution.

- **Comprehensiveness vs. synthesis:** the assumption that a "good"

conclusion should mention every point made in the body; in fact a conclusion that tries to summarise everything usually fails to synthesise anything (see weak vs. strong taxonomy, Section 2).

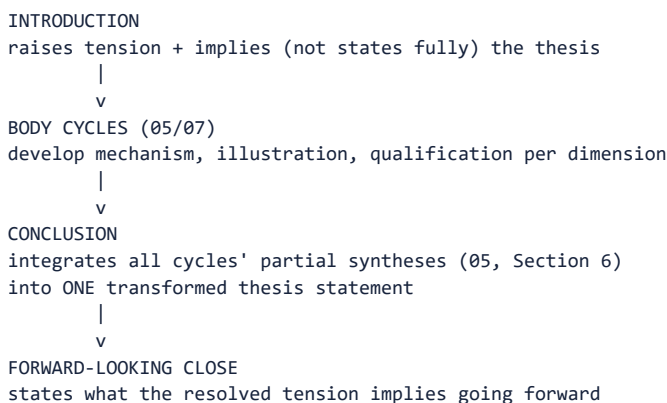
4. Levels of analysis and temporal-spatial scale

ANALYSIS: For prompts with a civilisational or long-run scale (2024-A1 forests/ deserts; 2025-B6 years teach), the introduction can legitimately open at that broad scale, provided the immediate next sentence narrows to the specific mechanism the essay will argue - a broad opening that never narrows produces a diffuse essay; a narrow opening on a broad-scale prompt can feel disproportionate.

5. Stakeholder map and distributional effects

ANALYSIS: Where the thesis has a distributional dimension (e.g. 2024-B5 FOMO, 2025-A1 truth/color), the conclusion should explicitly name whose responsibility the proposed synthesis assigns (individual, institution, state) rather than closing on an unattributed collective "we must" - vague collective responsibility is a common closure weakness (08 cross-link on stakeholder-aware synthesis).

6. Causality, mechanisms and feedback loops



ANALYSIS: A conclusion that does not draw on the body's specific cycles (skips the middle arrow) is detached from the essay's actual argument and reads as generic.

7. Necessary/sufficient conditions and exceptions

ANALYSIS: A tension-raising opening and a synthesising conclusion are each necessary for a strong frame, but neither is individually sufficient - an essay can have both, yet still fail if the body's argument-map cycles (05) do not actually connect the two. **Exception:** for very tightly scoped issue-prompts (2024-B5), a slightly more direct, less ambiguous opening (naming the phenomenon immediately) can work better than an elaborately tension-raising one, since the phenomenon itself is already concrete.

8. Paradox, dialectic and counterfactual test

Paradox: the most memorable conclusions often say *less* than a full summary would, because they compress the argument into one sharp, transformed statement rather than recapping every point. **Counterfactual test:** "If I deleted my body paragraphs and kept only my introduction and conclusion, would a reader still sense an argument happened, or just two restatements of the prompt?" If the latter, the frame is not actually connected to the body's specific work.

9. Ethical conflict and synthesis

ANALYSIS: Where the thesis resolves a genuine value conflict (e.g. 2025-B8 sufficiency vs. aspiration), the conclusion should name the values explicitly in its final synthesis rather than defaulting to a feel-good, values-neutral closing line - an advanced conclusion commits to a reasoned priority (per 10's ethical-conflict method) instead of avoiding the conflict at the last moment.

10. Evidence/source-risk and India application

ANALYSIS: The introduction and conclusion should generally avoid introducing a *new* illustration not already used in the body - new evidence at the close reads as an afterthought rather than a synthesis. If an Indian illustration is used in the opening to ground the tension, ensure it recurs (even briefly) in the conclusion to close the frame. Full discipline: 12.

11. Advanced structure, paragraph sequencing and style

ANALYSIS: Keep both frame paragraphs proportionate to a 1000-1200-word essay - typically 70-120 words each; a frame that is too long relative to the body signals thin body content, while a frame that is too short may under-establish the tension or under-deliver the synthesis. Full proportion guidance: 07, 13.

12. WRONG: Failure modes and revision protocol

- **WRONG: Pre-stating the full synthesis in the introduction**, leaving the body nothing new to demonstrate. -> Protocol: check that the introduction raises the tension without fully resolving it.

- **WRONG: Summary conclusion** that lists body points without integration. ->

Protocol: rewrite the conclusion as one transformed thesis statement, not a paragraph-by-paragraph recap.

- **WRONG: New, unintegrated illustration or claim in the conclusion.** ->

Protocol: remove it, or move it earlier into the body where it can be developed with mechanism and qualification.

13. CURRENT: Dated anchor / practice lab / transfer task

CURRENT: Dated anchor: not applicable - framing technique is stable and does not depend on current-affairs content.

Practice lab: For 2024-B6 ("power tests character"), write only the introduction and conclusion (not the body), then check via the Section 8 counterfactual test whether a reader could infer the argument's shape from the frame alone.

Transfer task: Repeat the same frame-only exercise for 2025-A4 ("bitter experiences") on a different occasion, and compare whether your introductions in both attempts avoid fabricated anecdotes and your conclusions avoid mere summary; log any drift in 16's error log.

TOPIC 07 - Macro-Structure, Paragraph Flow and Transitions

Complete foundational knowledge

Subject: Essay | **Tier:** Must-Do | **GS Paper:** Essay (General Studies Paper - Essay, Mains). **Core area:** Building a coherent 1000-1200-word architecture from a thesis and argument map, and linking paragraphs with genuine transitions rather than headings. **Grounded in:** V1 (2018-2025) UPSC Essay paper corpus (see `../README.md`); `../00_Master-Framework.md` Section 9. **Research cutoff:** 18 July 2026. **Tags:** FACT: verified fact | ANALYSIS: strategy/inference | CURRENT: dated anchor | WRONG: trap/boundary. **Companion:** `../advanced/07_Macro-Structure-Paragraph-Flow-and-Transitions.md`

1. Purpose and scope

This topic covers the essay's overall shape and how paragraphs connect to each other - it assumes the thesis and argument map are already built (05) and hands off the opening/closing paragraphs to 06.

2. Core terms in plain language

- **Paragraph cluster:** one or two paragraphs developing a single argument-map cycle (one dimension, its mechanism, illustration and qualification).
- **Transition:** a sentence or phrase at a paragraph's start that links back to the previous paragraph's idea before introducing the new one.
- **Flow:** the sense that each paragraph follows necessarily from the last, rather than being an independent, swappable block.

3. FACT: Exam facts / source basis

- FACT: Both audited papers require about 1000-1200 words per essay, with no printed instruction on paragraph count, headings, or subheadings (see `../README.md`).
- ANALYSIS: The 9-11 paragraph guidance and heading-free convention used here are pedagogical norms for continuous essay writing, not an official UPSC requirement.

4. The central idea and common misreading

ANALYSIS: **Central idea:** a 1000-1200-word essay typically works well as roughly **9-12 purposeful paragraphs** - introduction, three argument-map clusters (usually two paragraphs each), a counter-view/ synthesis paragraph, and a conclusion. Add a paragraph only when a distinct mechanism or objection needs development, not to meet a count. Each paragraph should open with a transition to the previous idea. WRONG: **Common misreading:** using GS-style headings, numbered sections, or bullet lists to organise the essay - this reads as an administrative answer, not a continuous argued essay, and undercuts flow.

5. Basic decomposition questions

1. How many argument-map cycles (from 05) do I have, and how many paragraphs does each need?
2. What order best builds toward the conclusion - narrowest to broadest, or cause to consequence?
3. Does each paragraph's opening sentence refer back to the previous paragraph's idea?
4. Is there a distinct paragraph testing the counter-view/synthesis (see 08) before the conclusion?

5. Does every paragraph contain exactly one main claim, not several unrelated ones crammed together?

6. Dimension-expansion grid

Essay section	Approx. paragraph count	Content
Introduction	1	Tension + implied thesis (06)
Body cycle 1	2	Mechanism + illustration + qualification for dimension 1
Body cycle 2	2	Mechanism + illustration + qualification for dimension 2
Body cycle 3	2	Mechanism + illustration + qualification for dimension 3
Counter-view/synthesis	1	Strongest non-duplicative objection tested and resolved (08)
Conclusion	1	Transformed thesis + forward-looking synthesis (06)
Optional expansion	0-2	Use only for a fourth distinct mechanism or a counter-view requiring separate development

This base plan has **9 paragraphs**; one or two earned expansions make it 10-11. It is a planning heuristic, not a paper rule.

Two prose-ready paragraph skeletons

Skeleton 1 - accountable power (2024-B6):

Claim: Personal restraint matters, but discretionary power that affects others' rights also needs an external test. **Mechanism:** when decisions can be examined by citizens and institutions, concealment is harder and reasons must be made public. **Verified illustration:** the Right to Information Act, 2005 enables citizen scrutiny of public authority; its year and the Central and State Information Commissions are locally verified in the illustration bank (12). **Qualification:** transparency alone cannot guarantee enforcement or ethical conduct. **Link:** Yet scrutiny cannot replace judgement; the next question is how institutions preserve necessary discretion without making it unanswerable.

Skeleton 2 - ecological restraint (2024-A1):

Claim: Development becomes self-defeating when it treats ecological restraint as an obstacle rather than a condition of durable prosperity. **Mechanism:** communities that bear environmental costs can make hidden losses visible and check extraction before damage compounds. **Verified illustration:** the Chipko movement was a 1970s Himalayan forest-protection movement; that placement is locally verified in 12. **Qualification:** one movement cannot prove that community action alone reverses every extractive pressure. **Link:** Its lesson therefore leads beyond local resistance to the institutional rules that decide whether ecological costs are counted at all.

Load-bearing transition chain

PERSONAL RESTRAINT limits abuse when nobody is watching.

|
v

"Yet private virtue is too fragile where a decision changes another person's rights; public power needs public reasons."

|
v

INSTITUTIONAL ACCOUNTABILITY tests those reasons through scrutiny.

|
v

"But scrutiny alone does not tell an institution which competing right should govern; that requires a reasoned ethical priority."

|
v

ETHICAL SYNTHESIS resolves the remaining conflict without hiding its cost.

7. India-first illustration starters

ANALYSIS: Assign one recalled Indian illustration per paragraph cluster where relevant, and check no single illustration is stretched across multiple clusters without adding new material each time. Full discipline: 12.

8. Thesis options and selection

ANALYSIS: The chosen thesis (05) should be traceable through every paragraph cluster's opening claim - if a paragraph's claim cannot be connected back to the thesis in one sentence, either cut it or revise the thesis to account for it.

9. Simple essay architecture

ANALYSIS: Use Section 6's grid as a literal paragraph-by-paragraph plan before drafting - write one claim-sentence per planned paragraph first, check for flow and non-repetition, then expand each into full prose.

10. Opening, body and closure moves

ANALYSIS: Each body paragraph should: (a) open with a transition to the previous paragraph, (b) state its claim, (c) develop mechanism and illustration, (d) close with a qualification or a link forward to the next paragraph. See 06 for the essay-level opening/closing paragraphs specifically.

11. WRONG: Traps and repair moves

- WRONG: **Headings/numbered lists/bullet points** in the essay body. ->

Repair: convert each into a connected sentence within continuous prose.

- WRONG: **Paragraphs that could be reordered with no loss of sense.** ->

Repair: add explicit transitions referencing the previous paragraph's specific claim, not a generic "furthermore."

- WRONG: **One paragraph containing two unrelated claims.** -> Repair: split

into two paragraphs, each with one claim.

- WRONG: **A thesis left untested where a serious objection is available.**

-> Repair: include a substantive counter-view where it genuinely tests the thesis; otherwise integrate the necessary qualification into the relevant argument cycle (see 08).

12. Timed micro-drill and self-check

5-minute drill: For any argument map from 05, write only the opening sentence of each planned paragraph (introduction through conclusion). Check that each opening sentence references the previous paragraph's idea before introducing its own.

Self-check: Could two of your body paragraphs be swapped without the essay reading noticeably worse? If so, add a transition anchored specifically to what precedes it, or reorder for a genuine build.

Complete advanced knowledge

Subject: Essay | **Tier:** Advanced | **GS Paper:** Essay (General Studies Paper - Essay, Mains). **Core area:** Diagnosing and repairing weak paragraph flow; engineering transitions that carry argumentative weight rather than decorative connectives. **Grounded in:** V1 (2018-2025) UPSC Essay paper corpus (see `../README.md`); `../00_Master-Framework.md` Section 9. **Research cutoff:** 18 July 2026. **Tags:** FACT: verified fact | ANALYSIS: strategy/inference | CURRENT: dated anchor | WRONG: trap/boundary. **Companion:** `../basic/07_Macro-Structure-Paragraph-Flow-and-Transitions.md`

1. Advanced proposition and boundary

Proposition: ANALYSIS: a transition is strong when removing it would create a visible logical gap, not merely a stylistic one - a good test of structural quality is whether the essay survives having its connective phrases deleted while the underlying logic still holds. **Boundary:** WRONG: this topic does not build the argument map itself (05) or the counter-view content (08) - it sequences and connects what those supply.

2. Concept definition and taxonomy

- **Decorative connective:** "furthermore," "moreover," "in addition" - signals continuation without stating *why* the next paragraph follows.
- **Load-bearing transition:** references the previous paragraph's specific qualification or claim and shows why it leads to the next paragraph's claim (e.g. "This same feedback loop, however, operates just as visibly at the institutional level...").
- **Paragraph repair:** the process of diagnosing which of a paragraph's three components (claim, development, link) is missing or weak, and rewriting only that component.

3. Tension pairs and hidden assumptions

- **Length vs. purposefulness:** the hidden assumption that reaching 1000-1200 words is itself sufficient; in fact each paragraph must earn its place by advancing the argument map, not merely adding length.
- **Variety vs. coherence:** varying paragraph content across many unconnected topics can look "comprehensive" while actually reducing coherence - an advanced essay favours fewer, connected cycles over many disconnected ones (cross-link 04, Section 7).
- **Breadth vs. coherence, structurally:** advanced/04 catches this at selection; it reappears here as a *sequencing* problem. Breadth is additive - each paragraph contributes a new angle. Coherence is cumulative - each paragraph is harder to remove than the last, because later ones depend on earlier ones. ANALYSIS: Test: number your body paragraphs and ask which could be moved to the front without rewriting its opening sentence. Every paragraph that could is a breadth paragraph; if all of them could, the essay is a well-stocked list. WRONG: Adding transitions to a breadth-only essay produces connective language over an unchanged structure - the reader notices the seam.

4. Levels of analysis and temporal-spatial scale

ANALYSIS: Sequencing should generally track a scale or intensity gradient: for 2024-A2 ("empires of the mind"), individual -> institutional -> state -> global/digital is a natural escalating sequence; for 2025-B6 ("years teach... days never know"), reversing to institutional/civilisational memory before individual reflection can work equally well if the transition explicitly justifies the jump in scale.

5. Stakeholder map and distributional effects

ANALYSIS: Where paragraph clusters address different stakeholders (e.g. 2024-B5's individual, family, platform, state dimensions), transitions should make the stakeholder shift explicit ("Where the individual's own habits shape exposure, platform design shapes the opportunity for that exposure in the first place...") rather than silently switching subject.

6. Causality, mechanisms and feedback loops - paragraph repair method

DIAGNOSE the weak paragraph:

missing CLAIM?	-> add one clear, arguable sentence at the top
missing DEVELOPMENT?	-> add mechanism + one verified illustration
missing LINK?	-> add a transition referencing the prior paragraph's specific qualification/claim

|
v

REWRITE only the diagnosed weak component

|
v

RE-CHECK: does the paragraph now survive the "delete the connective" test (Section 1) without losing logical continuity?

ANALYSIS: This diagnose-then-repair method is faster under time pressure than rewriting a weak paragraph wholesale, and is the core drill for 13's timed practice.

7. Necessary/sufficient conditions and exceptions

ANALYSIS: A claim-development-link structure in every paragraph is necessary for flow but not sufficient for a strong essay - the *content* of the claim and development still depends on 05's argument map quality. **Exception:** the counter-view/synthesis paragraph (08) may legitimately depart from the claim-development-link template by opening with the objection itself rather than a fresh claim, since its function is dialectical rather than additive.

8. Paradox, dialectic and counterfactual test

Paradox: the essays that read as most "natural" and unstructured are usually the most tightly engineered - visible structure (headings, numbered points) signals *weaker* control of flow, not stronger. **Counterfactual test:** "If I deleted this paragraph entirely, would the essay's argument have an unexplained gap, or would it read almost the same?" If the latter, the paragraph was not load-bearing and should either be cut or given a genuine claim (Section 6).

9. Ethical conflict and synthesis

ANALYSIS: Structural discipline itself has no ethical content, but the counter-view/synthesis paragraph's placement does: burying the strongest objection deep in the middle (where it can be forgotten) rather than addressing it prominently before the conclusion risks appearing to avoid the hardest part of the argument - placement should reflect genuine engagement, not concealment.

10. Evidence/source-risk and India application

ANALYSIS: When sequencing illustrations across paragraphs, avoid reusing the same Indian example in two different clusters without adding new functional content each time (repetition dressed as evidence) - full illustration-bank discipline in 12.

11. Advanced structure, paragraph sequencing and style

INTRO (tension + implied thesis)
| [transition: names the first dimension the tension implies]
CLUSTER 1 (claim -> mechanism -> illustration -> qualification)
| [transition: extends qualification to a broader/narrower scale]
CLUSTER 2 (claim -> mechanism -> illustration -> qualification)
| [transition: raises the strongest objection to clusters 1-2]
COUNTER-VIEW / SYNTHESIS (08)
| [transition: shows how synthesis integrates both clusters]
CONCLUSION (transformed thesis + forward-looking close)

ANALYSIS: This is a process map for organising an argument, not a decorative diagram - each arrow names the actual logical link required, and should be checked against the essay's real content, not filled in generically.

12. WRONG: Failure modes and revision protocol

- WRONG: **Reachable word count via padding** rather than purposeful paragraphs. -> Protocol: run the "delete the paragraph" test (Section 8. on any paragraph added mainly to reach the word count.
- WRONG: **Generic connectives standing in for real transitions.** ->

Protocol: replace "furthermore/moreover" with a phrase naming the specific prior claim being extended.

- WRONG: **A serious counter-view paragraph missing or too brief.** ->

Protocol: where a non-duplicative objection genuinely tests the thesis, include a substantive paragraph before the conclusion (08). Where its qualification is already fully handled inside a body cycle, do not add a token "on the other hand" paragraph merely to satisfy a formula.

13. CURRENT: Dated anchor / practice lab / transfer task

CURRENT: **Dated anchor:** not applicable - structural method does not depend on current-affairs content.

Practice lab: Take a rough draft (yours or a practice attempt) for any prompt in . . /README .md and apply the Section 6 diagnose-repair method to its two weakest paragraphs within 10 minutes.

Transfer task: Repeat the same repair exercise on a different prompt's draft on another occasion, timing yourself, and log whether your diagnosis speed and accuracy improve in 16's error log.

TOPIC 08 - Argument, Counterargument and Synthesis

Complete foundational knowledge

Subject: Essay | **Tier:** Must-Do | **GS Paper:** Essay (General Studies Paper - Essay, Mains). **Core area:** Testing a thesis against its strongest objection and resolving the tension into a genuine synthesis, rather than an unresolved "on the other hand." **Grounded in:** V1 (2018-2025) UPSC Essay paper corpus (see . . /README .md); . . /00_Master-Framework .md Section 6. **Research cutoff:** 18 July 2026. **Tags:** FACT: verified fact | ANALYSIS: strategy/inference | CURRENT: dated anchor | WRONG: trap/boundary. **Companion:** . . /advanced/08_Argument-Counterargument-and-Synthesis.md

1. Purpose and scope

This topic teaches the counter-view/synthesis step of the argument map (05) in depth - how to state a real objection, engage it fairly, and resolve it, rather than dismissing it or leaving it hanging.

2. Core terms in plain language

- **Counter-view (counterargument):** the strongest reasonable objection

to your thesis, stated fairly and at full strength, not a weak "straw man" version easy to knock down. It is a *position*, and in a good essay it is stated as its own advocate would state it.

- **Rebuttal:** your specific answer to that objection - showing it rests

on a false premise, applies only under conditions that do not hold here, or has been over-generalised. A rebuttal is a *move*, and it can succeed without the objection disappearing.

- **Synthesis:** a resolution that specifies the condition under which

each side governs, incorporating what is valid in the counter-view while still defending a version of the original thesis. A synthesis is an *outcome*, and it is not the same as splitting the difference.

- **Trade-off:** a genuine cost or limitation your thesis must

acknowledge, not explain away.

ANALYSIS: The three are not interchangeable, and the order matters.

COUNTERARGUMENT	"Some errors are irreversible and catastrophic."
	(stated at full strength; not yet answered)
v	
REBUTTAL	"That is true of a narrow class of decisions -
	irreversibility, not error itself, is the danger."
v	
SYNTHESIS	"So: prefer experimentation where error is reversible
	and safeguarded; apply precaution where it is not."

WRONG: Three common collapses: stating a counterargument and calling it balance (no rebuttal); rebutting without synthesising (the objection is defeated but nothing is learned); and presenting a synthesis with no counterargument behind it (a resolution to a conflict never actually staged). **ANALYSIS:** A rebuttal that fully destroys the objection usually signals the objection was too weak - the best counterarguments survive rebuttal in some bounded form, which is precisely what gives the synthesis something to resolve.

3. FACT: Exam facts / source basis

- **FACT:** Neither audited paper specifies how counterarguments should be

handled; no official rubric rewards or penalises a specific counterargument format (see . . /README.md).

- **ANALYSIS:** The "state fairly, then synthesise" method here is a pedagogical

discipline for producing a balanced, defensible essay - not an official UPSC instruction.

4. The central idea and common misreading

ANALYSIS: Central idea: a thesis is strengthened, not weakened, by confronting its best objection directly and showing how the argument still holds (with a qualification) once that objection is considered. **WRONG: Common misreading:** either ignoring counter-views entirely (one-sided moralising) or presenting a counter-view merely to reject it dismissively without genuine engagement - both under-use the paper's test of balanced judgement.

5. Basic decomposition questions

1. What is the single strongest objection a fair-minded reader could raise against my thesis?
2. Is there a genuine trade-off my thesis requires accepting (not just a minor caveat)?
3. What does the objection get right, even partially?
4. How does my synthesis incorporate that partial truth while still defending my central claim?
5. Does my synthesis avoid simply restating my original thesis unchanged?

6. Dimension-expansion grid

Prompt (example)	Strongest counter-view	Synthesis
2024-B8 "Cost of being wrong... less than doing nothing."	Some errors are irreversible and catastrophic (e.g. safety, ecological harm)	Prefer reversible, safeguarded experimentation; apply precaution where harm is irreversible
2025-A2 "Supreme art of war... without fighting."	Deterrence sometimes requires credible capability, not persuasion alone	Peace built on both preparedness and diplomacy, not diplomacy alone
2024-A4 "The doubter is a true man of science."	Excessive doubt can become denialism or paralysis	Doubt must be disciplined - falsifiable, evidence-seeking, time-bound

Two complete mini-cycles

Cycle 1 - "The cost of being wrong is less than the cost of doing nothing."

Move	Prose-ready content
Claim	A public problem should ordinarily invite safeguarded action rather than indefinite delay when the action can generate feedback and be corrected.
Evidence	The nationwide sanitation-behaviour campaigns associated with Swachh Bharat Mission are a candidate-recalled illustration of large-scale civic mobilisation; verify its exact facts before live use (12).
Counterclaim	Scale can magnify a mistaken intervention: participation or an announced goal does not establish uniform outcomes everywhere.
Switching condition	Prefer a pilot, phased roll-out, independent review and correction where harms are observable and reversible; apply precaution where foreseeable harm is irreversible or concentrated on people unable to bear it.
Synthesis	The relevant contrast is not action versus inaction, but accountable learning versus reckless or paralysed administration.

Cycle 2 - "Forests precede civilizations and deserts follow them."

Move	Prose-ready content
Claim	Ecological restraint is a productive condition of long-run civilisation, not a sentimental refusal of development.
Evidence	The Chipko movement, a locally verified 1970s Himalayan forest-protection movement, shows that communities can contest extraction whose costs they bear (12).
Counterclaim	A single local movement cannot prove that communities alone can reverse every extractive pressure or meet every development need.

Move	Prose-ready content
Switching condition	Community restraint should govern where local ecological loss is immediate and cumulative; wider public capacity is required where livelihoods, infrastructure and interregional costs must be reconciled.
Synthesis	Durable development combines locally visible ecological limits with institutions capable of sharing the costs of respecting them.

7. India-first illustration starters

ANALYSIS: Recall one Indian illustration for the counter-view itself, not only for the original thesis - e.g. a documented instance where excessive caution (not boldness) caused harm, to genuinely test the "doing nothing" thesis. Full discipline: 12.

8. Thesis options and selection

ANALYSIS: If the counter-view turns out to be stronger than your original thesis can withstand, revise the thesis's qualification (see 05) rather than ignoring the objection - a thesis that survives its strongest objection, suitably qualified, is more defensible than one that never faced it.

9. Simple essay architecture

ANALYSIS: Place the counter-view/synthesis as one distinct paragraph (or two) after the main argument-map cycles and before the conclusion - see 07 for exact sequencing.

10. Opening, body and closure moves

ANALYSIS: Introduce the counter-view with a fair, non-dismissive phrase ("A reasonable objection holds that..."), develop it briefly with its own mechanism/illustration, then pivot to synthesis ("Yet this need not defeat the broader claim, because..."). Avoid closing the counter-view paragraph without a clear pivot back to your thesis.

11. WRONG: Traps and repair moves

- WRONG: **One-sided moralising** (asserting the thesis with no counter-view where a serious objection exists). -> Repair: use Section 5's Q1-Q2 to test the thesis; where no separate counter-view paragraph is needed, integrate the qualification into the relevant argument cycle.
- WRONG: **Straw-manning the counter-view** (stating a weak version easy to dismiss). -> Repair: state the objection as its strongest advocate would.
- WRONG: **Unresolved "on the other hand"** (stating the counter-view and moving on without synthesis). -> Repair: always follow with an explicit synthesis sentence (Section 5, Q4).
- WRONG: **Synthesis that just restates the original thesis unchanged.** -> Repair: show what the thesis's qualification became *because of* the counter-view.

12. Timed micro-drill and self-check

5-minute drill: For any thesis from 05, write: the strongest counter-view (2 sentences), what it gets right (1 sentence), and the synthesis (1-2 sentences).

Self-check: Would a fair-minded person who holds the counter-view agree that you have represented their position accurately, even if they still disagree with your synthesis? If not, restate the counter-view more fairly.

Complete advanced knowledge

Subject: Essay | **Tier:** Advanced | **GS Paper:** Essay (General Studies Paper - Essay, Mains). **Core area:** Dialectical method - thesis, counter-claim, condition/ limit, higher synthesis - applied rigorously across multiple argument cycles rather than as a single token paragraph. **Grounded in:** V1 (2018-2025) UPSC Essay paper corpus (see [../README.md](#)); [../00_Master-Framework.md](#) Section 6. **Research cutoff:** 18 July 2026. **Tags:** FACT: verified fact | ANALYSIS: strategy/inference | CURRENT: dated anchor | WRONG: trap/boundary. **Companion:** [../basic/08_Argument-Counterargument-and-Synthesis.md](#)

1. Advanced proposition and boundary

Proposition: ANALYSIS: Core 08 supplies two simple, evidence-disciplined mini-cycles. This companion keeps the optional harder task: dialectical synthesis is strongest when the counter-claim is drawn from a genuinely different value or mechanism than the thesis, not merely a softened restatement of it - real tension produces real synthesis.

Boundary: WRONG: this topic does not construct the original thesis (05) or decide paragraph placement (07) - it supplies the counter-argument-and-synthesis content itself.

2. Concept definition and taxonomy

- **Weak counter-claim:** a minor exception dressed up as an objection (e.g. "of course there are some exceptions" with nothing specified).
- **Strong counter-claim:** a genuinely opposing mechanism or value that, taken alone, would support a different conclusion (Section 3 gives worked examples).
- **Conditional limit:** the specific circumstance under which the counter-claim, rather than the thesis, should prevail.
- **Higher synthesis:** a position that is not a simple average of thesis and counter-claim, but a reframing that shows both are correct under different, now-specified conditions.

3. Tension pairs and hidden assumptions

Thesis	Strong counter-claim (genuine, not weak)	Hidden assumption exposed
2025-B5 "Muddy water... leaving it alone" - restraint resolves conflict	Some emergencies (public-health, safety) worsen without timely intervention	Assumes all disturbance is unhelpful; ignores urgency-dependent cases
2024-B7 "Large-consequence ideas... always simple"	Complex problems sometimes require complex, multi-part solutions with no single simple core	Assumes every large-consequence idea has an irreducibly simple core; some may not
2025-A4 "Bitter experiences" teach best lessons	Some suffering is purely destructive and teaches nothing without support/ reflection	Assumes adversity automatically produces learning; ignores the role of support and reflection

4. Levels of analysis and temporal-spatial scale

ANALYSIS: Test whether the counter-claim operates at the same scale as the thesis or a different one - e.g. for 2024-B7, the thesis may hold at the scale of *moral/political principle* (simple) while the counter-claim holds at the scale of *implementation mechanics* (complex); recognising this scale-shift is itself the synthesis ("simple compass, sophisticated implementation"), rather than a contradiction to be argued away.

5. Stakeholder map and distributional effects

ANALYSIS: For value-conflict theses (2025-B8 contentment/luxury; 2024-B6 power/ character), identify which stakeholder's interest the counter-claim represents - e.g. the counter-claim to "contentment is natural wealth" might represent the interests of those still below a basic sufficiency threshold, for whom aspiration is not luxury but legitimate need. A synthesis should explicitly preserve this stakeholder's claim (e.g. sufficiency-with-equity) rather than universalising a comfortable position.

6. Causality, mechanisms and feedback loops

THESIS (mechanism A supports claim X)
|
v
STRONG COUNTER-CLAIM (mechanism B supports NOT-X, or a different X')
|
v
IDENTIFY THE CONDITION under which each mechanism dominates
(e.g. reversibility, urgency, existing sufficiency level, disciplined vs undisciplined form)
|
v
HIGHER SYNTHESIS: state which mechanism governs under which condition
(not "both are somewhat true" - name the actual switching condition)

ANALYSIS: The switching condition (the "identify the condition" step) is the single most valuable output of this process - an essay that skips it and simply asserts "there is truth on both sides" has not actually synthesised anything.

7. Necessary/sufficient conditions and exceptions

ANALYSIS: A genuine synthesis requires (a) a strong, fairly-stated counter-claim and (b) an explicit switching condition - both are necessary; a counter-claim without a switching condition yields an unresolved "on the other hand" (a common basic-level trap), and a switching condition without a genuinely strong counter-claim yields a synthesis that resolves nothing because there was no real tension to begin with.

8. Paradox, dialectic and counterfactual test

Paradox: the essays that appear most "decisive" are often those that have most carefully specified *when* they are not the right answer - a thesis with a precisely bounded exception reads as more authoritative than an unqualified absolute claim. **Counterfactual test:** "Under what specific, describable circumstance would the counter-claim clearly outweigh my thesis?" If you cannot describe such a circumstance concretely, either the counter-claim is weak (Section 2) or your thesis is already too narrow to be interesting.

9. Ethical conflict and synthesis

ANALYSIS: Where the tension is explicitly a value conflict (autonomy vs. accountability, sufficiency vs. aspiration, restraint vs. intervention), name the values by their ethical content, not only their practical consequence - full ethical-framework method in 10. The higher synthesis should state which value takes priority under the specified condition, and why, rather than avoiding a stated priority altogether.

10. Evidence/source-risk and India application

ANALYSIS: The counter-claim's illustration should be as carefully verified as the thesis's illustration - a common advanced-writer shortcut is to support the thesis with a real example but state the counter-claim only abstractly; both sides of the dialectic deserve equal evidentiary discipline (09, 12).

11. Advanced structure, paragraph sequencing and style

ANALYSIS: For a multi-cycle essay (05, Section 6), the dialectical counter-claim/synthesis can either appear once, globally, near the end (simpler, safer under time pressure), or once per cycle (richer, higher risk of repetition if not carefully varied) - choose the global version unless each cycle's counter-claim is genuinely distinct enough to avoid repeating the same switching-condition logic.

12. WRONG: Failure modes and revision protocol

- WRONG: **Weak counter-claim dressed as strong** (Section 2). -> Protocol:

test whether the counter-claim, taken alone, would genuinely support a different conclusion; if not, find a stronger one or drop the exercise.

- WRONG: **Missing switching condition** ("both sides have a point," full stop). -> Protocol: always name the specific condition under which each side dominates (Section 6).

- WRONG: **Asymmetric evidence** (thesis illustrated, counter-claim left abstract). -> Protocol: verify one recallable illustration for the counter-claim too.

13. CURRENT: Dated anchor / practice lab / transfer task

CURRENT: **Dated anchor**: not applicable - dialectical method is stable and does not depend on current-affairs content.

Practice lab: For 2024-B6 ("power tests character"), write the strongest counter-claim (adversity, not power, is the truer test), identify the switching condition, and state the higher synthesis in three sentences total.

Transfer task: Repeat the same three-sentence exercise for 2025-B7 ("life as journey, not destination") on a separate occasion, and check whether your switching condition is concrete and specific in both cases; log any vagueness in 16's error log.

V1 PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance**: Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented**: 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023
- **Paper(s)**: Essay
- **Routed question demands**: 5

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive /​ format	Source status	Owner requirement
2019	Essay	3	Best for an individual is not necessarily best for the society	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2020	Essay	6	Social justice and economic prosperity as mutually dependent	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2021	Essay	8	There are better practices to best practices	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2022	Essay	8	Having a choice does not mean any of them has to be right	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive /​ format	Source status	Owner requirement
2023	Essay	1	Thinking as a game that needs an opposite team	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​2023;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.

What this owner must now support

- Best for an individual is not necessarily best for the society
- Social justice and economic prosperity as mutually dependent
- There are better practices to best practices
- Having a choice does not mean any of them has to be right
- Thinking as a game that needs an opposite team

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

TOPIC 09 - Evidence, Examples, Data and Quotation Discipline

Complete foundational knowledge

Subject: Essay | **Tier:** Must-Do | **GS Paper:** Essay (General Studies Paper - Essay, Mains). **Core area:** Using examples, data and quotations safely and proportionately; the mandatory quotation-attribution safety rule for the 16 recent prompts and the wider 100-prompt ledger. **Grounded in:** V1 (2018-2025) UPSC Essay paper corpus (see [../README.md](#)); [../00_Master-Framework.md](#) Sections 8, 13. **Research cutoff:** 18 July 2026. **Tags:** FACT: verified fact | ANALYSIS: strategy/inference | CURRENT: dated anchor | WRONG: trap/boundary. **Companion:** [../advanced/09_Evidence-Examples-Data-and-Quotation-Discipline.md](#)

1. Purpose and scope

This topic covers how to use evidence inside an essay - examples, data and quotations - and, critically, the rule for using the prompt itself and any other quotation safely. It works alongside 12 (the illustration bank) but focuses on the *discipline*, not the content catalogue.

2. Core terms in plain language

- **Example:** a single instance of the thing being discussed. It makes an abstraction concrete; on its own it establishes that something *can* happen, not that it generally does.
- **Evidence:** material offered to support the truth of a claim - a documented pattern, an institutional fact, a sourced figure. Evidence bears a burden an example does not: it must be accurate *and* actually bear on the claim.
- **Analogy:** a transfer of structure from another domain ("policy reform is like repairing a roof"). **WRONG:** An analogy illustrates and can clarify a mechanism, but it **proves nothing** - the two domains are similar by the writer's choice, not by demonstration.
- **Functional example:** an illustration used to demonstrate a specific claim, not decoration or a fact dropped without purpose.
- **Evidence-dumping:** citing many examples or statistics without connecting each to the argument.
- **False precision:** stating a specific number or "latest" fact that cannot actually be verified.

- **Quotation-attribution safety:** the rule that a prompt or aphorism is

used without naming an author unless a primary/authoritative source independently verifies exact wording, authorship and context.

ANALYSIS: Why the example/evidence/analogy distinction earns marks. The sentence "Chipko shows that communities can restrain extraction" uses an example as evidence for a modal claim (*can*) - legitimate. "Chipko shows that community action is sufficient to protect forests" uses the same example as evidence for a general claim it cannot carry. "Forests are the lungs of the nation" is an analogy: useful for vividness, worthless as support. **WRONG:** The commonest failure is an analogy quietly doing the work of evidence - check whether your paragraph's support could be denied by someone who simply rejects the comparison.

2a. Quotation vs. paraphrase

	Quotation	Paraphrase
What it reproduces	Exact printed words, inside quote marks	The idea, in your own words
Risk carried	Wording, punctuation, authorship, translation, context	Only fidelity of meaning
When required	When the exact phrasing is itself the object of analysis	Almost everywhere else
Applies to the prompt	FACT: Safe for V1 (2018-2025; 64 rows), defects included	ANALYSIS: Preferred for V2 (2013-2017; 36 rows) until checked

ANALYSIS: Quotation marks are a promise about *wording*, not merely a signal of borrowing. If you cannot keep that promise - because you are recalling an aphorism, or working from a corpus row that has not been verified against the official paper - paraphrase instead. **WRONG:** Half-remembered quotation inside quote marks is a fabrication even when the idea is right, and it buys nothing a clean paraphrase would not.

3. FACT: Exam facts / source basis

- **FACT:** All **64 V1 prompts (2018-2025)** are printed ****without any author attribution**** in the source papers (see . . /PYQ-Corpus-2013-2025.md).

- **FACT:** The 2018-2025 rows are **V1** - read directly from local official papers and reproduced with their printed defects intact. **ANALYSIS:** The 36 rows from 2013-2017 are **V2** - not checked against an official paper locally, and therefore to be paraphrased rather than quoted verbatim (Section 2a).

- **ANALYSIS:** Because no V1 prompt prints an author, this folder's default rule is: **quote the prompt exactly, or paraphrase it faithfully; never attach an author's name to it.**

4. The central idea and common misreading

ANALYSIS: Central idea: evidence should follow the rule *one claim -> one function -> one verified source* - every example or quotation must be doing identifiable work for a specific claim. **WRONG: Common misreading:** treating evidence density as a proxy for quality - stacking multiple half-remembered facts, statistics or "famous quotes" to look erudite, which in fact increases factual risk without adding argumentative strength.

5. Basic decomposition questions

1. What specific claim does this example or quotation support?
2. Can I state the example accurately without inventing a number, date, or detail I am unsure of?
3. If I am tempted to quote a name alongside the prompt or a supporting aphorism, do I have a primary/authoritative source verifying it - or should I omit the name?
4. Is this the only example needed for this claim, or am I stacking redundant ones?
5. Would removing this piece of evidence leave the claim unsupported, or was it decorative?

6. Dimension-expansion grid

Use case	Safe practice
The UPSC prompt itself, 2018-2025 (V1; 64 rows)	Quote exactly as printed (see . . /​PYQ-Corpus-2013-2025.md), defects included; or paraphrase faithfully. No author needed or invented.
The UPSC prompt itself, 2013-2017 (V2; 36 rows)	ANALYSIS: Paraphrase, unless you have checked the official paper for that year - the ledger wording is carried forward, not locally verified.
A familiar aphorism recalled from general reading, with uncertain attribution	WRONG: Do not attribute an author. Either omit it, or use it as an unattributed proposition only if not presented as a direct quotation.
A named quotation from a known thinker	Use only after verifying exact wording, author, translation and context against a primary or authoritative source. Otherwise paraphrase the idea without quotation marks or attribution.
An analogy	Use to clarify a mechanism, never as support for a claim - state the mechanism it is standing in for, so the argument survives if a reader rejects the comparison.
A statistic or "current" fact	State only when an authoritative source and date are known and can be recorded. Otherwise describe a verified qualitative pattern or omit the claim.

Three complete evidence units

These units model the required chain. "Locally verified" means the underlying historical/institutional fact is verified in 12; it does not turn the analytical inference into an official finding.

Claim	Named evidence /​ status	Why it supports the claim	Limit /​ safe use
Communities can make environmental costs politically visible before ecological damage becomes normalised.	Chipko movement - 1970s Himalayan forest-protection movement; locally verified in 12.	It supplies a concrete instance of collective resistance to extraction by people bearing its costs.	It does not prove that all extraction is reversible through community action alone. Use for a <i>can constrain</i> claim, not a universal claim.
Public accountability needs institutional channels, not only personal virtue.	Right to Information Act, 2005 - its year and the Central and State Information Commissions are locally verified in 12.	Citizen scrutiny makes reasons and decisions more contestable, supporting an argument about accountable discretionary power.	It does not itself establish enforcement, ethical conduct, or complete transparency in every case.

Claim	Named evidence /​ status	Why it supports the claim	Limit /​ safe use
Long-run knowledge institutions can create strategic capacity.	India's space programme (ISRO) - candidate-recalled institutional illustration in 12; verify its precise facts against the linked Science-and-Technology source before live use.	It can make concrete the mechanism by which sustained research capacity becomes technological and strategic capability.	One institution cannot prove broad innovation access or resolve the digital divide; do not attach unverified launch, budget, or ranking data.

7. India-first illustration starters

ANALYSIS: Prefer institutions, well-documented policy episodes, or widely known social patterns you can describe accurately without a specific invented number - e.g. "a national digital-literacy initiative" rather than a guessed enrolment figure. Full discipline: 12.

8. Thesis options and selection

ANALYSIS: Choose illustrations that support the *specific* mechanism in your thesis (05), not a generic example that could support many different theses - a generic example signals the thesis has not been sharpened enough yet.

9. Simple essay architecture

ANALYSIS: Budget roughly one functional illustration per argument-map cycle (05, 07) - 2 to 4 across the whole essay is typically sufficient; more than this risks evidence-dumping (Section 2).

10. Opening, body and closure moves

ANALYSIS: Avoid opening or closing with a "famous quote" you cannot verify - opening with the prompt's own tension (see 06) is safer and more directly responsive to the actual question asked.

11. WRONG: Traps and repair moves

- WRONG: **Attaching a guessed author's name to the prompt or an aphorism.**
- > Repair: state it unattributed; the prompt's own wording is sufficient warrant (Section 6).
- WRONG: **Inventing a statistic to sound authoritative.** -> Repair: describe the pattern qualitatively, or omit the claim entirely.
- WRONG: **Analogy used as proof.** -> Repair: state the mechanism the analogy is standing in for, and support *that* - an analogy the reader rejects should not take a claim down with it (Section 2).
- WRONG: **Quotation marks around half-remembered wording.** -> Repair: paraphrase. Quote marks promise exact wording; a paraphrase carries the idea at no risk (Section 2a).
- WRONG: **Evidence-dumping** (stacking three examples for one claim). -> Repair: keep the single strongest, most accurate example.
- WRONG: **Treating a V2 corpus row as certified printed wording.** -> Repair: paraphrase it, or check the official paper for that year before quoting (. /PYQ-Corpus-2013-2025 .md).

12. Timed micro-drill and self-check

5-minute drill: For any thesis from 05, list the illustrations you plan to use and, for each, write one sentence stating the specific claim it supports. Cross out any illustration whose supporting claim is vague or shared with another illustration.

Self-check: For every quotation and current statistic, do you have the authoritative source and (for a current claim) date needed to stand behind it? If not, paraphrase qualitatively or remove it.

Complete advanced knowledge

Subject: Essay | **Tier:** Advanced | **GS Paper:** Essay (General Studies Paper - Essay, Mains). **Core area:** A full source/risk ledger discipline for prompts, aphorisms, named quotations and statistics; calibrating evidentiary confidence rather than treating "cite or omit" as binary. **Grounded in:** V1 (2018-2025) UPSC Essay paper corpus (see ../README.md); ../00_Master-Framework.md Sections 8, 13. **Research cutoff:** 18 July 2026. **Tags:** FACT: verified fact | ANALYSIS: strategy/inference | CURRENT: dated anchor | WRONG: trap/boundary. **Companion:** ../basic/09_Evidence-Examples-Data-and-Quotation-Discipline.md

1. Advanced proposition and boundary

Proposition: ANALYSIS: Core 09 supplies usable evidence units and the non-negotiable verification rule. This companion treats evidentiary discipline as a risk-calibration exercise - every example, statistic, or quotation carries a confidence level, and the essay should only use claims at a confidence level the candidate can genuinely stand behind under examiner scrutiny. **Boundary:** WRONG: this topic does not build the illustration catalogue itself (12 owns the India-centric bank) - it supplies the discipline governing how any evidence, from any source, is used.

2. Concept definition and taxonomy

- **Verified claim:** confirmed by a primary or authoritative source, or a printed exam-paper fact (e.g. the prompt wording itself).
- **Recalled-general claim:** a pattern the candidate is reasonably confident about from general awareness (an institution's existence, a well-known policy debate) but without a precise statistic attached.
- **Unverifiable claim:** a specific number, date, or "latest" development the candidate cannot confirm - should not appear in the essay at all.
- **Attribution risk:** the specific risk of naming a wrong author, a wrong translation, or a fabricated context for a quotation.

3. Tension pairs and hidden assumptions

- **Erudition vs. accuracy:** the assumption that naming authors and statistics signals depth; in fact, unverifiable attribution or false precision is a credibility risk with no compensating benefit, since neither audited paper rewards name-dropping.
- **Completeness vs. safety:** the assumption that every claim needs a named source is false for general, well-known patterns (e.g. "public discourse on digital well-being exists in India") - over-citation for common-knowledge claims can read as padding.

4. Levels of analysis and temporal-spatial scale

ANALYSIS: Calibrate evidentiary confidence differently by claim type: prompt wording (verified, use freely per Section 2); institutional existence or well-known policy debate (recalled-general, safe to state without a specific statistic); precise current statistic (requires genuine verification - if unavailable, describe qualitatively per basic/09 Section 6).

5. Stakeholder map and distributional effects

ANALYSIS: Misattributed quotations or invented statistics do not just risk the candidate's own score - in a public-facing essay genre, they also risk misinforming a reader who trusts the claim. This is a minor but genuine reason (beyond exam risk) to maintain the discipline described here.

6. Causality, mechanisms and feedback loops - the source/risk ledger

Use case	Printed author?	Permissible use	Attribution status	Verification source needed	Risk if misused
2018-2025 prompts (V1, 64 rows)	No (see . . /​PYQ-Corpus-2013-2025.md)	Quote exactly as printed, defects included, or paraphrase	Unattributed by design	None - the local official paper is the source	Low, if quoted/​paraphrased accurately
2013-2017 prompts (V2, 36 rows)	Only 2013-1, itself unverified	Paraphrase; quote only after checking the official paper for that year	Do not attribute	The official paper for that year	Medium - carried-forward wording may differ from print
Familiar aphorism, uncertain web attribution	Not applicable	Use only as an unattributed proposition, or omit	Do not attribute	Would need a primary/​authoritative source, typically unavailable	High - misattribution undermines credibility
Named quotation from a known thinker	N/​A (not from this corpus)	Use only after verification	Attribute only if verified	Primary text or authoritative anthology/​translation	High - wrong wording/​author/​context
Analogy	N/​A	Clarify a mechanism; never offer as support	Not a source claim at all	None - but the underlying mechanism must be supported separately	Medium - an argument that collapses if the comparison is rejected
Indian/​translated text	N/​A	Identify translator/​edition if quoted; else paraphrase	Attribute translator if known and verified	Cited edition	Medium - translation variance
Current statistic	N/​A	State only if source and date are genuinely known	Cite source and date	Dated official/​primary source	High - false precision, staleness

7. Necessary/sufficient conditions and exceptions

ANALYSIS: Verification is necessary before naming any author or citing any specific statistic; it is not sufficient by itself to justify inclusion - the claim must also be functionally relevant to the specific paragraph claim (Section 1 of the basic file). **Exception:** the UPSC prompt itself needs no external verification beyond the source paper already audited in . . /README.md - it is the one class of "quotation" this folder treats as inherently safe to use.

8. Paradox, dialectic and counterfactual test

Paradox: the essays that appear most well-read are often those that use the *fewest* named quotations, because they rely instead on precise, functional illustration of mechanism - heavy quotation density can signal insecurity about the argument's own strength rather than mastery. **Counterfactual test:** "If I removed every named-author quotation from this essay, would the argument still stand on its illustrations and mechanisms alone?" If not, the essay was leaning on borrowed authority rather than its own reasoning - restructure to rely on illustration and mechanism instead.

9. Ethical conflict and synthesis

ANALYSIS: There is a genuine intellectual-honesty dimension here: presenting an unverified quotation as verified, or a guessed statistic as known, misrepresents the candidate's actual knowledge state to the examiner. **Synthesis:** state confidence honestly - a well-argued essay using only recalled-general claims (Section 2) is more defensible than one using impressive-sounding but unverifiable specifics.

10. Evidence/source-risk and India application

FACT: Apply the ledger (Section 6) to every one of the 64 V1 prompts before using them in a drafted essay - since all are unattributed by design, the correct practice across the V1 set is uniform: quote or paraphrase without an author. **ANALYSIS:** The 36 V2 prompts (2013-2017) are not locally verified and should be paraphrased unless checked against the official paper for that year. **ANALYSIS:** For India-application illustrations, prefer institutions and documented episodes (recalled-general confidence) over precise current statistics unless a specific source and date are genuinely known (12).

11. Advanced structure, paragraph sequencing and style

ANALYSIS: Place the most confidently verified evidence (the prompt's own wording, well-known institutional facts) at the structurally most prominent points (opening, thesis statement, conclusion), and reserve any lower-confidence, qualitative claims for interior body paragraphs where they support rather than anchor the argument.

12. WRONG: Failure modes and revision protocol

- **WRONG: Guessed authorship attached to any of the 64 V1 prompts.** ->

Protocol: remove the name; the prompts are unattributed by design (Section 6).

- **WRONG: False precision** (a specific invented percentage or date). ->

Protocol: replace with a qualitative description or omit.

- **WRONG: Evidence-dumping** (multiple illustrations per claim). ->

Protocol: keep the single most accurate, functionally relevant illustration.

- **WRONG: Over-citation of common-knowledge claims.** -> Protocol: state well-known patterns plainly without an unnecessary source apparatus.

13. CURRENT: Dated anchor / practice lab / transfer task

CURRENT: Dated anchor: any genuinely current statistic used in an essay must carry its own source and date at the point of use (Section 6); this topic itself has no standing dated fact requiring a refresh.

Practice lab: Take three illustrations you would use for 2025-A2 ("supreme art of war... without fighting") and run each through the Section 6 ledger, marking confidence level and required verification.

Transfer task: Repeat the same ledger exercise for illustrations intended for 2024-A4 ("the doubter is a true man of science") on a separate occasion, checking whether your confidence-calibration is consistent; log any inflated-confidence claims caught late in 16's error log.

TOPIC 10 - Ethical and Philosophical Frameworks and Value Conflicts

Complete foundational knowledge

Subject: Essay | **Tier:** Must-Do | **GS Paper:** Essay (General Studies Paper - Essay, Mains). **Core area:** Applying ethics, constitutional values and Indian thought as analytical lenses on value conflicts, without name-dropping thinkers or duplicating Ethics-module theory. **Grounded in:** V1 (2018-2025) UPSC Essay paper corpus (see `../README.md`); `../00_Master-Framework.md` Section 7; Ethics module (for full thinker/theory depth). **Research cutoff:** 18 July 2026. **Tags:** FACT: verified fact | ANALYSIS: strategy/inference | CURRENT: dated anchor | WRONG: trap/boundary. **Companion:** `../advanced/10_Ethical-Philosophical-Frameworks-and-Value-Conflicts.md`

1. Purpose and scope

Several audited prompts compress a value conflict (accountability vs. autonomy, sufficiency vs. aspiration, restraint vs. intervention). This topic teaches how to name and resolve such conflicts as part of an essay argument - it does not reproduce the Ethics module's full theoretical apparatus (thinkers, schools, case studies), which remains that module's domain.

2. Core terms in plain language

- **Value conflict:** a situation where two legitimate values point to different conclusions (e.g. individual liberty vs. collective welfare).
- **Reasoned priority:** stating which value should generally take precedence under a specified condition, with a stated reason - not an unqualified ranking.
- **Name-dropping:** citing a thinker or school by name as a substitute for actually explaining the reasoning, rather than as a genuine analytical lens.

Compact ethical framework

Use a category only when it clarifies the prompt's actual tension; this is an essay lens, not a licence to list theories.

Category	Plain-language question	Typical scale	Boundary
Rights /&#8203; dignity	Whose basic claim must not be treated merely as a cost?	Individual	A right still needs fair institutions and feasible remedies.
Welfare	What course prevents the greatest avoidable harm or expands shared well-being?	Institution /​ state	Aggregate benefit must not erase a concentrated burden.
Fairness	Who receives the benefit, who bears the cost, and is that distribution defensible?	Community /​ state	Equal treatment may not repair unequal starting positions.
Care	What duty follows from dependency, vulnerability or relationship?	Family /​ community /​ institution	Care must not become paternalistic control.
Ecological responsibility	What cost is shifted to future generations or non-human systems?	Intergenerational /​ global	Present livelihoods cannot be dismissed as morally irrelevant.

3. FACT: Exam facts / source basis

- FACT: Several audited prompts directly compress a value conflict: 2024-B6 (power vs. character/accountability), 2025-B8 (contentment vs. luxury/aspiration), 2025-B5 (restraint vs. intervention) - see . . /README . md for exact wording.
- ANALYSIS: Neither paper specifies which ethical framework (if any) to apply; the frameworks below are general-purpose analytical tools, not an official requirement.

4. The central idea and common misreading

ANALYSIS: **Central idea:** name the values in genuine tension explicitly, then state a reasoned, conditional priority - this is more persuasive than either ignoring the conflict or asserting one value is simply "right." WRONG: **Common misreading:** dropping a philosopher's name (e.g. "as [thinker] said...") as decoration without actually using their reasoning to do analytical work - this reads as ornamental rather than substantive.

5. Basic decomposition questions

1. What two values does this prompt place in tension?
2. Is there a scale or context where one value should generally take priority, and why?
3. Is there a scale or context where the other value should prevail instead?
4. Can I state my reasoned priority in one sentence, with its condition attached?
5. Does my resolution avoid treating either value as simply wrong?
6. **Voiceless-stakeholder test:** whose interests are not represented in the immediate choice - future generations, an excluded group, or a non-human system - and would the priority change if its cost were counted?

6. Dimension-expansion grid

Prompt (example)	Values in tension	Reasoned priority (conditional)
2024-B6 "Power tests character."	Accountability/​restraint vs. autonomy/​discretion	Discretion should be bounded by institutional accountability where power affects others' rights; personal restraint matters most where oversight is weak
2025-B8 "Contentment... luxury."	Sufficiency vs. legitimate aspiration	Contentment should not be demanded of those below a basic sufficiency threshold; beyond that threshold, restraint on status-driven consumption is reasonable
2025-B5 "Muddy water... leaving it alone."	Restraint vs. timely intervention	Restraint where disturbance would worsen an already-settling situation; intervention where inaction causes ongoing, escalating harm

Worked conflict paragraph - power and accountability

Claim and conflict: Power needs enough discretion to act, but where its exercise changes another person's rights, fairness requires accountability. **Evidence:** the Right to Information Act, 2005, locally verified in 12, enables citizen scrutiny of public authority; it makes the case that character is tested not only inside an office holder but in the reasons an institution can defend. **Counterclaim:** complete exposure can impair candid deliberation and neglect legitimate privacy. **Voiceless-stakeholder test:** the affected citizen has less access to the decision-maker's information and must not disappear from the balance. **Synthesis:** prefer transparent, reviewable reasons where public rights are affected, while protecting narrowly justified private or sensitive interests; transparency alone, however, cannot guarantee enforcement or virtue.

7. India-first illustration starters

ANALYSIS: Recall one Indian illustration per value-conflict resolution - e.g. a documented instance of institutional accountability constraining discretionary power, or a documented public debate on consumption and sufficiency. Full discipline: 12.

8. Thesis options and selection

ANALYSIS: A thesis built on a reasoned, conditional priority (Section 6) is usually stronger than one that treats the conflict as fully resolved in one direction - see 05 for converting this into a full thesis sentence.

9. Simple essay architecture

ANALYSIS: Dedicate one paragraph to naming the conflict, one or two to developing each value's legitimate claim, and one to the reasoned priority/synthesis - see 07 for exact sequencing within the wider essay.

10. Opening, body and closure moves

ANALYSIS: Avoid opening or closing with a bare philosopher's name; instead state the value conflict in plain language, and let any thinker's reasoning (used sparingly, only where genuinely apt) support a specific paragraph's claim rather than serve as decoration.

11. WRONG: Traps and repair moves

- WRONG: **Name-dropping a thinker without using their reasoning.** ->

Repair: either explain the specific mechanism/reasoning briefly, or drop the name and state the point in plain language.

- WRONG: **Declaring one value simply "right" and the other "wrong."** ->

Repair: state a reasoned, conditional priority (Section 6) instead.

- WRONG: ****Treating the Ethics module's full theoretical machinery as required content.**** -> Repair: use only what the argument needs; for deeper theory, point to the Ethics module rather than reproducing it.

- WRONG: **Vague values language** ("balance is important") without naming the specific values or the condition. -> Repair: always name both values and the specific condition governing priority.

12. Timed micro-drill and self-check

5-minute drill: For any prompt with a value conflict (Section 6), write: the two values, one condition favouring each, and a one-sentence reasoned priority.

Self-check: Did you name a philosopher or school only to support a specific claim you also explain in your own words, or did the name stand in for the explanation? If the latter, add the explanation or remove the name.

V1 PYQ Integration (2018-2025)

Status: V1 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: `_PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2024-2025.md`.

- **Years represented:** 2024
- **Paper(s):** Essay
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive /​format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	Essay	Section A - 1	Forests precede civilizations and deserts follow them	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Routed to essay-method owner	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.

What this owner must now support

- Forests precede civilizations and deserts follow them

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Complete advanced knowledge

Subject: Essay | **Tier:** Advanced | **GS Paper:** Essay (General Studies Paper - Essay, Mains). **Core area:** Rigorous value-conflict resolution using rights, welfare, dignity, fairness, care and ecological responsibility as analytical categories; avoiding both relativism and unqualified absolutism. **Grounded in:** V1 (2018-2025) UPSC Essay paper corpus (see `../README.md`); `../00_Master-Framework.md` Section 7; Ethics module (for full thinker/theory depth). **Research cutoff:** 18 July 2026. **Tags:** FACT: verified fact | ANALYSIS: strategy/inference | CURRENT: dated anchor | WRONG: trap/boundary. **Companion:** `../basic/10_Ethical-Philosophical-Frameworks-and-Value-Conflicts.md`

1. Advanced proposition and boundary

Proposition: ANALYSIS: Core 10 supplies the compact category card, voiceless-stakeholder test and one worked paragraph. This companion keeps the harder task: a value conflict is resolved analytically, not rhetorically - by naming the specific ethical categories in tension (rights, welfare, dignity, fairness, care, ecological responsibility) and stating the condition under which each should govern, rather than by asserting a general "balance." **Boundary:** WRONG: this topic does not teach the Ethics module's full case-study or thinker-biography machinery - it supplies the essay-specific value-conflict method that draws lightly on that module as a lens.

2. Concept definition and taxonomy

- **Rights-based claim:** an entitlement that should not be overridden merely by aggregate welfare gains (e.g. individual dignity).
- **Welfare-based claim:** an outcome justified by net benefit to the greatest number, even if it burdens some individuals.
- **Care-based claim:** an obligation arising from relationship or dependency (e.g. duty toward the vulnerable), not from abstract universal rules.
- **Ecological-responsibility claim:** an obligation extending beyond present human stakeholders to future generations or non-human systems.

3. Tension pairs and hidden assumptions

Prompt (example)	Category 1	Category 2	Hidden assumption if unexamined
2024-A1 "Forests... deserts"	Welfare (present development benefits)	Ecological responsibility (future/intergenerational cost)	Assumes present welfare gains are costless; ignores compounding ecological debt
2024-B6 "Power tests character"	Rights/fairness (accountability constrains power)	Care (trust extended to competent, well-intentioned authority)	Assumes power is inherently corrupting; ignores that some discretion is functionally necessary
2025-B8 "Contentment... luxury"	Welfare/fairness (sufficiency for all)	Rights (freedom to aspire and consume within one's means)	Assumes aspiration is inherently excessive; ignores the sufficiency-vs-below-sufficiency distinction

4. Levels of analysis and temporal-spatial scale

ANALYSIS: Ethical categories operate differently by scale: dignity and rights are most directly assessed at the individual level; fairness and welfare scale naturally to institutional and state policy; ecological responsibility is inherently intergenerational and often global. An advanced essay should state explicitly which scale it is reasoning at when invoking a given category, rather than shifting scale silently mid-argument.

5. Stakeholder map and distributional effects

ANALYSIS: For each value conflict, map which stakeholder group is advantaged by prioritising each category - e.g. for 2024-A1, prioritising immediate welfare (development) advantages the present generation, while prioritising ecological responsibility advantages future generations and ecosystems with no current voice. Naming this asymmetry (who is represented, who is not) strengthens the synthesis.

6. Causality, mechanisms and feedback loops

NAME THE TWO ETHICAL CATEGORIES IN TENSION

|

v

STATE EACH CATEGORY'S STRONGEST CLAIM (not a straw version)

|

v

IDENTIFY THE CONDITION under which one should generally govern
(threshold, scale, reversibility, whose voice is represented)

|

v

STATE THE REASONED, CONDITIONAL PRIORITY

|

v

CHECK: does the priority still hold if the stakeholder without
present voice (future generations, excluded groups) is given weight?

ANALYSIS: The final feedback check (representing otherwise-silent stakeholders) is what distinguishes an advanced ethical resolution from a merely plausible-sounding one.

7. Necessary/sufficient conditions and exceptions

ANALYSIS: Naming the ethical categories precisely is necessary for a rigorous resolution but not sufficient - the resolution must also survive the stakeholder check (Section 6's final step). **Exception:** for prompts where the value conflict is minor or resolved quickly by the prompt's own logic (e.g. 2024-A4's doubt/denialism distinction), an extended multi-category ethical analysis may be disproportionate - use only the depth the argument genuinely needs.

8. Paradox, dialectic and counterfactual test

Paradox: the most ethically serious essays often refuse a clean "winner" between categories, instead showing that the categories are each valid at a different scale or threshold (Section 4) - this reads as more mature than either strict rights-absolutism or pure welfare- maximisation. **Counterfactual test:** "If the stakeholder currently without voice in this conflict (future generations, an excluded group) could speak, would my stated priority survive unchanged?" If not, revise the priority to account for that voice explicitly.

9. Ethical conflict and synthesis

ANALYSIS: The synthesis should state, in one sentence, which category governs under which condition, and acknowledge explicitly what is given up under that priority (e.g. "prioritising ecological responsibility in development policy accepts some foregone near-term welfare, justified by the scale and irreversibility of ecological debt") - an honest synthesis names its own cost, rather than presenting the resolution as costless.

10. Evidence/source-risk and India application

ANALYSIS: Illustrate each ethical category with one genuinely recalled Indian example - e.g. a documented instance of accountability mechanisms constraining discretionary institutional power, or public discourse around intergenerational environmental responsibility - rather than an abstract philosophical example disconnected from Indian context. Full discipline: 09, 12.

11. Advanced structure, paragraph sequencing and style

ANALYSIS: Sequence: name conflict -> develop category 1's strongest claim with illustration -> develop category 2's strongest claim with illustration -> stakeholder/voice check (Section 6) -> reasoned conditional priority as synthesis. This keeps the ethical analysis argumentative rather than a static "on one hand, on the other hand" listing.

12. WRONG: Failure modes and revision protocol

- WRONG: **Straw-manning one ethical category** to make the other easily win. -> Protocol: state each category's strongest form (Section 3) before resolving.
- WRONG: **Unqualified absolutism** ("rights always trump welfare," or vice versa). -> Protocol: attach the specific condition/threshold/scale (Section 6) to any stated priority.
- WRONG: **Ignoring the currently-voiceless stakeholder** (future generations, excluded groups). -> Protocol: always run the Section 8 counterfactual check before finalising the synthesis.

13. CURRENT: Dated anchor / practice lab / transfer task

CURRENT: Dated anchor: not applicable - ethical-framework method is stable; use the Ethics module for any current, dated ethical-policy anchor genuinely needed.

Practice lab: For 2024-A1 ("forests... deserts"), name the two ethical categories in tension, run the stakeholder/voice check, and state the reasoned conditional priority in two sentences.

Transfer task: Repeat the same two-sentence exercise for 2025-B8 ("contentment... luxury") on a separate occasion, and check whether your stated priority in both cases names an explicit condition rather than an unqualified ranking; log any unqualified priorities caught late in 16's error log.

V1 PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023
- **Paper(s):** Essay
- **Routed question demands:** 19

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive /​format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	Essay	2	A good life is one inspired by love and guided by knowledge	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2018	Essay	5	Customary morality cannot be a guide to modern life	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; section header OCR-read as SECTION-E in this scan	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2018	Essay	6	The past as a permanent dimension of human consciousness and values	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2019	Essay	1	Wisdom finds truth	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive /​ format	Source status	Owner requirement
2019	Essay	2	Values are not what humanity is but what humanity ought to be	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2020	Essay	1	Life is a long journey between human being and being humane	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2020	Essay	2	Mindful manifesto as the catalyst to a tranquil self	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2020	Essay	5	Culture is what we are, civilization is what we have	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2021	Essay	1	The process of self-discovery as technologically outsourced	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2021	Essay	2	Perception of me as a reflection of you and reaction as awareness	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2021	Essay	3	Philosophy of wantlessness as Utopian and materialism as chimera	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2021	Essay	4	The real is rational and the rational is real	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2021	Essay	7	History repeats itself first as tragedy then as farce	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2022	Essay	2	Poets as the unacknowledged legislators of the world	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2022	Essay	3	History as victories of the scientific man over the romantic man	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive /​format	Source status	Owner requirement
2022	Essay	6	You cannot step twice in the same river	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2023	Essay	3	Not all who wander are lost	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2023	Essay	6	Mathematics is the music of reason	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2023	Essay	7	A society that has more justice needs less charity	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.

What this owner must now support

- A good life is one inspired by love and guided by knowledge
- Customary morality cannot be a guide to modern life
- The past as a permanent dimension of human consciousness and values
- Wisdom finds truth
- Values are not what humanity is but what humanity ought to be
- Life is a long journey between human being and being humane
- Mindful manifesto as the catalyst to a tranquil self
- Culture is what we are, civilization is what we have
- The process of self-discovery as technologically outsourced
- Perception of me as a reflection of you and reaction as awareness
- Philosophy of wantlessness as Utopian and materialism as chimera
- The real is rational and the rational is real
- History repeats itself first as tragedy then as farce
- Poets as the unacknowledged legislators of the world
- History as victories of the scientific man over the romantic man
- You cannot step twice in the same river
- Not all who wander are lost
- Mathematics is the music of reason
- A society that has more justice needs less charity

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

TOPIC 11 - Cross-Sector Lenses and Scale

Complete foundational knowledge

Subject: Essay | **Tier:** Must-Do | **GS Paper:** Essay (General Studies Paper - Essay, Mains). **Core area:** Applying governance, economy, society, science and technology, environment, culture/history and international-relations lenses at the scale a thesis actually needs - not a token pass through every lens. **Grounded in:** V1 (2018-2025) UPSC Essay paper corpus (see . . /README.md); . . /00_Master-Framework.md Section 7. **Research cutoff:** 18 July 2026. **Tags:** FACT: verified fact | ANALYSIS: strategy/inference | CURRENT: dated anchor | WRONG: trap/boundary. **Companion:** . . /advanced/11_Cross-Sector-Lenses-and-Scale.md

1. Purpose and scope

This topic teaches which cross-sector lens to apply to a given prompt and at what scale, so that argument-map cycles (05) draw on the right mechanism rather than a generic one. It does not supply the GS content itself - each lens points to the owning subject module for depth.

2. Core terms in plain language

- **Lens:** a disciplinary angle (governance, economy, society, science/tech, environment, culture/history, ethics, IR) used to develop one argument-map cycle.
- **Scale:** the level (individual, institution, state, global, civilisational) at which a lens's mechanism operates most naturally for a given prompt.
- **Token lens use:** naming a lens in passing without developing its mechanism or an illustration - a common shallow-essay habit.

3. FACT: Exam facts / source basis

- **FACT:** Neither audited paper specifies which lenses to use for any prompt; lens selection is entirely the candidate's own analytical choice (see . . /README.md).
- **ANALYSIS:** The lens list and scale-matching guidance below are pedagogical tools built from this folder's own reading of the 16 recent prompts, not an official requirement.

4. The central idea and common misreading

ANALYSIS: Central idea: choose **two to four** lenses that genuinely fit the prompt's tension and develop each with a real mechanism and illustration - depth in fewer lenses outperforms a token pass through all seven or eight. Use a fourth lens only when it adds a distinct causal step or value conflict. **WRONG: Common misreading:** mechanically working through every lens ("politically... economically... socially...") regardless of fit, producing a checklist-style essay rather than an argued one.

5. Basic decomposition questions

1. Which two or three lenses does this prompt's tension most naturally touch?
2. At what scale does each chosen lens's mechanism operate best (individual, institutional, state, global)?
3. Can I state one specific mechanism per chosen lens, not just a label?
4. Do I have one recallable illustration per chosen lens?
5. Would a lens I am tempted to include add a genuinely new dimension, or merely repeat a point already made under another lens?

6. Dimension-expansion grid

Prompt (example)	Fitting lenses	Scale for each
2024-A2 "Empires of the mind"	Science & Technology; Economy; Governance	Institutional (research capacity) -> state (strategic autonomy) -> global (platform power)
2025-A2 "Supreme art of war... without fighting"	International Relations; Ethics	State (deterrence/​diplomacy) -> global order (conflict prevention)
2025-B8 "Contentment... luxury"	Economy; Society; Environment	Individual (consumption) -> society (status competition) -> ecological (footprint)

Mechanism-scale-limit cards

Lens	Prose-ready mechanism	Natural scale	Evidence function	Limit to state
Governance	Rules, incentives and accountability change what institutions can justify and correct.	Institution /​ state	A law, regulator or public institution can show how a decision is made reviewable.	A rule on paper does not prove implementation.
Economy	Prices, livelihoods and unequal access distribute opportunities and burdens.	Household /​ market /​ state	A policy or livelihood episode can make a distributional claim concrete.	GDP or aggregate gain alone cannot establish fairness.
Society	Norms, status and relationships shape behaviour before formal policy intervenes.	Individual /​ community	A social pattern can explain why identical rules affect groups differently.	One group experience cannot stand for all society.
Science and technology	Design choices expand capabilities while also creating new dependencies or risks.	Institution /​ platform /​ state	A research institution or technology-policy episode can connect capability to power.	Innovation alone does not establish equitable access.
Environment	Ecological costs accumulate and can shift burdens across place and generations.	Local ecosystem /​ intergenerational	A conservation or extraction episode can expose an externalised cost.	A local episode cannot prove a universal ecological outcome.
Culture /​ history	Memory and inherited practices shape what a society can imagine, value or repeat.	Community /​ civilisation	A historical comparison can show continuity or learning over time.	Tradition is not self-validating.
Ethics	Rights, welfare, fairness and care disclose who is protected or overlooked by a choice.	Individual to global	A value conflict can make the normative cost explicit.	"Balance" is empty without a stated priority and condition.
International relations	Security, interdependence and unequal power alter the room a state has to act.	State /​ global order	A diplomatic or strategic case can show external constraints.	State interest alone cannot settle the ethical question.

Interaction chain and tests

For an unfamiliar prompt such as **"A society that automates choice may weaken judgment"**, use a real causal hand-off, not three parallel labels:

Technology: engagement-optimised or delegated design changes what choices are visible

- > Society: repeated delegation can weaken reflective habits and redistribute autonomy
- > Governance: the resulting accountability gap requires transparent design, redress and public oversight

Scale-match test: does the illustration operate at the scale of the claim? A household example cannot by itself prove a state-wide governance effect. **Counterfactual test:** remove the middle social link. If the governance claim still follows unchanged, the chain is decorative; either state a real hand-off or use two independent lenses.

7. India-first illustration starters

ANALYSIS: For each chosen lens, recall one Indian illustration functionally tied to that lens's mechanism - e.g. a documented research/innovation policy episode for the Science & Technology lens on "empires of the mind." Full discipline: 12.

8. Thesis options and selection

ANALYSIS: Let the thesis (05) determine which lenses are needed, not the reverse - do not force a lens onto a thesis that does not require it merely to appear comprehensive.

9. Simple essay architecture

ANALYSIS: Typically, one lens develops per argument-map cycle/paragraph cluster (07) - matching the **two-to-four** lens limit to two-to-four distinct cycles keeps the essay focused rather than diffuse.

Multi-lens outline - unfamiliar prompt

Prompt: "A society that automates choice may weaken judgment."

1. **Thesis:** automation is valuable when it expands informed capacity, but it weakens judgement when opaque design replaces reflection and removes routes for correction.
2. **Technology / platform-scale paragraph:** explain how design decides which options become visible; use a verified policy or institutional illustration only after checking the linked owner.
3. **Society / individual-to-community paragraph:** show how repeated delegation affects agency unevenly, especially where digital literacy and bargaining power differ; state that an observed pattern is not universal.
4. **Governance / institution-scale paragraph:** argue for transparency, contestability and redress because the earlier technology-to-society hand-off creates an accountability gap.
5. **Synthesis:** do not oppose automation to human judgement; require automation that leaves people informed, able to contest and able to correct consequential choices.

10. Opening, body and closure moves

ANALYSIS: Signal the chosen lenses implicitly through the content of body paragraphs, not by naming them explicitly ("From an economic perspective...") in a checklist style - let the mechanism and illustration make the lens apparent.

11. WRONG: Traps and repair moves

- **WRONG: Checklist lens-listing** (touching every lens briefly). -> Repair:

cut to the two to four lenses the thesis actually needs, developed in depth.

- **WRONG: Explicit lens-labelling** ("Politically speaking...",

"Economically speaking..."). -> Repair: let mechanism and illustration imply the lens; avoid mechanical signposting.

- **WRONG: Wrong-scale mechanism** (e.g. discussing "empires of the mind" only

at the individual level, missing the institutional/global stakes). -> Repair: check Section 6's scale-matching before drafting.

- **WRONG: Lens repetition** (two lenses making the same point in different vocabulary). -> Repair: verify each lens's claim is genuinely distinct (cross-link 04).

12. Timed micro-drill and self-check

5-minute drill: For any prompt, list all lenses that could plausibly apply, then cross out any that would only restate a point already made by another lens. Keep the two to four strongest.

Self-check: For each kept lens, can you state its mechanism and scale in one sentence without using the lens's own name (e.g. without saying "economically")? If not, the lens has not yet been developed enough to use.

Complete advanced knowledge

Subject: Essay | **Tier:** Advanced | **GS Paper:** Essay (General Studies Paper - Essay, Mains). **Core area:** Selecting lens combinations that interact (rather than merely coexist), and matching mechanism to the precise scale where it is most defensible. **Grounded in:** V1 (2018-2025) UPSC Essay paper corpus (see `../README.md`); `../00_Master-Framework.md` Section 7. **Research cutoff:** 18 July 2026. **Tags:** FACT: verified fact | ANALYSIS: strategy/inference | CURRENT: dated anchor | WRONG: trap/boundary. **Companion:** `../basic/11_Cross-Sector-Lenses-and-Scale.md`

1. Advanced proposition and boundary

Proposition: ANALYSIS: Core 11 supplies mechanism-scale-limit cards, one interaction chain and basic tests. This companion keeps the harder task: the strongest essays use lenses that interact - one lens's mechanism creates the condition the next lens's mechanism responds to - rather than lenses that sit side by side making independent points.

Boundary: WRONG: this topic does not supply the substantive GS content for any lens (owned by the respective subject module, see `../README.md`'s boundary table) - it supplies the selection and interaction discipline.

2. Concept definition and taxonomy

- **Parallel lens use (weaker):** governance, economy and society lenses

each make an independent point about the same prompt, with no connection between them.

- **Interacting lens use (stronger):** one lens's outcome becomes the next lens's input - e.g. a technology lens's mechanism (algorithmic design) creates the social lens's condition (comparison-driven distress), which then creates the governance lens's problem (platform accountability).

- **Scale mismatch:** applying a lens's mechanism at a scale where it is not actually defensible (e.g. discussing "empires of the mind" only at the level of individual motivation, missing the institutional/global stakes that make the aphorism interesting).

3. Tension pairs and hidden assumptions

- **Breadth vs. interaction:** the assumption that using more lenses

signals more sophistication is false - an essay using three interacting lenses is stronger than one using six parallel ones.

- **Universal applicability vs. genuine fit:** the assumption that

every lens (especially Ethics and IR) can be forced onto every prompt; in fact some prompts (e.g. 2024-A3 "happiness is the path") are poorly served by an IR lens and well served by society/governance/ethics.

4. Levels of analysis and temporal-spatial scale

ANALYSIS: For each lens, state explicitly which scale its mechanism is being argued at, and check whether the illustration matches that scale - e.g. an Economy lens on 2025-B8 ("contentment... luxury") argued at the individual-consumption scale needs an individual/household illustration, not a national GDP statistic, which would belong to a state-scale argument instead.

5. Stakeholder map and distributional effects

ANALYSIS: When lenses interact (Section 2), track which stakeholder is affected at each stage of the interaction chain - e.g. for the FOMO prompt (03), the technology lens's mechanism (engagement-optimised design) affects platforms' commercial stakeholders, the social lens's consequence affects youth users, and the governance lens's response affects the state/regulator - showing the full chain demonstrates genuine cross-sector reasoning rather than parallel restatement.

6. Causality, mechanisms and feedback loops

```
LENS A mechanism produces OUTCOME A
|
v
OUTCOME A becomes the CONDITION for LENS B's mechanism
|
v
LENS B mechanism produces OUTCOME B
|
v
OUTCOME B becomes the CONDITION for LENS C's mechanism (governance/policy response)
```

Example for 2024-A2 ("empires of the mind"): Science & Technology lens (innovation capacity) produces knowledge-based competitive advantage -> this becomes the condition for the Economy lens (which nations/firms capture the value) -> this becomes the condition for the Governance lens (policy on education, R&D investment, digital-divide mitigation).

7. Necessary/sufficient conditions and exceptions

ANALYSIS: Lens interaction (Section 2) is necessary for the strongest essays but not always achievable for every prompt - some prompts (2025-B6, "years teach... days") are more naturally served by two lenses in parallel (individual/psychological and institutional/historical-memory) than by a forced interaction chain. **Exception:** do not manufacture an interaction that is not genuinely there; a well-developed parallel use of two lenses beats a strained, artificial interaction chain.

8. Paradox, dialectic and counterfactual test

Paradox: using fewer lenses, chosen for genuine fit and interaction, often reads as *more* comprehensive than using many lenses in parallel, because the interaction chain demonstrates systemic understanding rather than a checklist.

Counterfactual test: "If I removed lens B from my interaction chain, would lens C's argument still make sense?" If not, the interaction is genuine (B is a necessary link); if C's argument is unaffected, the chain may be artificial and should be simplified.

9. Ethical conflict and synthesis

ANALYSIS: Where an interaction chain crosses into a value conflict (e.g. Economy lens revealing a distributional cost that a Governance lens must then adjudicate), name the values explicitly per 10's method rather than letting the lens-interaction narrative silently resolve the ethical question by omission.

10. Evidence/source-risk and India application

ANALYSIS: Each link in an interaction chain needs its own recallable Indian illustration or, at minimum, a defensible general mechanism - a chain where only the first lens is illustrated and the rest are asserted abstractly is evidentially weaker than one where each link is grounded. Full discipline: 09, 12.

11. Advanced structure, paragraph sequencing and style

ANALYSIS: An interaction chain (Section 6) maps naturally onto sequential paragraphs, each explicitly picking up the previous lens's outcome as its own starting condition - this produces the transition quality 07 describes as load-bearing, since the lens-interaction structure itself supplies genuine linking content.

12. WRONG: Failure modes and revision protocol

- **WRONG: Checklist lens use with no interaction.** -> Protocol: for at least one pair of lenses, state explicitly how one's outcome becomes the other's condition (Section 6).
- **WRONG: Scale mismatch between lens and illustration.** -> Protocol: check Section 4 before finalising each illustration.
- **WRONG: **Forced interaction chain that does not survive the counterfactual test.**** -> Protocol: simplify to parallel lens use if the interaction is not genuine (Section 8).

13. CURRENT: Dated anchor / practice lab / transfer task

CURRENT: Dated anchor: not applicable - lens-selection method is stable; any current, dated fact used within a specific lens should be sourced per 09.

Practice lab: For 2025-A2 ("supreme art of war... without fighting"), build a two-lens interaction chain (IR mechanism -> Ethics/Governance response) and state explicitly how the first lens's outcome becomes the second's condition.

Transfer task: Repeat the same two-lens interaction exercise for 2024-B5 (FOMO) using Section 6's worked technology->society->governance chain as a model, and check whether your own chain passes the counterfactual test in Section 8; log any artificial links in 16's error log.

V1 PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023
- **Paper(s):** Essay
- **Routed question demands:** 9

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive /​format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	Essay	1	Alternative technologies for a climate change resilient India	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2018	Essay	3	Poverty anywhere is a threat to prosperity everywhere	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2019	Essay	5	South Asian societies woven around plural cultures and identities	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2019	Essay	8	Rise of Artificial Intelligence, jobless future or reskilling opportunity	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2020	Essay	7	Patriarchy as the least noticed structure of social inequality	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2020	Essay	8	Technology as the silent factor in international relations	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2021	Essay	5	The hand that rocks the cradle rules the world	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2022	Essay	1	Forests as the best case studies for economic excellence	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2023	Essay	5	Girls weighed down by restrictions and boys by demands	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​203;theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.

What this owner must now support

- Alternative technologies for a climate change resilient India
- Poverty anywhere is a threat to prosperity everywhere
- South Asian societies woven around plural cultures and identities
- Rise of Artificial Intelligence, jobless future or reskilling opportunity
- Patriarchy as the least noticed structure of social inequality
- Technology as the silent factor in international relations
- The hand that rocks the cradle rules the world

- Forests as the best case studies for economic excellence
- Girls weighed down by restrictions and boys by demands

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

TOPIC 12 - India-Centric Illustration Bank

Complete foundational knowledge

Subject: Essay | **Tier:** Must-Do | **GS Paper:** Essay (General Studies Paper - Essay, Mains). **Core area:** A governed catalogue of India-centred illustrations, each following claim -> candidate illustration -> essay function -> limitation -> source-module link - never a bare fact dump. **Grounded in:** durable Constitution/Act texts, official institutional owners and dated official sources identified in Section 6; linked GS subject modules for full depth; audited 2024-2025 UPSC Essay paper corpus (see `../README.md`) for prompt mapping. **Research cutoff:** 18 July 2026. **Tags:** FACT: verified fact | ANALYSIS: strategy/inference | CURRENT: dated anchor | WRONG: trap/boundary. **Companion:** `../advanced/12_India-Centric-Illustration-Bank.md`

1. Purpose and scope

This topic is the illustration bank other topics point to for functional examples. It does not develop mechanism/argument itself (05, 08) - it curates recallable, verifiable Indian illustrations in a disciplined format and links each to the prompt(s) and lens(es) it serves.

2. Core terms in plain language

- **Source-status-tagged illustration:** a non-statistical institutional, historical, constitutional, statutory or policy example whose row states whether it rests on a primary text, durable owner or a refreshed official source.
- **Essay function:** the specific claim the example is used to demonstrate - never used as a standalone fact.
- **Limitation:** the boundary of what the example does *not* prove, so it is not overstated.
- **Source-module link:** the GS folder owning the full depth of this fact, for further study.

3. FACT: Evidence and source basis

- The bank uses durable constitutional, statutory, institutional and historical facts. Every row names a **source status** and an owning module; it is not permission to invent a number, outcome, or quotation.
- **FACT:** A primary-text row may be used qualitatively as written. Check the linked owner before quoting a provision or adding a current outcome.
- **CURRENT:** A live-policy row must be refreshed against the named official source immediately before a live attempt. Its date is part of the fact.
- **WRONG:** No percentage, ranking, funding figure, beneficiary count, or claimed implementation outcome belongs in this bank without a dated authoritative source.

4. The central idea and common misreading

ANALYSIS: **Central idea:** every illustration must be usable in the exact chain **claim -> fact/source status -> essay function -> limitation -> owner** - an example without a stated function and limitation is a fact dump, not an essay illustration. **WRONG: Common misreading:** memorising a list of "good examples for Essay" and inserting them wherever convenient, regardless of whether they actually demonstrate the specific claim at hand.

5. Basic decomposition questions

1. What specific claim does this example support?
2. Is the example a widely documented fact I can state without inventing a number?
3. What is this example's essay function here (illustrating a mechanism, a value conflict, a counter-case)?
4. What does this example *not* prove - where does its relevance stop?
5. Which GS module owns the full depth of this fact, if the reader wants more?

6. Cross-domain illustration bank - claim -> fact/source status -> function -> limitation -> owner

Claim	Durable fact and source status	Essay function	Limitation	Owner
Community agency can restrain extraction	Chipko was a 1970s Himalayan forest-protection movement. Verified local historical source.	Ecological restraint; collective action	One movement cannot settle every development trade-off	Environment-and-Ecology, Modern-Indian-History
Institutions can check discretionary power	RTI Act, 2005 creates Central and State Information Commissions. Verified local polity source.	Accountability beyond personal virtue	Disclosure alone does not assure remedy	Governance, Polity
Knowledge capacity is a form of national power	ISRO is India's civil space institution. Durable institutional fact; ISRO owner.	Long-horizon public research capacity	One institution does not prove universally inclusive innovation	Science-and-Technology, Economy
Equality needs institutional protection	Articles 14-16 establish equality before law and non-discrimination/equal opportunity. Primary Constitution text.	From formal equality to public obligation	Formal equality does not itself remove social disadvantage	Polity, Social-Justice
Dignity requires social reform as well as law	Article 17 abolishes untouchability. Primary Constitution text.	Law as a moral-civic commitment	Constitutional prohibition alone cannot establish lived equality	Polity, Indian-Society
Representation can redistribute voice	The 73rd Amendment provides that not less than one-third of panchayat seats are reserved for women. Primary Constitution text.	Gendered participation in local democracy	Presence in office is not identical to effective agency	Polity, Indian-Society

Claim	Durable fact and source status	Essay function	Limitation	Owner
Work security can be framed as entitlement	MGNREGA is a 2005 Act providing a legal rural employment guarantee. Primary Act; use no outcome statistic without refresh.	Dignity of labour and state capacity	A statutory guarantee does not prove uniform delivery	Economy, Governance
Cooperation can connect producers and markets	Amul grew through dairy cooperatives. Durable ND DB/8203;cooperative-history fact.	Collective economic agency	A cooperative example is not a solution to every farm-market problem	Economy, Governance
Education is a rights-based public good	RTE Act, 2009 provides free and compulsory education for children aged 6-14. Primary Act.	Capability formation across generations	Enrolment entitlement is not proof of learning quality	Social-Justice, Indian-Society
Nutrition and dignity require public systems	National Food Security Act, 2013 provides a statutory food-security framework. Primary Act.	Welfare as capability protection	Legal coverage does not establish nutritional adequacy	Economy, Social-Justice
Federalism needs a forum, not merely divided lists	Article 279A establishes the GST Council. Primary Constitution text.	Negotiated intergovernmental coordination	A forum does not erase fiscal disagreement	Polity, Economy
Constitutional remedies make rights actionable	Article 32 guarantees the right to move the Supreme Court for enforcement of fundamental rights. Primary Constitution text.	Judiciary as rights-protecting institution	Litigation access and enforcement can remain uneven	Polity, Governance
Plural culture needs constitutional space	Articles 29-30 protect cultural and educational rights of minorities. Primary Constitution text.	Diversity within constitutional citizenship	Protection of groups must coexist with equal individual rights	Polity, Indian-Art-and-Culture
Public action must prepare for shocks	Disaster Management Act, 2005 provides the statutory disaster-management framework. Primary Act.	Prevention and institutional preparedness	A framework does not prove local readiness	Disaster-Management, Governance
Peace can be pursued without romanticising power	Panchsheel was articulated in the 1954 India-China agreement. Durable MEA historical record.	Coexistence and diplomatic restraint	Principles do not eliminate strategic conflict	International-Relations, Modern-Indian-History
Access to justice has a distributive dimension	Article 39A directs equal justice and free legal aid. Primary Constitution text.	Justice beyond formal courtroom equality	A directive principle is not proof of universal access	Polity, Social-Justice
Public campaigns can mobilise behavioural action	Swachh Bharat Mission is a nationwide sanitation mission. Official programme owner; do not claim outcomes without a dated source.	Civic participation plus state coordination	Participation and targets are not uniform outcomes	Governance, Indian-Society

Claim	Durable fact and source status	Essay function	Limitation	Owner
Innovation needs guardrails	India AI Governance Guidelines were launched in 2026 . CURRENT: Official IndiaAI source; refresh implementation claims.	Accountable innovation	Guidelines are not a comprehensive AI statute or proof of implementation	Ethics, Science-and-Technology
Technology diplomacy can frame shared goals	India AI Impact Summit's core summit ran 16-20 February 2026 ; its Expo extended to 21 February. CURRENT: Official IndiaAI source.	People-Planet-Progress framing	An agenda/"; event is not delivered impact	Science-and-Technology, International-Relations
Safeguarded action may be phased	Digital Personal Data Protection Rules, 2025 were notified 13 November 2025 , with staged commencement. CURRENT: MeitY Gazette notification.	Sequenced regulation rather than paralysis	Data protection does not resolve every platform or AI harm	Science-and-Technology, Internal-Security

ANALYSIS: The function and limitation columns are analytical judgements. The source status validates only the durable factual core; it never validates an exaggerated inference.

7. Selection, reuse and refresh protocol

PROMPT CLAIM -> choose a cross-domain example -> state its mechanism

- > state the limitation -> record owner/source status
- > live or dated policy? refresh official source and date
- > reused example? give it a demonstrably different function

Reuse is allowed only when the paragraph claim and stated function differ. Do not use one familiar example in both essays merely because it is easy to recall. For CURRENT: entries, re-check the owning official source immediately before writing; remove the entry if status, date or claimed implementation cannot be confirmed.

8. Thesis options and selection

ANALYSIS: Match the illustration to the specific mechanism in your thesis (05) - e.g. use the Chipko illustration only where your thesis actually concerns collective ecological restraint, not merely because the prompt mentions forests.

9. Simple essay architecture

ANALYSIS: Budget one illustration per argument-map cycle (07) drawn from this bank or your own verified recall - avoid clustering two illustrations in one paragraph and leaving another paragraph without any.

10. Opening, body and closure moves

ANALYSIS: Reserve your most vivid, well-verified illustration for a body paragraph where it does real argumentative work; avoid spending the opening or closing paragraph on an illustration instead of the prompt's own tension (06).

11. WRONG: Traps and repair moves

- **WRONG: Fact-dumping** (stating the Chipko movement or ISRO's programme without connecting it to a specific claim). -> Repair: always state the claim and function before or after the example (Section 6's format).
- **WRONG: Overstating an example's proof value** (treating one institution's success as proof of a general claim). -> Repair: always state the limitation explicitly.
- **WRONG: Inventing a statistic to make an example sound more impressive.**
-> Repair: state the fact qualitatively and verifiably; omit any number you cannot confirm (09).
- **WRONG: Reusing the same illustration in both required essays** with no new function stated. -> Repair: prefer a fresh, functionally distinct illustration for each essay to demonstrate range.

12. Timed micro-drill and self-check

5-minute drill: Pick a row from a domain you normally avoid. For an unmapped prompt, write its full chain (claim -> fact/source status -> function -> limitation -> owner) from memory, then verify the source status.

Self-check: For any illustration you plan to use, can you state its limitation as confidently as its function? If you can only state the impressive part and not the limitation, you may be overstating its proof value.

Complete advanced knowledge

Subject: Essay | **Tier:** Advanced | **GS Paper:** Essay (General Studies Paper - Essay, Mains). **Core area:** Extending the illustration bank with multi-claim examples, cross-prompt reuse discipline, and a refresh protocol for any illustration that touches a live policy debate. **Grounded in:** the source-status-tagged Core illustration bank (Constitution/Act texts, official institutional owners and dated official sources), linked GS subject modules for full depth, and audited 2024-2025 UPSC Essay paper corpus (see `../README.md`) for prompt mapping. **Research cutoff:** 18 July 2026. **Tags:** FACT: verified fact | ANALYSIS: strategy/inference | CURRENT: dated anchor | WRONG: trap/boundary. **Companion:** `../basic/12_India-Centric-Illustration-Bank.md`

1. Advanced proposition and boundary

Proposition: ANALYSIS: a mature illustration bank is organised by **function**, not by subject label - the same verified example can serve different essay functions across different prompts, provided each use states its own claim, function and limitation afresh. **Boundary:** WRONG: this topic does not replace the GS subject modules' factual depth (Section 12 links, not duplicates) - it governs how illustrations are selected, reused across prompts, and refreshed for currency.

2. Concept definition and taxonomy

- **Single-function example:** used for one specific claim only (most basic-file entries).
- **Multi-function example:** the same underlying fact, reused across different prompts with a genuinely different function each time (see Section 3).
- **Illustration reuse risk:** using the same example in both required essays, or repeatedly across practice attempts, without varying its stated function - signals a shallow illustration repertoire.
- **Refresh flag:** a marker on any illustration whose currency depends on an evolving policy situation, requiring a check against its named official source and recording its access date before live use.

3. Tension pairs and hidden assumptions

ANALYSIS: Multi-function reuse, worked example - the **Right to Information Act, 2005**:

Prompt/context	Function
2024-B6 "Power tests character"	Illustrates institutional accountability constraining discretionary power
2025-A1 "Truth knows no color"	Illustrates a legal mechanism for equal access to official information regardless of the requester's status
2024-A4 "The doubter is a true man of science"	Illustrates institutionalised scrutiny/verification as a civic analogue to scientific doubt

ANALYSIS: **Hidden assumption to avoid**: that reusing a familiar example signals efficiency; if the *function* is not restated distinctly for each prompt, the reuse reads as recycling rather than range.

4. Levels of analysis and temporal-spatial scale

ANALYSIS: Classify each bank entry by the scale at which its function operates - individual (a documented personal-conduct episode), institutional (an Act, agency, or programme), state (a national policy stance), or civilisational (a long-run historical pattern) - and match this to the scale identified for the prompt in 11, to avoid using an institutional-scale example to illustrate a claim pitched at the individual scale.

5. Stakeholder map and distributional effects

ANALYSIS: For each illustration, note which stakeholder group is centred by the example and which is not - e.g. the Chipko-movement illustration centres forest-dependent community agency; it says less about, and should not be overstated as resolving, state-level industrial-policy trade-offs. An advanced essay states this explicitly rather than letting the example imply a broader resolution than it supports.

6. Causality, mechanisms and feedback loops

```
SELECT CORE-BANK EXAMPLE (source status known)
|
v
STATE ITS MECHANISM (what causal/structural link does it demonstrate?)
|
v
MATCH MECHANISM TO SPECIFIC PARAGRAPH CLAIM (05/07)
|
v
STATE THE LIMITATION explicitly (what it does NOT prove)
|
v
IF THE EXAMPLE TOUCHES A LIVE POLICY SITUATION -> refresh the named
official source, record the date, then apply the refresh flag (13)
```

ANALYSIS: Skipping the "match mechanism to specific claim" step is the most common source of fact-dumping even among advanced writers who have already memorised good examples.

7. Necessary/sufficient conditions and exceptions

ANALYSIS: A verified, functionally matched illustration is necessary for a strong body paragraph but not sufficient on its own - the mechanism and qualification (05) must still be argued, not merely implied by the example's presence.

Exception: for very tightly reasoned aphorism essays (e.g. 2025-A3, "thought finds a world and creates one also"), a single, deeply developed illustration may outperform two shallower ones.

8. Paradox, dialectic and counterfactual test

Paradox: the examples that most impress on paper are often the least "famous" ones - a precisely matched, honestly limited example outperforms a grand but loosely connected one (e.g. invoking a major global institution vaguely, versus a smaller, precisely relevant Indian episode). **Counterfactual test:** "If I swapped this example for any other broadly similar one, would my specific claim still be equally well-supported?" If yes, the example was interchangeable filler, not a precisely matched illustration.

9. Ethical conflict and synthesis

ANALYSIS: Where an illustration involves a contested or sensitive episode, present it with due limitation and without partisan framing - the essay should use the example's structural/functional lesson, not take a side in an unrelated political controversy the essay is not actually arguing about.

10. Evidence/source-risk and India application

FACT: basic/12 now records a source status and owner for every entry: primary Constitution/Act text, a durable institutional/historical owner, or a **CURRENT:** official current source. Use the factual core only at the precision its status supports. A durable row does not license a recalled statistic; a **CURRENT:** row must be refreshed against its named official source immediately before live use. Do not add a funding amount, ranking, percentage or implementation claim without a dated authoritative source (09).

11. Advanced structure, paragraph sequencing and style

ANALYSIS: When using a multi-function example (Section 3) across the same essay's two argument-map cycles (an unusual but sometimes valid choice), make the distinct function explicit each time it reappears, so the repetition reads as a deliberate callback rather than as running out of material.

12. WRONG: Failure modes and revision protocol

- **WRONG: Reuse without restated function** (Section 3). -> Protocol: always state the specific claim being illustrated on each reuse.

- **WRONG: Overstated proof value** (Section 5). -> Protocol: name the stakeholder/scale the example does not speak to.

- **WRONG: Stale refresh-flagged example used without a currency check.** ->

Protocol: verify against the linked source module or a dated source before using in a live attempt (Section 13).

13. CURRENT: Dated anchor / practice lab / transfer task

Dated anchor	Reusable function	Limitation / refresh rule
CURRENT: India AI Governance Guidelines, 2026	Knowledge-power, ethical imagination, accountable innovation	Official IndiaAI source; policy framework, not a comprehensive AI statute or proof of implementation
CURRENT: India AI Impact Summit, core summit 16-20 February 2026; Expo to 21 February	People-Planet-Progress synthesis for science, inclusion and sustainability prompts	Official IndiaAI source; agenda/event is not proof of delivered outcomes
CURRENT: DPDP Rules, notified 13 November 2025	Sequenced, safeguarded action for technology/data dilemmas	Data protection does not resolve all social-media or AI risks

Any additional live-policy illustration carries a refresh flag: verify its status against the named official/primary source immediately before use, record the access date, and remove the claim if the status cannot be confirmed. When reusing an example, record the distinct paragraph claim, function and limitation; otherwise replace it with a different domain.

Practice lab: Take the Right to Information Act example (Section 3) and write out its three distinct functions from memory, checking each against its matched prompt.

Transfer task: Identify one new multi-function Indian example of your own (not listed in this bank) and map at least two distinct, honestly limited functions for it across two different audited prompts; log the exercise and any overstatement caught in 16's error log.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2018, 2019
- **Paper(s):** Essay
- **Routed question demands:** 3

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive /​format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	Essay	4	Management of Indian border disputes as a complex task	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2019	Essay	6	Neglect of primary health care and education as reasons for backwardness	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.
2019	Essay	7	Biased media as a real threat to Indian democracy	Essay · 125 marks · 1000-1200 words	Method routing only; prompt content is not pre-taught anywhere in this kit	Use as a brainstorming/​theme test; this owner supplies essay method, not a model essay.

What this owner must now support

- Management of Indian border disputes as a complex task
- Neglect of primary health care and education as reasons for backwardness
- Biased media as a real threat to Indian democracy

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

TOPIC 13 - Time Management, Planning and Execution

Complete foundational knowledge

Subject: Essay | **Tier:** Must-Do | **GS Paper:** Essay (General Studies Paper - Essay, Mains). **Core area:** Executing choice, planning, drafting and revision for two 1000-1200-word essays within the paper's real time constraint.

Grounded in: audited 2024-2025 UPSC Essay paper corpus (see ../README.md); ../00_Master-Framework.md Section 3. **Research cutoff:** 18 July 2026. **Tags:** FACT: verified fact | ANALYSIS: strategy/inference | CURRENT: dated anchor | WRONG: trap/boundary. **Companion:** ../advanced/13_Time-Management-Planning-and-Execution.md

1. Purpose and scope

This topic covers execution mechanics - how to allocate the paper's available time across choice, planning, drafting and revision for two essays. It assumes the analytical topics (01-12) are already understood; here they are sequenced under a clock.

2. Core terms in plain language

- **Choice-and-decode time:** minutes spent scanning prompts and selecting (01) plus initial decoding (02/03).
- **Planning time:** minutes spent building the argument map (05) and paragraph plan (07) before drafting prose.
- **Drafting time:** minutes spent writing continuous prose for the chosen structure.
- **Revision buffer:** minutes reserved at the end for the sweep described in 14/15.

3. FACT: Exam facts / source basis

- **FACT:** The Essay paper baseline is **3 hours (180 minutes)** for two essays of about 1000-1200 words, one chosen from each Section. Use the current official paper/admit card if an examination notice changes this.
- **FACT:** The 2024 paper prints "(125 × 2 = 250)"; the locally held 2025 copy has no marks line. Neither fact creates an official phase-wise timing rule.
- **ANALYSIS:** The minute plan below is a pedagogical starter, not a UPSC prescription. Its value is that it can be timed, diagnosed and adjusted.

4. The central idea and common misreading

ANALYSIS: Central idea: allocate time deliberately across all four phases (choice, planning, drafting, revision) for *both* essays, rather than spending most of the time on the first essay and rushing the second. **WRONG: Common misreading:** starting to write immediately after reading the prompt, skipping planning entirely, and discovering the structure has no clear thesis only after several paragraphs are already drafted.

5. Basic decomposition questions

1. How much total time do I have for both essays combined? (FACT: Start with the verified 180-minute baseline; check the current official paper/admit card for any change.)
2. How much time will I spend on choice-and-decode versus planning versus drafting versus revision, for each essay?
3. Am I allocating roughly similar planning discipline to both essays, or favouring the one I feel more confident about?
4. What is my trigger to stop planning and start drafting (e.g. a completed argument map)?
5. What is my trigger to stop drafting and start revising (e.g. reaching the upper end of the word range)?

6. Dimension-expansion grid

Clock point /​ phase	Starter allocation	Non-negotiable output
0-10: select and decode both choices	10 min total	One viable thesis direction and evidence inventory for each essay
10-25: Essay 1 plan	15 min	Thesis, 3-4 paragraph clusters, counter-view, conclusion direction
25-85: Essay 1 draft	60 min	Complete 1000-1200-word draft; do not borrow Essay 2 time
85-95: Essay 1 revision	10 min	Relevance, evidence-risk, transition and legibility sweep
95-110: Essay 2 plan	15 min	Equivalent complete plan
110-170: Essay 2 draft	60 min	Complete 1000-1200-word draft
170-180: Essay 2 revision	10 min	Same four-part sweep

Checkpoints: at minute **25**, Essay 1 must be planned; at **95**, it must be revised and closed; at **180**, both essays must be submitted. The 95-minute point is a hard cap: an unfinished Essay 1 is closed with its strongest available conclusion so Essay 2 retains its full budget.

7. India-first illustration starters

ANALYSIS: Not directly applicable to this topic's content - see 12 for the illustration bank itself; this topic only concerns how much time to spend selecting and inserting illustrations during drafting.

8. Thesis options and selection

ANALYSIS: Cap thesis-selection time (05) explicitly - if no thesis has emerged after a reasonable, pre-decided number of minutes, commit to the strongest available option rather than continuing to search for a "perfect" one.

9. Simple essay architecture

ANALYSIS: Use the paragraph-count plan from 07 as your drafting checklist - knowing you have, say, 9-12 planned paragraphs helps you pace drafting time evenly rather than over-writing the introduction and rushing the conclusion.

10. Opening, body and closure moves

ANALYSIS: Protect enough time to write a deliberate conclusion (06) - a common time-pressure failure is a rushed, generic final paragraph because all remaining time was spent on the body.

11. WRONG: Traps and repair moves

- **WRONG: Skipping planning to "save time."** -> Repair: even a compressed plan (thesis + 3-4 line argument map) is faster overall than discovering structural problems mid-draft.
- **WRONG: **Over-investing in the first essay, leaving little time for the second.**** -> Repair: pre-commit to a time cap per essay and track it.
- **WRONG: No protected revision buffer.** -> Repair: treat the revision sweep (14/15) as non-negotiable, not optional "if time permits."
- **WRONG: Continuing to search for a better thesis indefinitely.** -> Repair: set a decision deadline (Section 8) and commit.
- **WRONG: Calling a partial draft a mock.** -> Repair: a paper mock always means two complete essays under the 180-minute clock; partial drafting is a named micro-drill, not a substitute.

11A. Recovery protocol under the clock

If this phase overruns	Pre-decided recovery action
Choice/decode	Commit to the current-best thesis; do not reopen all options
Planning	Keep thesis, three clusters and counter-view; delete surplus branches
Drafting	Reduce the number of clusters, not the mechanism/qualification inside those retained
Revision	Run relevance plus factual/quotation-risk checks first; language polish comes last

ANALYSIS: Record which recovery action was triggered. Repeated use identifies an underlying skill to repair, rather than a reason to permanently compress the same phase.

12. Timed micro-drill and self-check

Timed drill: Run a complete two-essay paper: choose one prompt from each Section, follow the 25/95/180 checkpoints, draft and revise both essays, and record actual minutes for every phase.

Self-check: Did Essay 2 receive its planned 85 minutes? Record every missed checkpoint and recovery action in 16's error log. Change the next plan only after a pattern across three attempts, not after one bad day.

Complete advanced knowledge

Subject: Essay | **Tier:** Advanced | **GS Paper:** Essay (General Studies Paper - Essay, Mains). **Core area:** Adaptive time-budgeting based on diagnosed personal bottlenecks; recovery protocols when a phase overruns mid-attempt. **Grounded in:** audited 2024-2025 UPSC Essay paper corpus (see ../README.md); ../00_Master-Framework.md Section 3. **Research cutoff:** 18 July 2026. **Tags:** FACT: verified fact | ANALYSIS: strategy/inference | CURRENT: dated anchor | WRONG: trap/boundary. **Companion:** ../basic/13_Time-Management-Planning-and-Execution.md

1. Advanced proposition and boundary

Proposition: ANALYSIS: time-budgeting should be personalised from diagnosed bottlenecks (measured in practice, per basic/13 Section 12), not copied from a generic split - a candidate whose actual weakness is slow thesis-formation needs a different allocation than one whose weakness is over-long drafting. **Boundary:** WRONG: this topic does not teach the underlying skills (01-12) - it teaches how to sequence and recover them under a real clock.

2. Concept definition and taxonomy

- **Bottleneck phase:** the phase that most consistently overruns its planned allocation across your own timed attempts.
- **Recovery protocol:** a pre-decided, specific action taken when a phase overruns mid-attempt (Section 6), rather than an improvised panic response.
- **Two-essay budget interdependence:** the fact that overrunning on essay one directly reduces available time for essay two - the budget must be tracked jointly, not per-essay in isolation.
- **Absolute vs. personalised budget:** FACT: The paper baseline is 180 minutes. basic/13 supplies a labelled pedagogical 10 + 85 + 85 starter plan; ANALYSIS: modify phase allocations only from logged evidence, never by silently taking time from Essay 2.

3. Tension pairs and hidden assumptions

- **Perfectionism vs. completion:** the hidden assumption that spending

extra time refining the first essay improves the overall paper; in practice, both essays must be completed and one must be chosen from each displayed section, so overrunning on the first directly compromises the second.

- **Fixed template vs. adaptive budget:** the assumption that a single

time-split should be memorised and applied identically to every prompt; in fact issue-based prompts (03) may need more scoping time, while well-decoded aphorisms (02) may need less. The 25/95/180 completion checkpoints remain fixed unless the official paper says otherwise.

4. Levels of analysis and temporal-spatial scale

ANALYSIS: Track time at three levels: the whole-paper level (both essays plus any shared reading/choice time), the single-essay level (choice through revision), and the paragraph level (drafting pace per planned paragraph, from 07's paragraph-count plan) - a bottleneck can appear at any of these levels and needs a level-appropriate fix.

5. Stakeholder map and distributional effects

ANALYSIS: Not directly applicable in the usual sense - the only "stakeholder" in this topic's own scope is the candidate's own performance across two essays; the relevant distributional question is how minutes are allocated fairly between the two required essays rather than concentrated in one.

6. Causality, mechanisms and feedback loops - recovery protocols

PHASE OVERRUNS its planned time

|
v

DIAGNOSE: which phase, and by how much?

|

choice/decode overrun -----> commit to current-best thesis now (05, Section 8)
planning overrun -----> compress to a 3-4 line argument map, skip further options
drafting overrun -----> cut to fewer, better-developed paragraph clusters (07)
revision overrun (i.e. no time left) --> do only the relevance + evidence-risk sweep (14/15),
skip the language-polish pass

ANALYSIS: Deciding these recovery actions *in advance* (not in the moment of panic) is what separates an advanced execution plan from a merely aspirational one.

7. Necessary/sufficient conditions and exceptions

ANALYSIS: A pre-decided recovery protocol (Section 6) is necessary for resilient execution but not sufficient - it must be paired with honest, ongoing time-tracking (checking elapsed time at natural checkpoints, e.g. after choice, after planning) to be triggered at all. **Exception:** if a candidate's diagnosed bottleneck is consistently the *same* phase across many practice attempts, it is often more efficient to fix the underlying skill (e.g. faster decoding via 02) than to keep compensating with a recovery protocol every time.

8. Paradox, dialectic and counterfactual test

Paradox: spending slightly more time on planning than feels comfortable usually *reduces* total time to a finished essay, because it prevents a mid-draft structural rewrite, which is far more costly than an unhurried planning phase.

Counterfactual test: "If I had stopped planning two minutes earlier, would my draft have hit a structural problem I did not foresee?" If yes, planning time was actually under-allocated, not over-allocated, even though it felt slow at the time.

9. Ethical conflict and synthesis

ANALYSIS: Not a substantive ethical topic in itself; the closest relevant "conflict" is between the temptation to keep polishing a stronger essay and the fairness (to your own overall score) of ensuring the weaker essay also receives an adequate, complete attempt.

10. Evidence/source-risk and India application

ANALYSIS: Not directly applicable - this topic manages process, not content; evidence-risk discipline for the content itself is owned by 09/12. The only relevant "evidence" here is the candidate's own logged timing data from repeated practice attempts (Section 12 of the basic file, extended in 16).

11. Advanced structure, paragraph sequencing and style

ANALYSIS: Under a compressed drafting phase (Section 6), prefer cutting the *number* of paragraph clusters (e.g. from four dimensions to three) over cutting the *depth* of each remaining cluster - but still complete the required essay and preserve a conclusion. The 1000-1200-word range remains the target; do not mistake an emergency cut for a preferred short-essay strategy.

12. WRONG: Failure modes and revision protocol

- WRONG: **No pre-decided recovery protocol**, leading to panic-improvised cuts mid-draft. -> Protocol: memorise Section 6's table before any timed attempt.
- WRONG: **Ignoring diagnosed, repeated bottlenecks** and re-applying the same generic split every time. -> Protocol: adjust your personal time budget based on your own logged pattern (Section 7 exception).
- WRONG: **Treating the second essay's time budget as "whatever is left."**
-> Protocol: pre-commit to a hard cap for essay one regardless of how well it is going.

13. CURRENT: Dated anchor / practice lab / transfer task

CURRENT: **Dated anchor**: not applicable - execution/time-management method is stable and does not depend on current-affairs content.

Practice lab: Run one complete 180-minute, two-essay attempt using the 25/95/180 checkpoints. Deliberately force one phase overrun and apply Section 6's recovery protocol without taking the protected Essay 2 budget.

Transfer task: Repeat the same forced-overrun drill for a different phase on a separate occasion, and compare which recovery protocol felt most natural to execute under pressure; log the result and any first-time diagnosed bottleneck in 16's error log.

TOPIC 14 - Language, Style and Functional Visuals

Complete foundational knowledge

Subject: Essay | **Tier**: Must-Do | **GS Paper**: Essay (General Studies Paper - Essay, Mains). **Core area**: Precise, concise prose; avoiding ornamental vocabulary; using a visual only where it clarifies an actual process or comparison. **Grounded in**: audited 2024-2025 UPSC Essay paper corpus (see ../README.md); ../00_Master-Framework.md Section 10. **Research cutoff**: 18 July 2026. **Tags**: FACT: verified fact | ANALYSIS: strategy/inference | CURRENT: dated anchor | WRONG: trap/boundary. **Companion**: ../advanced/14_Language-Style-and-Functional-Visuals.md

1. Purpose and scope

This topic covers sentence- and paragraph-level language quality, and the narrow, disciplined case for using a visual inside a continuous prose essay. It assumes structure (07) and content (05, 08-12) are already in place.

2. Core terms in plain language

- **Precision:** using the word that states the claim exactly, not a vaguer synonym chosen for effect.
 - **Ornamental vocabulary:** words or phrases chosen to sound impressive rather than to communicate a specific meaning.
 - **Illustrative visual:** a diagram or table that carries information the prose would state less clearly - a genuine sequence, a genuine multi-item comparison. Removing it would cost the reader something.
 - **Decorative diagram:** a visual that restates in boxes and arrows what one sentence already said. Removing it would cost the reader nothing; it signals effort rather than supplying clarity.
- ANALYSIS: **The test is subtractive, not aesthetic.** Do not ask "does this look good?" - ask "if I delete this and say it in a sentence, what is lost?" An arrow chain showing social-media design -> comparison -> distress -> increased use -> distress again may earn its place because the *loop* is hard to hold in a sentence. A box labelled "Causes" above three bullet points does not. WRONG: In a continuous-prose essay the default is no visual at all; apply the two-gate test in Section 6A before using one.

3. FACT: Exam facts / source basis

- FACT: Neither audited paper specifies a required prose style or whether visuals/diagrams are permitted or expected within a written essay answer (see . . /README.md).
- ANALYSIS: Given the paper's continuous-essay format, this folder's guidance is that visuals should be rare and only used where they demonstrably clarify a process/comparison - this is a pedagogical caution, not an official prohibition or requirement.

4. The central idea and common misreading

ANALYSIS: **Central idea:** clear, precise, moderately plain prose communicates an argument better than dense, elaborate vocabulary - precision beats decoration. WRONG: **Common misreading:** believing that longer words, alliteration, or abstract phrasing make an essay sound more sophisticated - in fact these often obscure the actual claim being made.

5. Basic decomposition questions

1. Does this sentence state a specific claim, or does it gesture vaguely at a theme?
2. Could I replace any ornamental word here with a plainer, more precise one without losing meaning?
3. Is this paragraph's central claim clear on a single read?
4. If I were tempted to add a diagram here, does it clarify an actual process/comparison, or would prose alone communicate it just as well?
5. Have I varied sentence length and structure, or does every sentence follow the same pattern?

6. Dimension-expansion grid

Style issue	Example of the problem	Precise alternative
Ornamental abstraction	"The multifarious tapestry of human endeavour interweaves..."	"Human effort across different fields interacts in specific, describable ways..."
Vague hedging	"It could perhaps be argued in some sense that..."	State the claim directly, then qualify it precisely if needed.
Alliteration for effect	"Power, prestige and pride propel political practice."	Name the actual mechanism instead of the sound pattern.

6A. Exact-expression repair and visual gates

Before: "The multifarious tapestry of digital society has a deleterious impact on youth in the contemporary milieu."

After: "Platforms that reward comparison can make some young users measure self-worth against curated lives, increasing anxiety and loneliness." *The repair names actor, mechanism and consequence; it does not merely sound formal.*

Paragraph checklist - tick every item before retaining a paragraph:

1. Its first sentence makes one answer-relevant claim.
2. A precise actor, institution or process replaces an abstract noun pile.
3. "Because/how" is answered by a mechanism, not an assertion.
4. Any example is named, proportionate and followed by its significance.
5. A qualification prevents overclaiming.
6. Its last sentence links to the next claim.
7. No unexplained acronym, slogan, quotation or decorative adjective remains.

CANDIDATE VISUAL

|

v

Gate 1: Does it show a real multi-step process or genuine comparison?

no -> do not use; write prose

yes

v

Gate 2: Would one or two sentences explain it equally clearly?

yes -> do not use; prose is sufficient

no -> use a minimal, labelled visual, then interpret it in prose

Passing both gates is necessary, not sufficient: the visual must be small, readable and integrated into an argued paragraph. It never substitutes for one.

7. India-first illustration starters

ANALYSIS: Not directly applicable - see 12 for illustration content; this topic concerns only how illustrations are phrased once chosen.

8. Thesis options and selection

ANALYSIS: Re-read your thesis sentence (05) and check it uses precise, specific words, not vague abstractions - a vague thesis sentence is often the first sign of an underlying vague argument.

9. Simple essay architecture

ANALYSIS: If, and only if, a process or comparison is genuinely hard to state clearly in prose (e.g. a short causal chain), a minimal text-based diagram (arrows showing sequence) may be used sparingly - never as a substitute for the paragraph's own argued sentences.

10. Opening, body and closure moves

ANALYSIS: Keep the opening and closing paragraphs especially precise and free of ornamental language - these are the paragraphs an examiner reads most attentively, and vague or decorative language here is most costly.

11. WRONG: Traps and repair moves

- **WRONG: Decorative diagrams** in a philosophical/aphorism essay purely for visual effect. -> Repair: remove unless it clarifies an actual process or comparison the prose alone would state less clearly.
- **WRONG: Ornamental vocabulary** obscuring the actual claim. -> Repair: rewrite the sentence in plainer words and check the claim is still there.
- **WRONG: Uniform sentence rhythm** (every sentence the same length/structure) reading as monotonous. -> Repair: vary sentence length deliberately across a paragraph.
- **WRONG: Jargon imported from GS preparation** (scheme acronyms, technical shorthand) used without explanation. -> Repair: state the underlying idea in plain language; the essay is not a GS answer (03).

12. Timed micro-drill and self-check

10-minute unseen rewrite lab: Choose an unused V1 prompt from 2018-2023 in `../PYQ-Corpus-2013-2025.md`. Draft a 120-150-word body paragraph under the clock, then spend two minutes applying every Section 6A check and rewriting one sentence in the Before->After manner.

Self-check: Read the opening and closing sentences aloud. Can you name their claim, mechanism and qualification without paraphrasing vaguely? If not, revise before attempting visual polish.

Complete advanced knowledge

Subject: Essay | **Tier:** Advanced | **GS Paper:** Essay (General Studies Paper - Essay, Mains). **Core area:** Diagnosing register mismatches (GS-answer jargon vs. essay prose), and a strict test for when a visual earns its place in a continuous-prose essay. **Grounded in:** audited 2024-2025 UPSC Essay paper corpus (see `../README.md`); `../00_Master-Framework.md` Section 10. **Research cutoff:** 18 July 2026. **Tags:** FACT: verified fact | **ANALYSIS:** strategy/inference | **CURRENT:** dated anchor | **WRONG:** trap/boundary. **Companion:** `../basic/14_Language-Style-and-Functional-Visuals.md`

1. Advanced proposition and boundary

Proposition: **ANALYSIS:** style quality in this genre is measured by how quickly and accurately a reader can extract the claim from a sentence - not by vocabulary sophistication, sentence length, or rhetorical flourish. **Boundary:** **WRONG:** this topic does not decide *what* to argue (05, 08) - it governs *how* the argument is phrased, including the narrow, disciplined case for a visual.

2. Concept definition and taxonomy

- **Register mismatch:** importing GS-answer conventions (headings, scheme acronyms, bullet lists) into continuous essay prose, producing an administrative rather than argued tone.
- **Earned visual:** a diagram/table used because the underlying process or comparison is genuinely clearer in that form than in prose - passes the two-gate test now introduced in basic/14 Section 6A.
- **Decorative visual:** a diagram used to signal effort or visual appeal without adding clarity beyond what a sentence would achieve.

3. Tension pairs and hidden assumptions

- **Sophistication vs. clarity:** the hidden assumption that complex vocabulary signals intellectual depth; in the essay genre, clarity of argument is what is actually being tested, and unnecessarily complex phrasing can obscure a thin argument rather than reveal a rich one.
- **Visual appeal vs. genuine clarification:** the assumption that any diagram "adds value"; in fact a diagram that merely restates a one-sentence idea in boxes and arrows adds visual clutter without informational gain.

4. Levels of analysis and temporal-spatial scale

ANALYSIS: Apply register discipline at three levels: the word level (plain vs. ornamental vocabulary), the sentence level (direct claims vs. hedged vagueness), and the paragraph level (argued prose vs. list-like enumeration) - a register mismatch can occur at any of these levels even when the others are handled well.

5. Stakeholder map and distributional effects

ANALYSIS: Not directly applicable in the usual sense; the relevant "stakeholder" consideration is the reader (examiner), whose ability to follow the argument quickly and confidently is the real audience-effect of style choices - ornamental or list-like style burdens this reader without benefit.

6. Causality, mechanisms and feedback loops - the visual-earning test

```
CANDIDATE VISUAL
|
v
DOES IT DEPICT AN ACTUAL PROCESS OR COMPARISON
(a causal sequence, a before/after, a genuine multi-item comparison)?
|
no -----> DO NOT USE; state in prose
|
yes
v
WOULD A ONE-OR-TWO SENTENCE PROSE STATEMENT communicate the
same process/comparison EQUALLY CLEARLY?
|
yes -----> DO NOT USE; prose is sufficient
|
no (the visual genuinely adds clarity a sentence could not)
v
USE THE VISUAL, MINIMAL AND LABELLED, INTEGRATED WITH SURROUNDING PROSE
```

ANALYSIS: This is a genuine test, not a rule of thumb to be waved through - most candidate-drafted diagrams fail at the second gate (a sentence would have communicated the same thing) and should be removed.

7. Necessary/sufficient conditions and exceptions

ANALYSIS: Passing the Section 6 test is necessary before using any visual in an essay answer; it is not, by itself, sufficient to guarantee the visual helps - it must also be minimal (not overloaded with boxes) and clearly labelled.

Exception: given the essay's continuous-prose genre and the audited papers' silence on visuals (Section 3 of the basic file), the safest default is to use **no visual at all** unless a process is genuinely multi-step and would be materially harder to follow in prose.

8. Paradox, dialectic and counterfactual test

Paradox: the essays that most successfully use a visual are usually the ones that could have "gotten away" without one, but chose to for genuine added clarity - essays that *need* a visual to compensate for an otherwise confused prose argument are using the visual to paper over a structural problem, not solve it. **Counterfactual test:** "If I deleted this visual and described the same process in two sentences, would a reader understand it just as well?" If yes, delete the visual.

9. Ethical conflict and synthesis

ANALYSIS: Not a substantive ethical topic; the closest relevant point is intellectual honesty in self-presentation - ornamental language or decorative visuals used to disguise a thin argument misrepresent the essay's actual analytical content to the reader.

10. Evidence/source-risk and India application

ANALYSIS: Not directly applicable - evidentiary discipline is owned by 09; this topic only governs how any already-verified illustration is phrased and whether it is accompanied by a genuinely earned visual.

11. Advanced structure, paragraph sequencing and style

ANALYSIS: Where a visual does pass Section 6's test (e.g. a short causal chain for 2024-B5's feedback loop, per 03's advanced file), integrate it within, not instead of, the surrounding argued prose - precede it with a sentence stating what it shows, and follow it with a sentence interpreting its significance for the thesis.

12. WRONG: Failure modes and revision protocol

- **WRONG: Ornamental vocabulary throughout a draft.** -> Protocol: run the claim -> actor/process -> mechanism -> qualification -> link checklist (basic/14 Section 6A) sentence by sentence before finalising.
- **WRONG: Decorative visual that fails the Section 6 test.** -> Protocol: delete it and state the content in prose.
- **WRONG: GS-register bleed** (headings, bullet points, acronyms) inside the essay. -> Protocol: convert every instance into connected prose (cross-link 03, 07).

13. CURRENT: Dated anchor / practice lab / transfer task

CURRENT: Dated anchor: not applicable - style and visual-discipline method is stable and does not depend on current-affairs content.

Practice lab: Take an unused 2018-2023 V1 prompt, draft a 120-150-word paragraph in ten minutes, and run every sentence through the basic/14 Section 6A precision check. Record the before/after repair, not merely a general impression that the prose improved.

Transfer task: For 2024-B5 (FOMO) or another process-heavy prompt, attempt one candidate visual and run it through Section 6's earning test; record whether it passed or was deleted, and log the reasoning in 16's error log.

TOPIC 15 - Self-Evaluation and Internal Practice Rubric

Complete foundational knowledge

Subject: Essay | **Tier:** Must-Do | **GS Paper:** Essay (General Studies Paper - Essay, Mains). **Core area:** A clearly non-official internal diagnostic scorecard for self-evaluating a drafted or timed-practice essay. **Grounded in:** audited 2024-2025 UPSC Essay paper corpus (see `../README.md`, which confirms neither paper prints a marking rubric); `../00_Master-Framework.md` Section 10. **Research cutoff:** 18 July 2026. **Tags:** FACT: verified fact | ANALYSIS: strategy/inference | CURRENT: dated anchor | WRONG: trap/boundary. **Companion:** `../advanced/15_Self-Evaluation-and-Internal-Practice-Rubric.md`

This entire topic is an Internal Essay Practice Rubric - not UPSC's official rubric. Neither audited paper publishes a marking scheme, examiner weightage, or scoring formula of any kind (see `../README.md`). The scorecard below is a self-diagnosis tool this folder built for practice purposes; it must never be represented, quoted, or relied upon as UPSC's actual grading method.

1. Purpose and scope

This topic gives a structured way to review your own drafted or timed-practice essay against the skills taught in 01-14. It does not teach any of those skills itself - it only diagnoses where a specific attempt was weak, so you know which topic file to revisit.

2. Core terms in plain language

- **Internal Essay Practice Rubric:** this folder's own diagnostic tool, explicitly not an official UPSC document.
- **Self-diagnosis:** identifying, honestly, which specific skill (from 01-14) an attempt under-performed on.
- **Score, in this context:** a private, relative signal for your own revision priorities - not a prediction of an actual UPSC mark.

3. FACT: Exam facts / source basis

- **FACT:** Neither the 2024 nor the 2025 paper prints any marking rubric, weightage table, or scoring guidance. **FACT:** The only marks information printed anywhere in either locally held copy is 2024's "(125 × 2 = 250)" - a marks split between the two essays, **not** a rubric, and with no 2025 counterpart in the local copy (see `../README.md`).
- **WRONG:** Do not present any score derived from this topic's tool as an official UPSC mark, an examiner's likely score, or a "topper formula" - none of these exist in the audited corpus, and inventing one would misrepresent the source material.
- **WRONG:** Equally, do not treat "(125 × 2 = 250)" as implying anything about how those 125 marks are distributed within an essay. The paper is silent on that, and any internal weighting - including this file's seven dimensions - is a coaching/self-evaluation construct.

4. The central idea and common misreading

ANALYSIS: **Central idea:** self-evaluation is most useful when it identifies one or two specific, fixable weaknesses per attempt, tied to a specific topic file to revisit. **WRONG: Common misreading:** treating a total score from this internal tool as equivalent to an actual UPSC mark, or assuming a specific number of headings/examples/paragraphs is officially required - no such official figure exists.

5. Basic decomposition questions

1. Did my essay answer the exact prompt, or did it drift toward a related but different topic (03, 04)?
2. Did my thesis go beyond restating the prompt, and was it qualified (05)?
3. Did my structure flow with real transitions, or did it read as a list of disconnected points (07)?
4. Did I use verified, functional illustrations without inventing statistics or authors (09, 12)?
5. Did I test a genuine counter-view and reach a real synthesis, not an unresolved "on the other hand" (08)?

6. Dimension-expansion grid - the Internal Essay Practice Rubric (0-4 each, /28 total; not UPSC's official rubric)

Score only after writing the paragraph numbers that justify the score. The anchors make the number repeatable; they do **not** predict UPSC marks.

Dimension	0	1	2	3	4
Relevance	Does not answer prompt	Mostly generic/203;drifts	Answers part of prompt	Answers all terms with one weak drift	Every paragraph advances the exact proposition
Depth	Assertion only	One undeveloped reason	Some mechanism, little qualification	Mechanism and qualification in most clusters	Sustained causal/203;conceptual reasoning, including limits
Coherence	No thesis/203;sequence	List-like	Thesis exists but links fail	Clear sequence with minor discontinuity	Thesis, transitions and transformed conclusion form one argument
Evidence	Fabricated/203;irrelevant	Dumped or unsupported	One usable but weakly linked example	Accurate, functional examples with one weak limitation	Each example has claim, source status, function and limitation
Originality	Copied/203;t emplate prose	Stock framing dominates	Some independent choice	Distinct thesis or synthesis	Independent, defensible framing throughout without novelty-for-its-own-sake
Balance	No counter-view	Token "however"	Counter-view stated but not answered	Fair counter-view and plausible answer	Strongest counter-view genuinely tests and improves the thesis
Language	Often unclear	Ornament/203;j argon blocks meaning	Generally readable, repetitive	Precise with occasional imprecision	Exact, concise, varied prose; every sentence carries a claim or link

Restated for clarity: this /28 table is the Internal Essay Practice Rubric - not UPSC's official rubric, and it invents no official examiner weighting.

7. India-first illustration starters

ANALYSIS: Not directly applicable - see 12 for illustration content; this topic only diagnoses whether illustrations already used met that topic's discipline (dimension 4 above).

8. Thesis options and selection

ANALYSIS: If dimension 1 (Relevance) or 2 (Depth) scores low, the underlying issue is usually with 05 (thesis construction), not with later drafting - revisit thesis choice before revising prose.

9. Simple essay architecture

ANALYSIS: If dimension 3 (Coherence) scores low, revisit 07's paragraph-plan method before rewriting individual sentences.

10. Opening, body and closure moves

ANALYSIS: Score the introduction and conclusion specifically against dimension 3 (Coherence) - does the conclusion return to a transformed thesis, or merely restate the introduction (06)?

11. Evidence, quotation and time audit

Before adding the /28, record:

Audit	Required record
Paragraph evidence	Paragraph number(s) supporting each of the seven scores
Factual risk	Every number, date, policy-status claim and outcome claim; source status or "remove"
Quotation risk	Exact wording, author and primary source; otherwise paraphrase or delete
Timing	Selection, plan, draft and revision minutes; whether 25/95/180 checkpoints were met
Choice quality	Why this prompt was safer than the rejected option, stated before drafting

An invented fact, unsupported quotation or missed Essay 2 cap is never cancelled out by fluent language; log it as a separate repair priority.

11A. Three-attempt tracker and calibration

Attempt/8203;date	Prompt/8203;V1 status	/8203;203;28	Lowest two dimensions + paragraph evidence	Fact/8203;quotation/8203;time flags	One repair	Reattempt/8203;transfer date
1						
2						
3						

Do not label a weakness "consistent" before three timed attempts, unless there is an objective failure such as an invented statistic or no counter-view. On attempt three, ask a peer/mentor to score one dimension from the anchored table without seeing your own score; discuss only the paragraph evidence, not a predicted UPSC mark.

12. WRONG: Traps and repair moves

- **WRONG: Treating this scorecard as UPSC's own marking key.** -> Repair: always describe it, out loud or in writing, as the "Internal Essay Practice Rubric - not UPSC's official rubric."
- **WRONG: Inventing an ideal paragraph or example count** as if officially required. -> Repair: no such official figure exists in the audited corpus; use 07's pedagogical guidance (10-12 paragraphs) as a starting heuristic only.
- **WRONG: Scoring generously to feel reassured.** -> Repair: score each dimension against a specific question (Section 5), not a general impression.
- **WRONG: Ignoring low scores instead of routing them to a specific topic file.** -> Repair: for every dimension scoring 2 or below, name the topic file (01-14) you will revisit.

13. Timed micro-drill and self-check

Drill: After a complete two-essay timed attempt, score each essay separately against Section 6. For every dimension write the supporting paragraph number, then complete the evidence/quotation/time audit in Section 11.

Self-check: For the two lowest dimensions, name the exact topic file, one observable repair, and a transfer date in the Section 11A tracker. Never average the two essays into a reassuring total that conceals a weak second essay.

Complete advanced knowledge

Subject: Essay | **Tier:** Advanced | **GS Paper:** Essay (General Studies Paper - Essay, Mains). **Core area:** Extending self-diagnosis with drift/risk/time metrics alongside the seven-dimension scorecard, and building a longitudinal self-evaluation practice across multiple attempts. **Grounded in:** audited 2024-2025 UPSC Essay paper corpus (see `../README.md`, which confirms neither paper prints a marking rubric); `../00_Master-Framework.md` Section 10. **Research cutoff:** 18 July 2026. **Tags:** FACT: verified fact | ANALYSIS: strategy/inference | CURRENT: dated anchor | WRONG: trap/boundary. **Companion:** `../basic/15_Self-Evaluation-and-Internal-Practice-Rubric.md`

This entire topic, and every scorecard in it, is part of the Internal Essay Practice Rubric - not UPSC's official rubric. Neither audited paper publishes a marking scheme, examiner weightage, or "topper formula" of any kind. Nothing in this file should be cited, quoted, or represented as UPSC's actual grading method.

1. Advanced proposition and boundary

Proposition: ANALYSIS: self-evaluation becomes genuinely useful only when tracked longitudinally - a single essay's score tells you little; the *pattern* across several attempts tells you which skill genuinely needs work. **Boundary:** WRONG: this topic does not create the seven-dimension table itself (`basic/15` does) - it extends it with supplementary metrics and a tracking method, still entirely as the **Internal Essay Practice Rubric, not UPSC's official rubric.**

2. Concept definition and taxonomy

- **Core scorecard (0-4 × 7 = /28):** relevance, depth, coherence, evidence, originality, balance, language - using `basic/15`'s paragraph-evidenced 0-4 anchors, never as an official mark.
- **Supplementary flags (not scored, tracked separately):** word-range estimate, choice quality, topic-drift instances, factual-risk count, quotation-risk count, time used per phase.
- **Longitudinal log:** a record across multiple attempts used to spot a repeated weak dimension, distinct from any single attempt's score.

3. Tension pairs and hidden assumptions

- **Single-attempt score vs. trend:** the hidden assumption that one

low score on one dimension is diagnostic; in fact a single low score could be attempt-specific (a hard prompt, a rushed day), while a *repeated* low score across attempts is the genuine signal.

- **Precision vs. false authority:** the assumption that a numeric /28

score carries the same weight as an official mark; it does not - it is explicitly **the Internal Essay Practice Rubric, not UPSC's official rubric**, useful only for relative, private tracking.

4. Levels of analysis and temporal-spatial scale

ANALYSIS: Evaluate at three levels: the paragraph level (does this specific paragraph do its job - claim, development, link, per 07), the essay level (the seven-dimension scorecard, basic/15), and the multi-attempt level (the longitudinal log, Section 6 below) - a weakness invisible at one level often shows clearly at another.

5. Stakeholder map and distributional effects

ANALYSIS: Not directly applicable in the usual sense - the sole "stakeholder" is the candidate's own future performance; the relevant distributional question is whether self-evaluation time is spent proportionately across both required essay types (Section A and B prompts) rather than only on a favoured style of prompt.

6. Causality, mechanisms and feedback loops - longitudinal tracking

```
ATTEMPT 1 -> score against 7-dimension scorecard (basic/15) + supplementary flags
|
ATTEMPT 2 -> same scoring
|
ATTEMPT 3 -> same scoring
|
v
COMPARE across attempts: which dimension is CONSISTENTLY low?
|
v
ROUTE that dimension to its specific topic file (01-14) for targeted revision
|
v
RE-ATTEMPT and re-score to confirm improvement
```

ANALYSIS: This loop, not any single score, is the actual value of self-evaluation - reiterate this whenever the /28 figure is used, so it is never mistaken for an official prediction. All figures produced by this loop remain part of the **Internal Essay Practice Rubric - not UPSC's official rubric**.

7. Necessary/sufficient conditions and exceptions

ANALYSIS: basic/15's three-attempt tracker is the minimum before a "consistently low" dimension can be identified with confidence; a single attempt is not sufficient evidence of a stable weakness. **Exception:** a glaring, self-evident failure (e.g. a completely one-sided essay with no counter-view at all, 08) can be flagged and addressed immediately, without waiting for a longitudinal pattern.

8. Paradox, dialectic and counterfactual test

Paradox: candidates who score themselves most harshly on "Originality" and "Depth" (the two hardest-to-fake dimensions) often improve fastest, because these dimensions cannot be patched by surface polishing alone - they force a return to 04/05. **Counterfactual test:** "If an independent, fair-minded reader scored this same essay, would they likely agree with my self-score, or am I being unusually generous/harsh on a specific dimension?" Where you suspect bias, ask a peer or mentor to cross-check.

9. Ethical conflict and synthesis

ANALYSIS: The main integrity concern here is self-honesty: scoring generously to feel reassured defeats the tool's purpose. **Synthesis:** treat every low score as useful information routed to a specific topic file, not as a verdict to be avoided or inflated - and continue describing the whole exercise, in any notes or conversation, as the **Internal Essay Practice Rubric** - not UPSC's official rubric.

10. Evidence/source-risk and India application

ANALYSIS: The factual-risk, quotation-risk and phase-timing flags in basic/15 Section 11 should be cross-checked directly against 09, 12 and 13. Any invented statistic, unverified attribution or missed Essay 2 cap is logged as a risk instance, not silently corrected without noting the pattern.

11. Advanced structure, paragraph sequencing and style

ANALYSIS: When self-evaluating structure specifically, re-run 07's "delete-the-paragraph" test on your own completed draft - if a paragraph could be removed without creating a logical gap, mark "Coherence" down and note the specific paragraph in your longitudinal log.

12. WRONG: Failure modes and revision protocol

- WRONG: ****Presenting this rubric's score as an official UPSC mark or examiner prediction.** -> **Protocol: always restate the disclaimer - the Internal Essay Practice Rubric, not UPSC's official rubric**** - when discussing any score from this tool.
- WRONG: **Single-attempt overreaction** (treating one low score as a fixed trait). -> **Protocol: wait for a three-attempt pattern before concluding a dimension is a stable weakness (Section 7).**
- WRONG: **Self-scoring bias** (consistently generous or harsh). -> **Protocol: periodically cross-check with a peer/mentor (Section 8).**

13. CURRENT: Dated anchor / practice lab / transfer task

CURRENT: **Dated anchor:** not applicable - self-evaluation method is stable and does not depend on current-affairs content.

Practice lab: Score both essays from your most recent complete mock with basic/15's anchored table, paragraph evidence and Section 11 audit. Label the output **Internal Essay Practice Rubric** - not UPSC's official rubric.

Transfer task: After two further timed attempts (16), compile a three-attempt longitudinal comparison (Section 6) and identify one dimension to prioritise in your next study cycle; log the pattern and your chosen next topic file in 16's error log.

TOPIC 16 - Practice Loops, PYQ Lab and Revision System

Complete foundational knowledge

Subject: Essay | **Tier:** Must-Do | **GS Paper:** Essay (General Studies Paper - Essay, Mains). **Core area:** Routing and concise interpretive outlines for the 16 recent prompts, linked to the full 100-prompt corpus; a deliberate-practice loop with an error log and spaced reattempts. **Grounded in:** the 2013-2025 UPSC Essay corpus with per-year verification levels (see `../PYQ-Corpus-2013-2025.md`); `../00_Master-Framework.md` Section 11.

Research cutoff: 18 July 2026. **Tags:** FACT: verified fact | ANALYSIS: strategy/inference | CURRENT: dated anchor | WRONG: trap/boundary. **Companion:**

`../advanced/16_Practice-Loops-PYQ-Lab-and-Revision-System.md`

1. Purpose and scope

This topic is the practice engine for the whole folder: it routes the 16 recent prompts to the relevant earlier topics and gives concise interpretive outlines - never memorised model essays - while `../PYQ-Corpus-2013-2025.md` supplies all 100 prompts. It owns the complete two-essay mock, error-log, spacing and blind-transfer loop.

2. Core terms in plain language

- **Interpretive outline:** a short, bulleted sketch of thesis direction, key dimensions and synthesis - enough to plan from, not a finished essay.

- **Practice loop:** one full mock cycle of choose -> decode -> plan -> complete two essays -> self-evaluate -> log; a partial draft is a separately labelled micro-drill, never a mock.

- **Error log:** a running record of specific weaknesses found during self-evaluation (15), routed to a topic file for targeted revision.

- **Spaced reattempt:** re-doing the same or a related prompt after a deliberate gap, to check whether a logged weakness has actually improved.

3. FACT: Exam facts / source basis

FACT: All 16 recent prompts below are quoted from `../PYQ-Corpus-2013-2025.md`'s **V1** rows - read directly off the official 2024 and 2025 PDFs in `books/mains/` - and are reproduced with their printed defects intact ("futures" in 2024-A2; a comma before a capitalised "Happiness" in 2024-A3; no comma before "precipitating" in 2024-B5). FACT: Both V1 papers are unattributed for every prompt; this topic follows the same quotation-attribution safety rule as 09 - no author is ever attached to any of the 16 recent prompts.

FACT: The current ledger classifies **2018-2025 as V1 (64 prompts)**, read from local official papers; these prompts may be quoted verbatim, defects included. ANALYSIS: **2013-2017 are V2 (36 prompts)** and must be paraphrased until checked against their official paper. Do not use the obsolete 16-V1/84-V2 split.

4. The central idea and common misreading

ANALYSIS: **Central idea:** practice is only as useful as the feedback loop attached to it - plan/draft, evaluate honestly (15), log the specific weakness, and deliberately re-test it later. WRONG: **Common misreading:** practising by writing many essays without ever reviewing or logging what went wrong, which produces repetition of the same errors rather than improvement.

5. Basic decomposition questions

For any prompt below: (1) which topic files does it primarily route to? (2) what is the central tension? (3) what thesis direction and qualification would you choose? (4) what is one Indian illustration you can genuinely recall for it? (5) what is the synthesis?

5A. Complete mock loop, not a partial-draft substitute

SELECT one prompt from each Section
-> 10-minute joint selection/decode
-> Essay 1: 15 plan + 60 draft + 10 revision
-> Essay 2: 15 plan + 60 draft + 10 revision
-> score EACH essay (15), audit facts/quotes/time
-> log one repair and schedule a transfer attempt

Use the 25/95/180 checkpoints from 13. A completed mock means two complete essays in 180 minutes. A plan, opening-only drill or partial draft is useful practice but cannot replace a mock.

5B. Error-log schema

Date	Prompt + V1/V2 status	Choice rationale	Checkpoint minutes	Paragraph/evidence defect	Fact/quote source risk	15 score by essay	One repair	Reattempt date	Blind-transfer prompt
			25 / 95 / 180			E1: / 203;28; E2: / 203;28			

Record a fact or quotation risk even when corrected before submission; the pattern matters more than a cleaned final draft.

5C. Spacing and blind-transfer calendar

Day	Task	Required evidence
0	Complete mock and log one weakness	Both drafts, timing and two audits
2	Targeted micro-drill on the weakness	One repaired paragraph or plan
7	Blind transfer	Unused 2018-2023 V1 prompt testing the same skill
21	Full reattempt	Different Section pairing; compare to Day 0

Do not read a supplied outline before the Day-7 prompt. Select an unused 2018-2023 V1 prompt directly from the ledger, preserve its printed wording, and judge whether the *skill* transferred rather than whether a memorised outline returned.

6. Dimension-expansion grid - recent 16-prompt routing table with concise interpretive outlines

2024 - Section A

Label	Exact prompt	Route	Concise interpretive outline
2024-A1	"Forests precede civilizations and deserts follow them."	02, 04, 05, 11, 12	Ecological precondition/warning; forests as ecological capital, deserts as the cost of extractive overreach; dimensions: ecological, civilisational, developmental; synthesis: regenerative development and intergenerational responsibility.
2024-A2	"The empires of the futures will be the empires of the mind."	02, 05, 09, 11, 12	"Empire" redefined as knowledge/power; dimensions: education, research capacity, digital-platform power; synthesis: inclusive, accountable knowledge-power, not concentrated power. WRONG: "futures" is the paper's printed slip - do not build the essay on the plural.
2024-A3	"There is no path to happiness, Happiness is the path."	02, 05, 06, 10, 12	Process vs. destination; dimensions: individual conduct, consumption, public policy/well-being; synthesis: flourishing as an ongoing process and a social condition. (Printed with a comma, not a semicolon.)
2024-A4	"The doubter is a true man of science."	02, 08, 09, 11	Disciplined doubt vs. denialism; dimensions: scientific method, public policy, civic scrutiny; synthesis: scientific temper as method, not mere scepticism.

2024 - Section B

Label	Exact prompt	Route	Concise interpretive outline
2024-B5	"Social media is triggering 'Fear of Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness."	03, 04, 08, 09, 10, 11, 12	Issue-based prompt (see 03); mechanism: design/​comparison-driven distress; dimensions: individual, family, platform, state; synthesis: agency, literacy, humane platform design. (No comma before "precipitating" in the printed paper.)
2024-B6	"Nearly all men can stand adversity, but to test the character, give him power."	02, 05, 08, 10, 12	Discretionary power vs. adversity as character tests; dimensions: personal virtue, institutional accountability; synthesis: accountable power, not power denied or unchecked.
2024-B7	"All ideas having large consequences are always simple."	02, 05, 08, 09, 11	Simplicity of moral/​political core vs. complexity of execution; synthesis: simple compass, sophisticated implementation.
2024-B8	"The cost of being wrong is less than the cost of doing nothing."	02, 05, 08, 09, 11	Reversible experimentation vs. paralysis; synthesis: responsible, safeguarded action with precaution for irreversible harms.

2025 - Section A

Label	Exact prompt	Route	Concise interpretive outline
2025-A1	"Truth knows no color."	02, 05, 08, 09, 10, 11	Objectivity vs. identity/​perspective-shaped perception; synthesis: plural voice with common evidentiary standards.
2025-A2	"The supreme art of war is to subdue the enemy without fighting."	02, 08, 10, 11, 12	Beyond military literalism: deterrence, diplomacy, conflict prevention; synthesis: just peace built on preparedness and dialogue together.
2025-A3	"Thought finds a world and creates one also."	02, 04, 05, 08, 10, 11	Thought as discovery and as world-remaking imagination; synthesis: ethical, evidence-aware imagination.
2025-A4	"Best lessons are learnt through bitter experiences."	02, 05, 08, 10, 12	Adversity as potential, not automatic, teacher; synthesis: reflection and institutional reform, not suffering alone, produce learning.

2025 - Section B

Label	Exact prompt	Route	Concise interpretive outline
2025-B5	"Muddy water is best cleared by leaving it alone."	02, 05, 08, 10, 13	Restraint vs. intervention; synthesis: diagnostic wisdom on when patience helps and when timely action is a duty.
2025-B6	"The years teach much which the days never know."	02, 04, 05, 10, 12	Accumulated/​reflected experience vs. daily events; synthesis: experience must be reflected on, not merely lived through.
2025-B7	"It is best to see life as a journey, not as a destination."	02, 05, 06, 10, 11	Process/​means alongside achievement; synthesis: purpose-led progress, not destination-obsession or process without direction.
2025-B8	"Contentment is natural wealth; luxury is artificial poverty."	02, 05, 08, 10, 11, 12	Contentment vs. resignation; luxury vs. legitimate comfort; synthesis: sufficiency, equity and sustainable prosperity.

7. India-first illustration starters

ANALYSIS: For each prompt above, recall (do not invent) one Indian illustration before attempting a full plan - cross-check against 12's bank and discipline.

8. Thesis options and selection

ANALYSIS: Use the interpretive outline above only as a starting direction - you may reasonably choose a different thesis for any prompt, provided it passes 05's tests (arguable, qualified, illustrable).

9. Simple essay architecture

ANALYSIS: Convert any chosen outline into a full paragraph plan using 07 before drafting - the outline above is not itself a paragraph plan.

10. Opening, body and closure moves

ANALYSIS: Practise writing only the opening and closing sentences for several prompts in one sitting (see 06), before attempting a full timed draft of any one of them.

11. WRONG: Traps and repair moves

- WRONG: ****Treating the interpretive outlines above as model answers to memorise and reproduce.**** -> Repair: use them only as a starting direction; build your own thesis, mechanism and illustrations.

- WRONG: **Practising without logging errors.** -> Repair: always complete 15's self-evaluation and record at least one specific weakness per attempt.

- WRONG: **Re-attempting the same prompt immediately** rather than spacing reattempts. -> Repair: use the Day 2/7/21 calendar and test the repair first on an unseen 2018-2023 V1 prompt.

- WRONG: **Attaching an author to any of the 16 recent prompts.** -> Repair: none is printed in either source paper; keep every reference unattributed (09).

12. Timed micro-drill and self-check

Drill: Pick an unused 2018-2023 V1 prompt. Within 15 minutes, write: thesis, 2-3 dimensions with one illustration each, the strongest counter-view and the synthesis. Do this blind; then enter the result in the error log as a transfer task, not as a complete mock.

Self-check: Compare your plan to the table's interpretive outline. Did you arrive at a genuinely different, equally defensible thesis, or did you simply restate the outline without adding your own reasoning? Log the result against the Day-7 transfer row in Section 5C.

Complete advanced knowledge

Subject: Essay | **Tier:** Advanced | **GS Paper:** Essay (General Studies Paper - Essay, Mains). **Core area:** A quotation/source-risk rule for the 100-prompt corpus, with deeper analytical outlines for the 16 recent prompts building on the basic routing table, and a spaced-repetition error-log system. **Grounded in:** the 2013-2025 UPSC Essay corpus with per-year verification levels (see `../PYQ-Corpus-2013-2025.md`); `../00_Master-Framework.md` Sections 11, 13. **Research cutoff:** 18 July 2026. **Tags:** FACT: verified fact | ANALYSIS: strategy/inference | CURRENT: dated anchor | WRONG: trap/boundary. **Companion:** `../basic/16_Practice-Loops-PYQ-Lab-and-Revision-System.md`

1. Advanced proposition and boundary

Proposition: ANALYSIS: a practice system is only as strong as its feedback and spacing discipline - random, unlogged repetition of the same recent 16 prompts produces familiarity without necessarily producing skill transfer to a genuinely new prompt. **Boundary:** WRONG: this topic does not reintroduce the full routing table (basic/16 owns it) - it deepens selected outlines, owns the full quotation ledger jointly with 09, and supplies the spaced-repetition method.

2. Concept definition and taxonomy

- **Deep outline:** an interpretive plan that includes thesis, qualification, 2-3 dimensions with mechanism, one counter-view, and a synthesis - richer than basic/16's one-line outlines, still not a full essay.
- **Quotation ledger entry:** per-prompt record of attribution status and permissible use, mirroring 09's method, applied to the full corpus.
- **Spaced reattempt:** a deliberately delayed re-practice of a prompt or skill, timed to test retention rather than immediate recall.

3. Tension pairs and hidden assumptions

- **Coverage vs. depth:** the hidden assumption that practising all recent 16 prompts once each is sufficient; in fact, revisiting a smaller subset multiple times with genuine spacing typically produces more transfer than a single pass through all recent 16.
- **Familiarity vs. transfer:** the assumption that being able to recall an outline for a specific prompt means the underlying skill (e.g. dialectical synthesis, 08) transfers to an unfamiliar prompt; this should be explicitly tested (Section 6).

4. Levels of analysis and temporal-spatial scale

ANALYSIS: Track practice at three levels: per-prompt (can I outline this specific prompt well?), per-skill (across several prompts, is my counter-view construction consistently strong or consistently weak?), and per-cycle (is my overall practice-loop discipline - planning, logging, spacing - actually being followed?).

5. Stakeholder map and distributional effects

ANALYSIS: Not directly applicable in the usual sense; ensure practice time is distributed across both years and both Sections, not concentrated on whichever prompts feel most comfortable - an uneven practice distribution leaves blind spots exactly where a live exam prompt might resemble the neglected set.

6. Causality, mechanisms and feedback loops - corrected quotation/source-risk ledger

Prompt set	Verification level	Printed author?	Permissible use	Verification needed for attribution
2018-2025 (64 prompts)	V1 - read from local official PDFs	Do not infer an author from familiarity	Quote verbatim, printed defects included, or paraphrase faithfully	Any added attribution requires a primary/authoritative source
2013-2017 (36 prompts)	V2 - no local official paper	Only 2013-1 carries one ("Gandhiji"), itself unverified	Paraphrase for practice; check the official paper before quoting verbatim	Both wording and attribution need the official paper

BEFORE using any prompt-derived quotation in a live attempt:

|
v

IS IT A V1 ROW (2018-2025)?

yes -> quote verbatim as printed (defects included), unattributed

no -> IS IT A V2 ROW (2013-2017)?

yes -> paraphrase the idea, OR verify against the official
paper for that year before quoting verbatim

no (a different, remembered aphorism) -> apply 09's full ledger:
verify author/wording via primary source, or use
unattributed, or omit

WRONG: The commonest failure here is quiet upgrading: reproducing a V2 prompt inside quotation marks because it "sounds exactly right." Sounding right is not verification - see 09's quotation-vs-paraphrase rule.

7. Necessary/sufficient conditions and exceptions

ANALYSIS: Logging an error (15) is necessary for a practice loop to improve performance but not sufficient - the logged weakness must also be revisited via a spaced reattempt (Section 8) to confirm improvement, otherwise the log becomes a passive record rather than an active feedback loop. **Exception:** a glaring one-off error (e.g. an invented statistic caught immediately) can be corrected on the spot without waiting for a full spaced-reattempt cycle.

8. Paradox, dialectic and counterfactual test

Paradox: re-attempting the *same* prompt after a gap is less informative about genuine skill transfer than attempting a *different* prompt that exercises the same logged weakness - e.g. if your logged weakness is "weak counter-view construction" (08), a stronger test is applying 08's method to a new prompt than re-writing the same essay.

Counterfactual test: "If I applied my logged-weakness fix to a prompt I have never outlined before, would it hold up?" This is the real test of whether a skill has actually improved, versus whether a specific essay was merely patched.

9. Ethical conflict and synthesis

ANALYSIS: Not a substantive ethical topic in itself; the closest relevant point is intellectual honesty in tracking - logging only successes and omitting recurring failures defeats the purpose of the error log (cross-link 15's self-honesty discipline).

10. Evidence/source-risk and India application

ANALYSIS: The ledger in Section 6 applies to all 100 prompts, but not uniformly: **64 rows (2018-2025) are V1** and quotable verbatim; **36 rows (2013-2017) are V2** and should be paraphrased until checked. FACT: Every illustration used in practice attempts should also be checked against 12's claim -> example -> function -> limitation -> source-module chain, logged as part of the same practice record.

11. Advanced structure, paragraph sequencing and style - deep-outline worked examples

2024-A2 ("Empires of the mind") - deep outline: Thesis: knowledge and institutional capacity, not territorial control, are becoming the decisive form of power, though this power must be made inclusive to be legitimate. Dimensions: (a) individual/education - access to quality learning as the base unit of this power; (b) institutional - research and innovation capacity as its accumulation mechanism; (c) global/ digital - platform and data power as its newest, most concentrated form. Counter-view: physical/military and resource power still matter decisively in many conflicts and crises. Synthesis: inclusive, accountable knowledge-power complements rather than fully replaces material power.

2025-B5 ("Muddy water... leaving it alone") - deep outline: Thesis: restraint is often the wiser response to a self-correcting or inflammatory situation, but this is a bounded, not universal, wisdom. Dimensions: (a) interpersonal/psychological - anger and conflict often settle with time and space; (b) informational - misinformation/outrage cycles sometimes fade faster without amplification; (c) policy - complex systems sometimes self-correct without heavy-handed intervention. Counter-view: some emergencies (public health, safety, active injustice) worsen without timely action. Synthesis: diagnostic wisdom - restraint where disturbance would worsen an

already-settling situation; timely action where inaction itself causes escalating harm.

12. WRONG: Failure modes and revision protocol

- WRONG: **Practising the same few "comfortable" prompts repeatedly.** ->

Protocol: deliberately rotate across both years and all four Sections (Section 5).

- WRONG: **Logging errors without spaced reattempt.** -> Protocol: schedule a reattempt of the logged skill (not necessarily the same prompt) after a genuine gap (Section 8).

- WRONG: ****Attaching an author to a familiar V1 or V2 prompt, or to a remembered aphorism without verification.**** -> Protocol: apply Section 6's ledger before every use.

13. CURRENT: Dated anchor / practice lab / transfer task

CURRENT: Dated anchor: not applicable - the practice-system method is stable; any current illustration used during practice should carry its own source and date per 09/12.

Practice lab: Write a deep outline (Section 11 format) for one prompt not already deep-outlined above - e.g. 2025-A3 ("thought finds a world and creates one also") - within 15 minutes.

Transfer task: On Day 7 of basic/16's calendar, apply the most recently logged weakness (15) to an unused **2018-2023 V1** prompt without first reading an outline. Assess via Section 8's counterfactual test whether the underlying skill, not just the specific essay, improved; record the outcome in the Core error-log schema.

PART II - SOLVED UPSC ESSAY PYQS, 2013-2025

2013-1 - Be the change you want to see in others." - Gandhiji

Verification: V2 - carried-forward; re-check before verbatim use **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. "Be the change you want to see in others." - Gandhiji" presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to "Be the change you want to see in others." - Gandhiji", this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to "Be the change you want to see in others." - Gandhiji", this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Be the change you want to see in others.” - Gandhiji”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Be the change you want to see in others.” - Gandhiji”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Be the change you want to see in others.” - Gandhiji”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2013-2 - Is the colonial mentality hindering India's success?

Verification: V2 - carried-forward; re-check before verbatim use **Prompt type:** issue-based proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Is the colonial mentality hindering India's success?” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Is the colonial mentality hindering India's success?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Is the colonial mentality hindering India's success?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Is the colonial mentality hindering India's success?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Is the colonial mentality hindering India's success?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Is the colonial mentality hindering India's success?”, this dimension must

be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2013-3 - GDP (Gross Domestic Product) along with GDH (Gross Domestic Happiness) would be the right indices for judging the well-being of a country.

Verification: V2 - carried-forward; re-check before verbatim use **Prompt type:** hybrid proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Happiness includes meaning, relationships, dignity and purposeful activity rather than only pleasure or deferred achievement.
2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “GDP (Gross Domestic Product) along with GDH (Gross Domestic Happiness) would be the right indices for judging the well-being of a country.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Happiness includes meaning, relationships, dignity and purposeful activity rather than only pleasure or deferred achievement. Applied to “GDP (Gross Domestic Product) along with GDH (Gross Domestic Happiness) would be the right indices for judging the well-being of a country.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “GDP (Gross Domestic Product) along with GDH (Gross Domestic Happiness) would be the right indices for judging the well-being of a country.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “GDP (Gross Domestic Product) along with GDH (Gross Domestic Happiness) would be the right indices for judging the well-being of a country.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “GDP (Gross Domestic Product) along with GDH (Gross Domestic Happiness) would be the right indices for judging the well-being of a country.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “GDP (Gross Domestic Product) along with GDH (Gross Domestic Happiness) would be the right indices

for judging the well-being of a country.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “GDP (Gross Domestic Product) along with GDH (Gross Domestic Happiness) would be the right indices for judging the well-being of a country.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2013-4 - Science and Technology is the panacea for the growth and security of the nation.

Verification: V2 - carried-forward; re-check before verbatim use **Prompt type:** hybrid proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Technology redistributes power, opportunity and risk; its effects depend on access, design, regulation and human agency.
2. Science advances through curiosity, doubt, evidence, reproducibility and institutions that permit correction.
3. Security is sustainable when prevention, capability, legitimacy, rights and public trust reinforce one another.
4. Growth becomes development when it creates productive work, public capability, resilience and fairly shared opportunity.
5. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
6. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.

Model response:

Introduction. “Science and Technology is the panacea for the growth and security of the nation.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Technology redistributes power, opportunity and risk; its effects depend on access, design, regulation and human agency. Applied to “Science and Technology is the panacea for the growth and security of the nation.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. Science advances through curiosity, doubt, evidence, reproducibility and institutions that permit correction. Applied to “Science and Technology is the panacea for the growth and security of the nation.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. Security is sustainable when prevention, capability, legitimacy, rights and public trust reinforce one another. Applied to “Science and Technology is the panacea for the growth and security of the nation.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. Growth becomes development when it creates productive work, public capability, resilience and fairly shared opportunity. Applied to “Science and Technology is the panacea for the growth and security of the nation.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Science and Technology is the panacea for the growth and security of the nation.”, this dimension must be

connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Science and Technology is the panacea for the growth and security of the nation.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2014-A1 - With greater power comes greater responsibility.

Verification: V2 - carried-forward; re-check before verbatim use **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Power tests character because it expands discretion and reveals whether authority is treated as trust, entitlement or licence.
2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “With greater power comes greater responsibility.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Power tests character because it expands discretion and reveals whether authority is treated as trust, entitlement or licence. Applied to “With greater power comes greater responsibility.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “With greater power comes greater responsibility.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “With greater power comes greater responsibility.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “With greater power comes greater responsibility.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “With greater power comes greater responsibility.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “With greater power comes greater responsibility.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2014-A2 - Is the growing level of competition good for the youth?

Verification: V2 - carried-forward; re-check before verbatim use **Prompt type:** issue-based proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Is the growing level of competition good for the youth?” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Is the growing level of competition good for the youth?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Is the growing level of competition good for the youth?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Is the growing level of competition good for the youth?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Is the growing level of competition good for the youth?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Is the growing level of competition good for the youth?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits

established in the essay.

2014-A3 - Are the standardized tests good measure of academic ability or progress?

Verification: V2 - carried-forward; re-check before verbatim use **Prompt type:** issue-based proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Are the standardized tests good measure of academic ability or progress?” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Are the standardized tests good measure of academic ability or progress?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Are the standardized tests good measure of academic ability or progress?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Are the standardized tests good measure of academic ability or progress?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Are the standardized tests good measure of academic ability or progress?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Are the standardized tests good measure of academic ability or progress?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2014-A4 - Words are sharper than the two-edged sword.

Verification: V2 - carried-forward; re-check before verbatim use **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Words are sharper than the two-edged sword.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Words are sharper than the two-edged sword.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Words are sharper than the two-edged sword.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Words are sharper than the two-edged sword.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Words are sharper than the two-edged sword.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Words are sharper than the two-edged sword.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2014-B5 - Was it the policy paralysis or the paralysis of implementation which slowed the growth of our country?

Verification: V2 - carried-forward; re-check before verbatim use **Prompt type:** issue-based proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Growth becomes development when it creates productive work, public capability, resilience and fairly shared opportunity.
2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Was it the policy paralysis or the paralysis of implementation which slowed the growth of our country?” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Growth becomes development when it creates productive work, public capability, resilience and fairly shared opportunity. Applied to “Was it the policy paralysis or the paralysis of implementation which slowed the growth of our country?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Was it the policy paralysis or the paralysis of implementation which slowed the growth of our country?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Was it the policy paralysis or the paralysis of implementation which slowed the growth of our country?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Was it the policy paralysis or the paralysis of implementation which slowed the growth of our country?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Was it the policy paralysis or the paralysis of implementation which slowed the growth of our country?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Was it the policy paralysis or the paralysis of implementation which slowed the growth of our country?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2014-B6 - Is sting operation an invasion on privacy?

Verification: V2 - carried-forward; re-check before verbatim use **Prompt type:** hybrid proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Privacy protects autonomy and dignity while requiring proportionate accommodation with legitimate public purposes.
2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Is sting operation an invasion on privacy?” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Privacy protects autonomy and dignity while requiring proportionate accommodation with legitimate public purposes. Applied to “Is sting operation an invasion on privacy?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Is sting operation an invasion on privacy?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Is sting operation an invasion on privacy?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Is sting operation an invasion on privacy?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Is sting operation an invasion on privacy?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Is sting operation an invasion on privacy?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2014-B7 - Fifty Golds in Olympics: Can this be a reality for India?

Verification: V2 - carried-forward; re-check before verbatim use **Prompt type:** issue-based proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Fifty Golds in Olympics: Can this be a reality for India?” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Fifty Golds in Olympics: Can this be a reality for India?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Fifty Golds in Olympics: Can this be a reality for India?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Fifty Golds in Olympics: Can this be a reality for India?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Fifty Golds in Olympics: Can this be a reality for India?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Fifty Golds in Olympics: Can this be a reality for India?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2014-B8 - Tourism: Can this be the next big thing for India?

Verification: V2 - carried-forward; re-check before verbatim use **Prompt type:** issue-based proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Tourism: Can this be the next big thing for India?” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Tourism: Can this be the next big thing for India?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Tourism: Can this be the next big thing for India?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Tourism: Can this be the next big thing for India?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Tourism: Can this be the next big thing for India?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Tourism: Can this be the next big thing for India?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2015-A1 - Lending hands to someone is better than giving a dole.

Verification: V2 - carried-forward; re-check before verbatim use **Prompt type:** hybrid proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Lending hands to someone is better than giving a dole.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Lending hands to someone is better than giving a dole.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Lending hands to someone is better than giving a dole.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Lending hands to someone is better than giving a dole.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Lending hands to someone is better than giving a dole.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Lending hands to someone is better than giving a dole.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2015-A2 - Quick but steady wins the race.

Verification: V2 - carried-forward; re-check before verbatim use **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Quick but steady wins the race.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Quick but steady wins the race.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Quick but steady wins the race.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Quick but steady wins the race.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Quick but steady wins the race.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Quick but steady wins the race.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2015-A3 - Character of an institution is reflected in its leader.

Verification: V2 - carried-forward; re-check before verbatim use **Prompt type:** hybrid proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Leadership becomes durable when it builds accountable institutions, distributes capability and protects principled disagreement.
2. Institutions convert values into repeatable rules; their credibility depends on competence, fairness, transparency and correction.
3. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
4. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
5. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
6. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.

Model response:

Introduction. “Character of an institution is reflected in its leader.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Leadership becomes durable when it builds accountable institutions, distributes capability and protects principled disagreement. Applied to “Character of an institution is reflected in its leader.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. Institutions convert values into repeatable rules; their credibility depends on competence, fairness, transparency and correction. Applied to “Character of an institution is reflected in its leader.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Character of an institution is reflected in its leader.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Character of an institution is reflected in its leader.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Character of an institution is reflected in its leader.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Character of an institution is reflected in its leader.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2015-A4 - Education without values, as useful as it is, seems rather to make a man more clever devil.

Verification: V2 - carried-forward; re-check before verbatim use **Prompt type:** hybrid proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Education shapes capability, citizenship, mobility and the habits through which a society reproduces or reforms itself.
2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Education without values, as useful as it is, seems rather to make a man more clever devil.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Education shapes capability, citizenship, mobility and the habits through which a society reproduces or reforms itself. Applied to “Education without values, as useful as it is, seems rather to make a man more clever devil.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Education without values, as useful as it is, seems rather to make a man more clever devil.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Education without values, as useful as it is, seems rather to make a man more clever devil.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Education without values, as useful as it is, seems rather to make a man more clever devil.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Education without values, as useful as it is, seems rather to make a man more clever devil.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Education without values, as useful as it is, seems rather to make a man more clever devil.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2015-B5 - Technology cannot replace manpower.

Verification: V2 - carried-forward; re-check before verbatim use **Prompt type:** hybrid proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Technology redistributes power, opportunity and risk; its effects depend on access, design, regulation and human agency.
2. Power tests character because it expands discretion and reveals whether authority is treated as trust, entitlement or licence.
3. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
4. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
5. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
6. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.

Model response:

Introduction. “Technology cannot replace manpower.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Technology redistributes power, opportunity and risk; its effects depend on access, design, regulation and human agency. Applied to “Technology cannot replace manpower.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. Power tests character because it expands discretion and reveals whether authority is treated as trust, entitlement or licence. Applied to “Technology cannot replace manpower.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Technology cannot replace manpower.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Technology cannot replace manpower.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Technology cannot replace manpower.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Technology cannot replace manpower.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2015-B6 - Crisis faced in India - moral or economic.

Verification: V2 - carried-forward; re-check before verbatim use **Prompt type:** hybrid proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Economic outcomes must be read through growth, employment, capability, distribution, resilience and ecological cost.
2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Crisis faced in India - moral or economic.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Economic outcomes must be read through growth, employment, capability, distribution, resilience and ecological cost. Applied to “Crisis faced in India - moral or economic.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Crisis faced in India - moral or economic.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Crisis faced in India - moral or economic.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Crisis faced in India - moral or economic.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Crisis faced in India - moral or economic.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Crisis faced in India - moral or economic.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2015-B7 - Dreams which should not let India sleep.

Verification: V2 - carried-forward; re-check before verbatim use **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Dreams which should not let India sleep.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Dreams which should not let India sleep.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Dreams which should not let India sleep.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Dreams which should not let India sleep.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Dreams which should not let India sleep.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Dreams which should not let India sleep.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2015-B8 - Can capitalism bring inclusive growth?

Verification: V2 - carried-forward; re-check before verbatim use **Prompt type:** issue-based proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Capitalism can generate innovation and wealth, but inclusion depends on competition, labour capability, social protection and public regulation.
2. Growth becomes development when it creates productive work, public capability, resilience and fairly shared opportunity.
3. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
4. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
5. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
6. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.

Model response:

Introduction. “Can capitalism bring inclusive growth?” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Capitalism can generate innovation and wealth, but inclusion depends on competition, labour capability, social protection and public regulation. Applied to “Can capitalism bring inclusive growth?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. Growth becomes development when it creates productive work, public capability, resilience and fairly shared opportunity. Applied to “Can capitalism bring inclusive growth?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Can capitalism bring inclusive growth?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Can capitalism bring inclusive growth?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Can capitalism bring inclusive growth?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Can capitalism bring inclusive growth?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2016-A1 - If development is not engendered, it is endangered.

Verification: V2 - carried-forward; re-check before verbatim use **Prompt type:** hybrid proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Gender norms distribute freedom, care, labour, safety and authority unequally across households, institutions and public life.
2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “If development is not engendered, it is endangered.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Gender norms distribute freedom, care, labour, safety and authority unequally across households, institutions and public life. Applied to “If development is not engendered, it is endangered.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “If development is not engendered, it is endangered.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “If development is not engendered, it is endangered.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “If development is not engendered, it is endangered.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “If development is not engendered, it is endangered.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “If development is not engendered, it is endangered.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2016-A2 - Need brings greed, if greed increases it spoils breed.

Verification: V2 - carried-forward; re-check before verbatim use **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Need brings greed, if greed increases it spoils breed.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Need brings greed, if greed increases it spoils breed.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Need brings greed, if greed increases it spoils breed.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Need brings greed, if greed increases it spoils breed.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Need brings greed, if greed increases it spoils breed.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Need brings greed, if greed increases it spoils breed.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2016-A3 - Water disputes between States in federal India.

Verification: V2 - carried-forward; re-check before verbatim use **Prompt type:** issue-based proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Water joins ecology, agriculture, health, federal relations, urbanisation and distributive justice.
2. Federalism manages unity and diversity through divided authority, negotiation, fiscal capacity and constitutional trust.
3. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
4. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
5. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
6. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.

Model response:

Introduction. “Water disputes between States in federal India.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Water joins ecology, agriculture, health, federal relations, urbanisation and distributive justice. Applied to “Water disputes between States in federal India.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. Federalism manages unity and diversity through divided authority, negotiation, fiscal capacity and constitutional trust. Applied to “Water disputes between States in federal India.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Water disputes between States in federal India.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Water disputes between States in federal India.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Water disputes between States in federal India.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Water disputes between States in federal India.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2016-A4 - Innovation is the key determinant of economic growth and social welfare.

Verification: V2 - carried-forward; re-check before verbatim use **Prompt type:** hybrid proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Economic outcomes must be read through growth, employment, capability, distribution, resilience and ecological cost.
2. Growth becomes development when it creates productive work, public capability, resilience and fairly shared opportunity.
3. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
4. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
5. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
6. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.

Model response:

Introduction. “Innovation is the key determinant of economic growth and social welfare.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Economic outcomes must be read through growth, employment, capability, distribution, resilience and ecological cost. Applied to “Innovation is the key determinant of economic growth and social welfare.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. Growth becomes development when it creates productive work, public capability, resilience and fairly shared opportunity. Applied to “Innovation is the key determinant of economic growth and social welfare.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Innovation is the key determinant of economic growth and social welfare.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Innovation is the key determinant of economic growth and social welfare.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Innovation is the key determinant of economic growth and social welfare.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Innovation is the key determinant of economic growth and social welfare.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2016-B5 - Cooperative federalism: Myth or reality.

Verification: V2 - carried-forward; re-check before verbatim use **Prompt type:** issue-based proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Federalism manages unity and diversity through divided authority, negotiation, fiscal capacity and constitutional trust.
2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Cooperative federalism: Myth or reality.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Federalism manages unity and diversity through divided authority, negotiation, fiscal capacity and constitutional trust. Applied to “Cooperative federalism: Myth or reality.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Cooperative federalism: Myth or reality.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Cooperative federalism: Myth or reality.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Cooperative federalism: Myth or reality.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Cooperative federalism: Myth or reality.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Cooperative federalism: Myth or reality.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2016-B6 - Cyberspace and internet: Blessing or curse to the human civilization in the long run.

Verification: V2 - carried-forward; re-check before verbatim use **Prompt type:** hybrid proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Civilisations endure by balancing material capability with ecological restraint, ethical purpose and institutional learning.
2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Cyberspace and internet: Blessing or curse to the human civilization in the long run.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Civilisations endure by balancing material capability with ecological restraint, ethical purpose and institutional learning. Applied to “Cyberspace and internet: Blessing or curse to the human civilization in the long run.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Cyberspace and internet: Blessing or curse to the human civilization in the long run.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Cyberspace and internet: Blessing or curse to the human civilization in the long run.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Cyberspace and internet: Blessing or curse to the human civilization in the long run.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Cyberspace and internet: Blessing or curse to the human civilization in the long run.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Cyberspace and internet: Blessing or curse to the human civilization in the long run.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2016-B7 - Near jobless growth in India: An anomaly or an outcome of economic reforms.

Verification: V2 - carried-forward; re-check before verbatim use **Prompt type:** issue-based proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Economic outcomes must be read through growth, employment, capability, distribution, resilience and ecological cost.
2. Growth becomes development when it creates productive work, public capability, resilience and fairly shared opportunity.
3. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
4. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
5. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
6. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.

Model response:

Introduction. “Near jobless growth in India: An anomaly or an outcome of economic reforms.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Economic outcomes must be read through growth, employment, capability, distribution, resilience and ecological cost. Applied to “Near jobless growth in India: An anomaly or an outcome of economic reforms.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. Growth becomes development when it creates productive work, public capability, resilience and fairly shared opportunity. Applied to “Near jobless growth in India: An anomaly or an outcome of economic reforms.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Near jobless growth in India: An anomaly or an outcome of economic reforms.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Near jobless growth in India: An anomaly or an outcome of economic reforms.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Near jobless growth in India: An anomaly or an outcome of economic reforms.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Near jobless growth in India: An anomaly or an outcome of economic reforms.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2016-B8 - Digital economy: A leveller or a source of economic inequality.

Verification: V2 - carried-forward; re-check before verbatim use **Prompt type:** hybrid proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Economic outcomes must be read through growth, employment, capability, distribution, resilience and ecological cost.
2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Digital economy: A leveller or a source of economic inequality.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Economic outcomes must be read through growth, employment, capability, distribution, resilience and ecological cost. Applied to “Digital economy: A leveller or a source of economic inequality.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Digital economy: A leveller or a source of economic inequality.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Digital economy: A leveller or a source of economic inequality.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Digital economy: A leveller or a source of economic inequality.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Digital economy: A leveller or a source of economic inequality.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Digital economy: A leveller or a source of economic inequality.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2017-A1 - Farming has lost the ability to be a source of subsistence for majority of farmers in India.

Verification: V2 - carried-forward; re-check before verbatim use **Prompt type:** issue-based proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Farmers face intertwined risks from climate, prices, input costs, fragmented holdings, credit and unequal market power.
2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. "Farming has lost the ability to be a source of subsistence for majority of farmers in India." presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Farmers face intertwined risks from climate, prices, input costs, fragmented holdings, credit and unequal market power. Applied to "Farming has lost the ability to be a source of subsistence for majority of farmers in India.", this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to "Farming has lost the ability to be a source of subsistence for majority of farmers in India.", this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to "Farming has lost the ability to be a source of subsistence for majority of farmers in India.", this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to "Farming has lost the ability to be a source of subsistence for majority of farmers in India.", this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to "Farming has lost the ability to be a source of subsistence for majority of farmers in India.", this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to "Farming has lost the ability to be a source of subsistence for majority of farmers in India.", this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2017-A2 - Impact of the new economic measures on fiscal ties between the Union and States in India.

Verification: V2 - carried-forward; re-check before verbatim use **Prompt type:** issue-based proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Economic outcomes must be read through growth, employment, capability, distribution, resilience and ecological cost.
2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Impact of the new economic measures on fiscal ties between the Union and States in India.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Economic outcomes must be read through growth, employment, capability, distribution, resilience and ecological cost. Applied to “Impact of the new economic measures on fiscal ties between the Union and States in India.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Impact of the new economic measures on fiscal ties between the Union and States in India.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Impact of the new economic measures on fiscal ties between the Union and States in India.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Impact of the new economic measures on fiscal ties between the Union and States in India.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Impact of the new economic measures on fiscal ties between the Union and States in India.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Impact of the new economic measures on fiscal ties between the Union and States in India.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2017-A3 - Destiny of a nation is shaped in its classrooms.

Verification: V2 - carried-forward; re-check before verbatim use **Prompt type:** hybrid proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Destiny of a nation is shaped in its classrooms.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Destiny of a nation is shaped in its classrooms.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Destiny of a nation is shaped in its classrooms.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Destiny of a nation is shaped in its classrooms.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Destiny of a nation is shaped in its classrooms.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Destiny of a nation is shaped in its classrooms.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2017-A4 - Has the Non-Alignment Movement (NAM) lost its relevance in a multipolar world?

Verification: V2 - carried-forward; re-check before verbatim use **Prompt type:** issue-based proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Has the Non-Alignment Movement (NAM) lost its relevance in a multipolar world?” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Has the Non-Alignment Movement (NAM) lost its relevance in a multipolar world?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Has the Non-Alignment Movement (NAM) lost its relevance in a multipolar world?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Has the Non-Alignment Movement (NAM) lost its relevance in a multipolar world?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Has the Non-Alignment Movement (NAM) lost its relevance in a multipolar world?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Has the Non-Alignment Movement (NAM) lost its relevance in a multipolar world?”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2017-B5 - Joy is the simplest form of gratitude.

Verification: V2 - carried-forward; re-check before verbatim use **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Joy is the simplest form of gratitude.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Joy is the simplest form of gratitude.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Joy is the simplest form of gratitude.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Joy is the simplest form of gratitude.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Joy is the simplest form of gratitude.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Joy is the simplest form of gratitude.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2017-B6 - Fulfilment of 'new woman' in India is a myth.

Verification: V2 - carried-forward; re-check before verbatim use **Prompt type:** hybrid proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Fulfilment of 'new woman' in India is a myth.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Fulfilment of 'new woman' in India is a myth.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Fulfilment of 'new woman' in India is a myth.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Fulfilment of 'new woman' in India is a myth.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Fulfilment of 'new woman' in India is a myth.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Fulfilment of 'new woman' in India is a myth.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2017-B7 - We may brave human laws but cannot resist natural laws.

Verification: V2 - carried-forward; re-check before verbatim use **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “We may brave human laws but cannot resist natural laws.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “We may brave human laws but cannot resist natural laws.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “We may brave human laws but cannot resist natural laws.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “We may brave human laws but cannot resist natural laws.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “We may brave human laws but cannot resist natural laws.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “We may brave human laws but cannot resist natural laws.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2017-B8 - Social media is inherently a selfish medium.

Verification: V2 - carried-forward; re-check before verbatim use **Prompt type:** hybrid proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Media shapes the informational conditions of citizenship, accountability, pluralism and public trust.
2. Social media combines connection and expression with attention incentives, comparison, misinformation and platform power.
3. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
4. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
5. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
6. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.

Model response:

Introduction. “Social media is inherently a selfish medium.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Media shapes the informational conditions of citizenship, accountability, pluralism and public trust. Applied to “Social media is inherently a selfish medium.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. Social media combines connection and expression with attention incentives, comparison, misinformation and platform power. Applied to “Social media is inherently a selfish medium.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Social media is inherently a selfish medium.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Social media is inherently a selfish medium.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Social media is inherently a selfish medium.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Social media is inherently a selfish medium.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2018-A1 - Alternative technologies for a climate change resilient India.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** issue-based proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Climate risk links ecology, livelihoods, public finance, technology and intergenerational justice.
2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Alternative technologies for a climate change resilient India.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Climate risk links ecology, livelihoods, public finance, technology and intergenerational justice. Applied to “Alternative technologies for a climate change resilient India.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Alternative technologies for a climate change resilient India.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Alternative technologies for a climate change resilient India.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Alternative technologies for a climate change resilient India.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Alternative technologies for a climate change resilient India.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Alternative technologies for a climate change resilient India.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2018-A2 - A good life is one inspired by love and guided by knowledge.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “A good life is one inspired by love and guided by knowledge.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “A good life is one inspired by love and guided by knowledge.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “A good life is one inspired by love and guided by knowledge.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “A good life is one inspired by love and guided by knowledge.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “A good life is one inspired by love and guided by knowledge.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “A good life is one inspired by love and guided by knowledge.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2018-A3 - Poverty anywhere is a threat to prosperity everywhere.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** hybrid proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Poverty is a deprivation of income, capability, security, voice and access to institutions, not merely a low monetary threshold.
2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Poverty anywhere is a threat to prosperity everywhere.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Poverty is a deprivation of income, capability, security, voice and access to institutions, not merely a low monetary threshold. Applied to “Poverty anywhere is a threat to prosperity everywhere.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Poverty anywhere is a threat to prosperity everywhere.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Poverty anywhere is a threat to prosperity everywhere.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Poverty anywhere is a threat to prosperity everywhere.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Poverty anywhere is a threat to prosperity everywhere.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Poverty anywhere is a threat to prosperity everywhere.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2018-A4 - Management of Indian border disputes - a complex task.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** issue-based proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Borders combine sovereignty and security with trade, ecology, migration, local livelihoods and human relationships.
2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Management of Indian border disputes - a complex task.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Borders combine sovereignty and security with trade, ecology, migration, local livelihoods and human relationships. Applied to “Management of Indian border disputes - a complex task.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Management of Indian border disputes - a complex task.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Management of Indian border disputes - a complex task.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Management of Indian border disputes - a complex task.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Management of Indian border disputes - a complex task.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Management of Indian border disputes - a complex task.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2018-B5 - Customary morality cannot be a guide to modern life.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** hybrid proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Customary morality cannot be a guide to modern life.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Customary morality cannot be a guide to modern life.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Customary morality cannot be a guide to modern life.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Customary morality cannot be a guide to modern life.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Customary morality cannot be a guide to modern life.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Customary morality cannot be a guide to modern life.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2018-B6 - 'The past' is a permanent dimension of human consciousness and values.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “‘The past’ is a permanent dimension of human consciousness and values.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “‘The past’ is a permanent dimension of human consciousness and values.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “‘The past’ is a permanent dimension of human consciousness and values.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “‘The past’ is a permanent dimension of human consciousness and values.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “‘The past’ is a permanent dimension of human consciousness and values.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “‘The past’ is a permanent dimension of human consciousness and values.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2018-B7 - A people that values its privileges above its principles loses both.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “A people that values its privileges above its principles loses both.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “A people that values its privileges above its principles loses both.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “A people that values its privileges above its principles loses both.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “A people that values its privileges above its principles loses both.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “A people that values its privileges above its principles loses both.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “A people that values its privileges above its principles loses both.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2018-B8 - Reality does not conform to the ideal, but confirms it.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Reality does not conform to the ideal, but confirms it.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Reality does not conform to the ideal, but confirms it.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Reality does not conform to the ideal, but confirms it.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Reality does not conform to the ideal, but confirms it.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Reality does not conform to the ideal, but confirms it.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Reality does not conform to the ideal, but confirms it.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2019-A1 - Wisdom finds truth.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Truth requires openness to evidence, independence from prejudice and institutions capable of correcting error.
2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Wisdom finds truth.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Truth requires openness to evidence, independence from prejudice and institutions capable of correcting error. Applied to “Wisdom finds truth.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Wisdom finds truth.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Wisdom finds truth.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Wisdom finds truth.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Wisdom finds truth.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Wisdom finds truth.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2019-A2 - Values are not what humanity is, but what humanity ought to be.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Values are not what humanity is, but what humanity ought to be.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Values are not what humanity is, but what humanity ought to be.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Values are not what humanity is, but what humanity ought to be.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Values are not what humanity is, but what humanity ought to be.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Values are not what humanity is, but what humanity ought to be.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Values are not what humanity is, but what humanity ought to be.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2019-A3 - Best for an individual is not necessarily best for the society.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** hybrid proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Best for an individual is not necessarily best for the society.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Best for an individual is not necessarily best for the society.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Best for an individual is not necessarily best for the society.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Best for an individual is not necessarily best for the society.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Best for an individual is not necessarily best for the society.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Best for an individual is not necessarily best for the society.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2019-A4 - Courage to accept and dedication to improve are two keys to success.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Courage to accept and dedication to improve are two keys to success.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Courage to accept and dedication to improve are two keys to success.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Courage to accept and dedication to improve are two keys to success.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Courage to accept and dedication to improve are two keys to success.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Courage to accept and dedication to improve are two keys to success.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Courage to accept and dedication to improve are two keys to success.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2019-B5 - South Asian societies are woven not around the state, but around their plural cultures and plural identities.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** hybrid proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Culture carries memory and identity while remaining open to contestation, exchange and reform.
2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. "South Asian societies are woven not around the state, but around their plural cultures and plural identities." presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Culture carries memory and identity while remaining open to contestation, exchange and reform. Applied to "South Asian societies are woven not around the state, but around their plural cultures and plural identities.", this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to "South Asian societies are woven not around the state, but around their plural cultures and plural identities.", this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to "South Asian societies are woven not around the state, but around their plural cultures and plural identities.", this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to "South Asian societies are woven not around the state, but around their plural cultures and plural identities.", this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to "South Asian societies are woven not around the state, but around their plural cultures and plural identities.", this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to "South Asian societies are woven not around the state, but around their plural cultures and plural identities.", this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits

established in the essay.

2019-B6 - Neglect of primary health care and education in India are reasons for its backwardness.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** issue-based proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Education shapes capability, citizenship, mobility and the habits through which a society reproduces or reforms itself.
2. Health reflects prevention, nutrition, sanitation, primary care, financial protection, trust and the social determinants of well-being.
3. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
4. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
5. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
6. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.

Model response:

Introduction. “Neglect of primary health care and education in India are reasons for its backwardness.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Education shapes capability, citizenship, mobility and the habits through which a society reproduces or reforms itself. Applied to “Neglect of primary health care and education in India are reasons for its backwardness.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. Health reflects prevention, nutrition, sanitation, primary care, financial protection, trust and the social determinants of well-being. Applied to “Neglect of primary health care and education in India are reasons for its backwardness.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Neglect of primary health care and education in India are reasons for its backwardness.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Neglect of primary health care and education in India are reasons for its backwardness.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Neglect of primary health care and education in India are reasons for its backwardness.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Neglect of primary health care and education in India are reasons for its backwardness.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2019-B7 - Biased media is a real threat to Indian democracy.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** issue-based proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Media shapes the informational conditions of citizenship, accountability, pluralism and public trust.
2. Democracy requires informed choice, accountable institutions, equal voice, lawful restraint and the protection of dissent.
3. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
4. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
5. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
6. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.

Model response:

Introduction. “Biased media is a real threat to Indian democracy.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Media shapes the informational conditions of citizenship, accountability, pluralism and public trust. Applied to “Biased media is a real threat to Indian democracy.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. Democracy requires informed choice, accountable institutions, equal voice, lawful restraint and the protection of dissent. Applied to “Biased media is a real threat to Indian democracy.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Biased media is a real threat to Indian democracy.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Biased media is a real threat to Indian democracy.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Biased media is a real threat to Indian democracy.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Biased media is a real threat to Indian democracy.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2019-B8 - Rise of Artificial Intelligence: the threat of jobless future or better job opportunities through reskilling and upskilling.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** issue-based proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Artificial intelligence can augment knowledge and productivity while creating risks of opacity, concentration, displacement and manipulation.
2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Rise of Artificial Intelligence: the threat of jobless future or better job opportunities through reskilling and upskilling.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Artificial intelligence can augment knowledge and productivity while creating risks of opacity, concentration, displacement and manipulation. Applied to “Rise of Artificial Intelligence: the threat of jobless future or better job opportunities through reskilling and upskilling.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Rise of Artificial Intelligence: the threat of jobless future or better job opportunities through reskilling and upskilling.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Rise of Artificial Intelligence: the threat of jobless future or better job opportunities through reskilling and upskilling.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Rise of Artificial Intelligence: the threat of jobless future or better job opportunities through reskilling and upskilling.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Rise of Artificial Intelligence: the threat of jobless future or better job opportunities through reskilling and upskilling.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Rise of Artificial Intelligence: the threat of jobless future or better job opportunities through reskilling and upskilling.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2020-A1 - Life is a long journey between human being and being humane.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Life is a long journey between human being and being humane.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Life is a long journey between human being and being humane.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Life is a long journey between human being and being humane.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Life is a long journey between human being and being humane.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Life is a long journey between human being and being humane.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Life is a long journey between human being and being humane.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2020-A2 - Mindful manifesto is the catalyst to a tranquil self.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Mindful manifesto is the catalyst to a tranquil self.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Mindful manifesto is the catalyst to a tranquil self.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Mindful manifesto is the catalyst to a tranquil self.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Mindful manifesto is the catalyst to a tranquil self.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Mindful manifesto is the catalyst to a tranquil self.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Mindful manifesto is the catalyst to a tranquil self.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2020-A3 - Ships do not sink because of water around them, ships sink because of water that gets into them.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Water joins ecology, agriculture, health, federal relations, urbanisation and distributive justice.
2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Ships do not sink because of water around them, ships sink because of water that gets into them.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Water joins ecology, agriculture, health, federal relations, urbanisation and distributive justice. Applied to “Ships do not sink because of water around them, ships sink because of water that gets into them.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Ships do not sink because of water around them, ships sink because of water that gets into them.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Ships do not sink because of water around them, ships sink because of water that gets into them.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Ships do not sink because of water around them, ships sink because of water that gets into them.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Ships do not sink because of water around them, ships sink because of water that gets into them.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Ships do not sink because of water around them, ships sink because of water that gets into them.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2020-A4 - Simplicity is the ultimate sophistication.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Simplicity is the ultimate sophistication.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Simplicity is the ultimate sophistication.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Simplicity is the ultimate sophistication.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Simplicity is the ultimate sophistication.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Simplicity is the ultimate sophistication.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Simplicity is the ultimate sophistication.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2020-B5 - Culture is what we are, civilization is what we have.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** hybrid proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Culture carries memory and identity while remaining open to contestation, exchange and reform.
2. Civilisations endure by balancing material capability with ecological restraint, ethical purpose and institutional learning.
3. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
4. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
5. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
6. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.

Model response:

Introduction. “Culture is what we are, civilization is what we have.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Culture carries memory and identity while remaining open to contestation, exchange and reform. Applied to “Culture is what we are, civilization is what we have.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. Civilisations endure by balancing material capability with ecological restraint, ethical purpose and institutional learning. Applied to “Culture is what we are, civilization is what we have.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Culture is what we are, civilization is what we have.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Culture is what we are, civilization is what we have.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Culture is what we are, civilization is what we have.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Culture is what we are, civilization is what we have.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2020-B6 - There can be no social justice without economic prosperity but economic prosperity without social justice is meaningless.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** hybrid proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Economic outcomes must be read through growth, employment, capability, distribution, resilience and ecological cost.
2. Justice asks how rights, resources, recognition, capability and institutional burdens are distributed.
3. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
4. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
5. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
6. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.

Model response:

Introduction. “There can be no social justice without economic prosperity but economic prosperity without social justice is meaningless.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Economic outcomes must be read through growth, employment, capability, distribution, resilience and ecological cost. Applied to “There can be no social justice without economic prosperity but economic prosperity without social justice is meaningless.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. Justice asks how rights, resources, recognition, capability and institutional burdens are distributed. Applied to “There can be no social justice without economic prosperity but economic prosperity without social justice is meaningless.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “There can be no social justice without economic prosperity but economic prosperity without social justice is meaningless.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “There can be no social justice without economic prosperity but economic prosperity without social justice is meaningless.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “There can be no social justice without economic prosperity but economic prosperity without social justice is meaningless.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “There can be no social justice without economic prosperity but economic prosperity without social justice is meaningless.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2020-B7 - Patriarchy is the least noticed yet the most significant structure of social inequality.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** issue-based proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Patriarchy is the least noticed yet the most significant structure of social inequality.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Patriarchy is the least noticed yet the most significant structure of social inequality.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Patriarchy is the least noticed yet the most significant structure of social inequality.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Patriarchy is the least noticed yet the most significant structure of social inequality.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Patriarchy is the least noticed yet the most significant structure of social inequality.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Patriarchy is the least noticed yet the most significant structure of social inequality.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2020-B8 - Technology as the silent factor in international relations.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** issue-based proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Technology redistributes power, opportunity and risk; its effects depend on access, design, regulation and human agency.
2. International relations join power and interest with institutions, technology, interdependence and normative legitimacy.
3. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
4. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
5. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
6. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.

Model response:

Introduction. “Technology as the silent factor in international relations.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Technology redistributes power, opportunity and risk; its effects depend on access, design, regulation and human agency. Applied to “Technology as the silent factor in international relations.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. International relations join power and interest with institutions, technology, interdependence and normative legitimacy. Applied to “Technology as the silent factor in international relations.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Technology as the silent factor in international relations.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Technology as the silent factor in international relations.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Technology as the silent factor in international relations.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Technology as the silent factor in international relations.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2021-A1 - The process of self-discovery has now been technologically outsourced.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** hybrid proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “The process of self-discovery has now been technologically outsourced.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “The process of self-discovery has now been technologically outsourced.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “The process of self-discovery has now been technologically outsourced.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “The process of self-discovery has now been technologically outsourced.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “The process of self-discovery has now been technologically outsourced.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “The process of self-discovery has now been technologically outsourced.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2021-A2 - Your perception of me is a reflection of you; my reaction to you is an awareness of me.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Your perception of me is a reflection of you; my reaction to you is an awareness of me.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Your perception of me is a reflection of you; my reaction to you is an awareness of me.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Your perception of me is a reflection of you; my reaction to you is an awareness of me.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Your perception of me is a reflection of you; my reaction to you is an awareness of me.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Your perception of me is a reflection of you; my reaction to you is an awareness of me.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Your perception of me is a reflection of you; my reaction to you is an awareness of me.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2021-A3 - Philosophy of wantlessness is Utopian, while materialism is a chimera.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Philosophy of wantlessness is Utopian, while materialism is a chimera.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Philosophy of wantlessness is Utopian, while materialism is a chimera.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Philosophy of wantlessness is Utopian, while materialism is a chimera.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Philosophy of wantlessness is Utopian, while materialism is a chimera.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Philosophy of wantlessness is Utopian, while materialism is a chimera.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Philosophy of wantlessness is Utopian, while materialism is a chimera.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2021-A4 - The real is rational and the rational is real.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “The real is rational and the rational is real.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “The real is rational and the rational is real.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “The real is rational and the rational is real.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “The real is rational and the rational is real.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “The real is rational and the rational is real.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “The real is rational and the rational is real.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2021-B5 - Hand that rocks the cradle rules the world.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** hybrid proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Hand that rocks the cradle rules the world.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Hand that rocks the cradle rules the world.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Hand that rocks the cradle rules the world.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Hand that rocks the cradle rules the world.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Hand that rocks the cradle rules the world.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Hand that rocks the cradle rules the world.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2021-B6 - What is research, but a blind date with knowledge!

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Research is organised uncertainty: it combines disciplined method with imagination, failure, peer scrutiny and public purpose.
2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “What is research, but a blind date with knowledge!” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Research is organised uncertainty: it combines disciplined method with imagination, failure, peer scrutiny and public purpose. Applied to “What is research, but a blind date with knowledge!”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “What is research, but a blind date with knowledge!”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “What is research, but a blind date with knowledge!”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “What is research, but a blind date with knowledge!”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “What is research, but a blind date with knowledge!”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “What is research, but a blind date with knowledge!”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2021-B7 - History repeats itself, first as a tragedy, second as a farce.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “History repeats itself, first as a tragedy, second as a farce.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “History repeats itself, first as a tragedy, second as a farce.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “History repeats itself, first as a tragedy, second as a farce.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “History repeats itself, first as a tragedy, second as a farce.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “History repeats itself, first as a tragedy, second as a farce.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “History repeats itself, first as a tragedy, second as a farce.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2021-B8 - There are better practices to "best practices".

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** hybrid proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. "There are better practices to "best practices"." presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to "There are better practices to "best practices".", this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to "There are better practices to "best practices".", this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to "There are better practices to "best practices".", this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to "There are better practices to "best practices".", this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to "There are better practices to "best practices".", this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2022-A1 - Forests are the best case studies for economic excellence.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** hybrid proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Forests are ecological infrastructure, livelihood spaces, cultural landscapes and buffers against climate and disaster risk.
2. Economic outcomes must be read through growth, employment, capability, distribution, resilience and ecological cost.
3. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
4. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
5. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
6. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.

Model response:

Introduction. “Forests are the best case studies for economic excellence.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Forests are ecological infrastructure, livelihood spaces, cultural landscapes and buffers against climate and disaster risk. Applied to “Forests are the best case studies for economic excellence.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. Economic outcomes must be read through growth, employment, capability, distribution, resilience and ecological cost. Applied to “Forests are the best case studies for economic excellence.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Forests are the best case studies for economic excellence.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Forests are the best case studies for economic excellence.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Forests are the best case studies for economic excellence.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Forests are the best case studies for economic excellence.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2022-A2 - Poets are the unacknowledged legislators of the world.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Poets are the unacknowledged legislators of the world.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Poets are the unacknowledged legislators of the world.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Poets are the unacknowledged legislators of the world.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Poets are the unacknowledged legislators of the world.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Poets are the unacknowledged legislators of the world.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Poets are the unacknowledged legislators of the world.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2022-A3 - History is a series of victories won by the scientific man over the romantic man.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “History is a series of victories won by the scientific man over the romantic man.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “History is a series of victories won by the scientific man over the romantic man.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “History is a series of victories won by the scientific man over the romantic man.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “History is a series of victories won by the scientific man over the romantic man.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “History is a series of victories won by the scientific man over the romantic man.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “History is a series of victories won by the scientific man over the romantic man.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2022-A4 - A ship in harbour is safe, but that is not what ship is for.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “A ship in harbour is safe, but that is not what ship is for.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “A ship in harbour is safe, but that is not what ship is for.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “A ship in harbour is safe, but that is not what ship is for.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “A ship in harbour is safe, but that is not what ship is for.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “A ship in harbour is safe, but that is not what ship is for.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “A ship in harbour is safe, but that is not what ship is for.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2022-B5 - The time to repair the roof is when the sun is shining.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “The time to repair the roof is when the sun is shining.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “The time to repair the roof is when the sun is shining.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “The time to repair the roof is when the sun is shining.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “The time to repair the roof is when the sun is shining.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “The time to repair the roof is when the sun is shining.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “The time to repair the roof is when the sun is shining.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2022-B6 - You cannot step twice in the same river.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “You cannot step twice in the same river.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “You cannot step twice in the same river.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “You cannot step twice in the same river.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “You cannot step twice in the same river.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “You cannot step twice in the same river.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “You cannot step twice in the same river.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2022-B7 - A smile is the chosen vehicle for all ambiguities.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “A smile is the chosen vehicle for all ambiguities.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “A smile is the chosen vehicle for all ambiguities.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “A smile is the chosen vehicle for all ambiguities.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “A smile is the chosen vehicle for all ambiguities.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “A smile is the chosen vehicle for all ambiguities.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “A smile is the chosen vehicle for all ambiguities.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2022-B8 - Just because you have a choice, it does not mean that any of them has to be right.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Just because you have a choice, it does not mean that any of them has to be right.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Just because you have a choice, it does not mean that any of them has to be right.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Just because you have a choice, it does not mean that any of them has to be right.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Just because you have a choice, it does not mean that any of them has to be right.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Just because you have a choice, it does not mean that any of them has to be right.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Just because you have a choice, it does not mean that any of them has to be right.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2023-A1 - Thinking is like a game, it does not begin unless there is an opposite team.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Thinking is like a game, it does not begin unless there is an opposite team.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Thinking is like a game, it does not begin unless there is an opposite team.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Thinking is like a game, it does not begin unless there is an opposite team.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Thinking is like a game, it does not begin unless there is an opposite team.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Thinking is like a game, it does not begin unless there is an opposite team.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Thinking is like a game, it does not begin unless there is an opposite team.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2023-A2 - Visionary decision-making happens at the intersection of intuition and logic.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Visionary decision-making happens at the intersection of intuition and logic.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Visionary decision-making happens at the intersection of intuition and logic.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Visionary decision-making happens at the intersection of intuition and logic.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Visionary decision-making happens at the intersection of intuition and logic.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Visionary decision-making happens at the intersection of intuition and logic.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Visionary decision-making happens at the intersection of intuition and logic.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2023-A3 - Not all who wander are lost.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Not all who wander are lost.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Not all who wander are lost.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Not all who wander are lost.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Not all who wander are lost.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Not all who wander are lost.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Not all who wander are lost.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2023-A4 - Inspiration for creativity springs from the effort to look for the magical in the mundane.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Inspiration for creativity springs from the effort to look for the magical in the mundane.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Inspiration for creativity springs from the effort to look for the magical in the mundane.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Inspiration for creativity springs from the effort to look for the magical in the mundane.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Inspiration for creativity springs from the effort to look for the magical in the mundane.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Inspiration for creativity springs from the effort to look for the magical in the mundane.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Inspiration for creativity springs from the effort to look for the magical in the mundane.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2023-B5 - Girls are weighed down by restrictions, boys with demands - two equally harmful disciplines.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** hybrid proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. The position of girls reveals how mobility, education, care burdens, safety and social expectations shape substantive freedom.
2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Girls are weighed down by restrictions, boys with demands - two equally harmful disciplines.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. The position of girls reveals how mobility, education, care burdens, safety and social expectations shape substantive freedom. Applied to “Girls are weighed down by restrictions, boys with demands - two equally harmful disciplines.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Girls are weighed down by restrictions, boys with demands - two equally harmful disciplines.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Girls are weighed down by restrictions, boys with demands - two equally harmful disciplines.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Girls are weighed down by restrictions, boys with demands - two equally harmful disciplines.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Girls are weighed down by restrictions, boys with demands - two equally harmful disciplines.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Girls are weighed down by restrictions, boys with demands - two equally harmful disciplines.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2023-B6 - Mathematics is the music of reason.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Mathematics is the music of reason.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Mathematics is the music of reason.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Mathematics is the music of reason.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Mathematics is the music of reason.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Mathematics is the music of reason.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Mathematics is the music of reason.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2023-B7 - A society that has more justice is a society that needs less charity.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** hybrid proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Justice asks how rights, resources, recognition, capability and institutional burdens are distributed.
2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “A society that has more justice is a society that needs less charity.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Justice asks how rights, resources, recognition, capability and institutional burdens are distributed. Applied to “A society that has more justice is a society that needs less charity.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “A society that has more justice is a society that needs less charity.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “A society that has more justice is a society that needs less charity.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “A society that has more justice is a society that needs less charity.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “A society that has more justice is a society that needs less charity.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “A society that has more justice is a society that needs less charity.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2023-B8 - Education is what remains after one has forgotten what one has learned in school.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** hybrid proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Education shapes capability, citizenship, mobility and the habits through which a society reproduces or reforms itself.
2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Education is what remains after one has forgotten what one has learned in school.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Education shapes capability, citizenship, mobility and the habits through which a society reproduces or reforms itself. Applied to “Education is what remains after one has forgotten what one has learned in school.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Education is what remains after one has forgotten what one has learned in school.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Education is what remains after one has forgotten what one has learned in school.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Education is what remains after one has forgotten what one has learned in school.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Education is what remains after one has forgotten what one has learned in school.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Education is what remains after one has forgotten what one has learned in school.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2024-A1 - Forests precede civilizations and deserts follow them.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** hybrid proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Forests are ecological infrastructure, livelihood spaces, cultural landscapes and buffers against climate and disaster risk.
2. Civilisations endure by balancing material capability with ecological restraint, ethical purpose and institutional learning.
3. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
4. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
5. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
6. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.

Model response:

Introduction. “Forests precede civilizations and deserts follow them.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a hybrid proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Forests are ecological infrastructure, livelihood spaces, cultural landscapes and buffers against climate and disaster risk. Applied to “Forests precede civilizations and deserts follow them.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. Civilisations endure by balancing material capability with ecological restraint, ethical purpose and institutional learning. Applied to “Forests precede civilizations and deserts follow them.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Forests precede civilizations and deserts follow them.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Forests precede civilizations and deserts follow them.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Forests precede civilizations and deserts follow them.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Forests precede civilizations and deserts follow them.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2024-A2 - The empires of the futures will be the empires of the mind.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “The empires of the futures will be the empires of the mind.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “The empires of the futures will be the empires of the mind.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “The empires of the futures will be the empires of the mind.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “The empires of the futures will be the empires of the mind.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “The empires of the futures will be the empires of the mind.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “The empires of the futures will be the empires of the mind.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2024-A3 - There is no path to happiness, Happiness is the path.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Happiness includes meaning, relationships, dignity and purposeful activity rather than only pleasure or deferred achievement.
2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “There is no path to happiness, Happiness is the path.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Happiness includes meaning, relationships, dignity and purposeful activity rather than only pleasure or deferred achievement. Applied to “There is no path to happiness, Happiness is the path.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “There is no path to happiness, Happiness is the path.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “There is no path to happiness, Happiness is the path.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “There is no path to happiness, Happiness is the path.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “There is no path to happiness, Happiness is the path.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “There is no path to happiness, Happiness is the path.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2024-A4 - The doubter is a true man of science.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Science advances through curiosity, doubt, evidence, reproducibility and institutions that permit correction.
2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “The doubter is a true man of science.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Science advances through curiosity, doubt, evidence, reproducibility and institutions that permit correction. Applied to “The doubter is a true man of science.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “The doubter is a true man of science.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “The doubter is a true man of science.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “The doubter is a true man of science.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “The doubter is a true man of science.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “The doubter is a true man of science.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2024-B5 - Social media is triggering 'Fear of Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** issue-based proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Media shapes the informational conditions of citizenship, accountability, pluralism and public trust.
2. Social media combines connection and expression with attention incentives, comparison, misinformation and platform power.
3. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
4. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
5. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
6. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.

Model response:

Introduction. "Social media is triggering 'Fear of Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness." presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a issue-based proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Media shapes the informational conditions of citizenship, accountability, pluralism and public trust. Applied to "Social media is triggering 'Fear of Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness.", this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. Social media combines connection and expression with attention incentives, comparison, misinformation and platform power. Applied to "Social media is triggering 'Fear of Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness.", this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to "Social media is triggering 'Fear of Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness.", this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to "Social media is triggering 'Fear of Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness.", this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to "Social media is triggering 'Fear of Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness.", this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to "Social media is triggering 'Fear of Missing Out' amongst the youth precipitating depression and loneliness.", this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2024-B6 - Nearly all men can stand adversity, but to test the character, give him power.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Power tests character because it expands discretion and reveals whether authority is treated as trust, entitlement or licence.
2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Nearly all men can stand adversity, but to test the character, give him power.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Power tests character because it expands discretion and reveals whether authority is treated as trust, entitlement or licence. Applied to “Nearly all men can stand adversity, but to test the character, give him power.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Nearly all men can stand adversity, but to test the character, give him power.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Nearly all men can stand adversity, but to test the character, give him power.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Nearly all men can stand adversity, but to test the character, give him power.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Nearly all men can stand adversity, but to test the character, give him power.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Nearly all men can stand adversity, but to test the character, give him power.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2024-B7 - All ideas having large consequences are always simple.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “All ideas having large consequences are always simple.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “All ideas having large consequences are always simple.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “All ideas having large consequences are always simple.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “All ideas having large consequences are always simple.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “All ideas having large consequences are always simple.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “All ideas having large consequences are always simple.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2024-B8 - The cost of being wrong is less than the cost of doing nothing.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “The cost of being wrong is less than the cost of doing nothing.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “The cost of being wrong is less than the cost of doing nothing.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “The cost of being wrong is less than the cost of doing nothing.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “The cost of being wrong is less than the cost of doing nothing.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “The cost of being wrong is less than the cost of doing nothing.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “The cost of being wrong is less than the cost of doing nothing.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2025-A1 - Truth knows no color.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Truth requires openness to evidence, independence from prejudice and institutions capable of correcting error.
2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Truth knows no color.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Truth requires openness to evidence, independence from prejudice and institutions capable of correcting error. Applied to “Truth knows no color.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Truth knows no color.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Truth knows no color.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Truth knows no color.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Truth knows no color.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Truth knows no color.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2025-A2 - The supreme art of war is to subdue the enemy without fighting.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “The supreme art of war is to subdue the enemy without fighting.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “The supreme art of war is to subdue the enemy without fighting.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “The supreme art of war is to subdue the enemy without fighting.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “The supreme art of war is to subdue the enemy without fighting.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “The supreme art of war is to subdue the enemy without fighting.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “The supreme art of war is to subdue the enemy without fighting.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2025-A3 - Thought finds a world and creates one also.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Thought finds a world and creates one also.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Thought finds a world and creates one also.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Thought finds a world and creates one also.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Thought finds a world and creates one also.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Thought finds a world and creates one also.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Thought finds a world and creates one also.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2025-A4 - Best lessons are learnt through bitter experiences.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Best lessons are learnt through bitter experiences.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Best lessons are learnt through bitter experiences.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Best lessons are learnt through bitter experiences.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Best lessons are learnt through bitter experiences.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Best lessons are learnt through bitter experiences.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Best lessons are learnt through bitter experiences.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2025-B5 - Muddy water is best cleared by leaving it alone.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Water joins ecology, agriculture, health, federal relations, urbanisation and distributive justice.
2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Muddy water is best cleared by leaving it alone.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Water joins ecology, agriculture, health, federal relations, urbanisation and distributive justice. Applied to “Muddy water is best cleared by leaving it alone.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Muddy water is best cleared by leaving it alone.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Muddy water is best cleared by leaving it alone.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Muddy water is best cleared by leaving it alone.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Muddy water is best cleared by leaving it alone.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Muddy water is best cleared by leaving it alone.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2025-B6 - The years teach much which the days never know.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “The years teach much which the days never know.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “The years teach much which the days never know.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “The years teach much which the days never know.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “The years teach much which the days never know.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “The years teach much which the days never know.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “The years teach much which the days never know.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2025-B7 - It is best to see life as a journey, not as a destination.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “It is best to see life as a journey, not as a destination.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “It is best to see life as a journey, not as a destination.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “It is best to see life as a journey, not as a destination.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “It is best to see life as a journey, not as a destination.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “It is best to see life as a journey, not as a destination.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “It is best to see life as a journey, not as a destination.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.

2025-B8 - Contentment is natural wealth; luxury is artificial poverty.

Verification: V1 - directly verified locally **Prompt type:** philosophical or quotation proposition

Working thesis: The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Complete argument map:

1. Poverty is a deprivation of income, capability, security, voice and access to institutions, not merely a low monetary threshold.
2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct.
3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice.
4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice.
5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks.
6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility.

Model response:

Introduction. “Contentment is natural wealth; luxury is artificial poverty.” presents a relationship that must be interpreted before it is illustrated. The essay should define its key terms, state a qualified position and keep every paragraph answerable to that position. The prompt should be treated as a philosophical or quotation proposition. A defensible answer should accept its central insight conditionally, explain the mechanism through which it operates, test it across scales, confront the strongest counter-case and end with an earned synthesis rather than an absolute claim.

Argument 1. Poverty is a deprivation of income, capability, security, voice and access to institutions, not merely a low monetary threshold. Applied to “Contentment is natural wealth; luxury is artificial poverty.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 2. At the individual level, the proposition affects agency, character, capability and everyday conduct. Applied to “Contentment is natural wealth; luxury is artificial poverty.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 3. At the social level, it shapes relationships, norms, inclusion and the distribution of voice. Applied to “Contentment is natural wealth; luxury is artificial poverty.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 4. At the institutional level, incentives and rules determine whether the insight becomes durable practice. Applied to “Contentment is natural wealth; luxury is artificial poverty.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 5. At the national level, law, policy and public capacity can enlarge benefits while controlling unequal risks. Applied to “Contentment is natural wealth; luxury is artificial poverty.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Argument 6. At the global and intergenerational levels, the argument must account for interdependence, sustainability and responsibility. Applied to “Contentment is natural wealth; luxury is artificial poverty.”, this dimension must be connected to a mechanism and a safe illustration rather than left as a decorative heading.

Counter-view and qualification. The proposition should not be made universal merely because it is memorable. Its strongest exception may alter the scale, timing, institutional conditions or distribution of effects. A good counter-view therefore refines the thesis instead of replacing it with the opposite slogan.

Conclusion. The conclusion should return to the words of the prompt after the argument has deepened them. The final synthesis must join human agency with institutional responsibility and preserve both the insight and the limits established in the essay.